The Fulfilled Prophecies Of Jesus

A Verse-by-Verse Study of Matthew 24

Dr. Cindye Coates

Dr. Cindye Coates, Publisher

The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus

A VERSE-BY-VERSE STUDY OF MATTHEW 24

The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus:

A Verse-by-Verse Study of Matthew 24

Copyright © 2024 by Dr. Cindye Coates, Marietta, Georgia

First Edition: May 2024. Second Edition: September 2024.

Second Edition Print ISBN: 979-8-9905403-2-3

eBook ISBN: 979-8-9905403-1-6

All rights reserved.

Proofreading and editing: Dr. Stan Coates, Tyler Coates, Heidi Hunt,

Geneva Hollis and Lonzine Lee

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopy, recording, or otherwise without prior written permission of the publisher, except for brief quotations in critical reviews or articles. Such quotations must be in context.

Unless otherwise noted, all Scripture quotations are from the New King James Version (NKJV): Scripture taken from the NEW KING JAMES VERSION®. Copyright© 1982 by Thomas Nelson, Inc. Used by permission. All rights reserved. Scripture quoted by permission.

Quotations designated (NET) are from the NET Bible® copyright ©1996, 2019 by Biblical Studies Press, L.L.C. http://netbible.com.

All rights reserved. All graphics used in this publication are sourced from public domain.

Cover design: Dr. Cindye Coates

Appendices by Dr. Cindye Coates.

Special thanks to Mrs. Pam Norman for permission to reprint lyrics to *I Wish We'd All Been Ready* by Larry D. Norman. Copyright © Beechwood Music Corporation, Ordure Blanc Music, J.C. Love Pub. Co.

Published by Dr. Cindye Coates

Printed in the United States of America

Acknowledgements

Special thanks to the following friends who gave their valuable time and resources to help bring this book to reality: Geneva Hollis, Lonzine Lee, Tyler Coates, Heidi Hunt, Dr. Don Hughes, Dr. Klaune Spake, Anthony Sisson, Joe and Amanda Barton, Kay Perkins, Daniel and April Williams, Terry Trip, Sandra Cook, David Green, and Larry and Margo Thorson. Your encouragement, support and expertise are so very much appreciated.

This book is based on research conducted by scholars, historians, and older bible commentaries prior to 1864, before the extremes of dispensational indoctrination gained a foothold among evangelicals. These resources are mentioned in the bibliography. However, because their work was confined to the printed page, I would be remiss not to mention those who brought their work to the digital age on websites, social media platforms, and on-line teaching videos. Among these notable faithful stewards of present truth are Gary DeMar, Don. K Preston, R.C. Sproul, Charles Meek, Brian Martin, Lynn Hiles, Kelley Varner, Gary Parish, Michael Miano, Kobus & Annalise van Rensburg, Maurice Perry, Daniel Morais, and the list goes on. To those who are still with us in this earthly realm, keep up the good work! People are waking up!

Dedication

This book is dedicated to my sons, Kyle and Tyler:

To Kyle, your curious mind and excellent questions forced me to study so you would have the answers you so deserved.

To Tyler, for being the logical one who had to know things for yourself and see proof so you could inspire others.

And to:

My husband of forty years, Dr. Stan Coates.
Your encouragement and support kept me determined to stay the course and see this thing through.

You are all amazing, I am truly blessed.

Contents

Foreword

Endorsements

Introduction

I. The Basics

1. How to Read Using the 5 W's
2. Three First Century Historians To Know
3. Getting Scriptural Context

II. Matthew 24: The Prophecies Of Jesus

4. Jesus Predicts the Destruction of Herod's Temple
5. Sign of the End of the Age
6. The Great Tribulation
7. Coming of the Son of Man
8. This Generation
9. No One Knows The Day Or Hour
10. Parable of the Faithful Servant and The Evil Servant
11. Matthew 25: The Olivet Discourse Ends with Three Parables
12. Conclusion
13. My Story

Appendices

Bibliography

About the Author

Current Ministry Projects

Books by Dr Cindye Coates

Foreword

In every generation people have argued that their generation was the end-time generation. They had one thing in common: they were all wrong. Is the Bible unclear? Is God's Word the problem?

No. The Bible is the best interpreter of itself. If you want to know how the Bible uses words like "near," "shortly," "quickly," and this "generation," go to the Bible. You don't have to be a Bible scholar to do this. But what if what you find does not fit what you've been told about Bible prophecy? Then you will have to give up what you've been told. "Let God be true though everyone were a liar…" (Romans 3:4). The Bible is the standard.

Dr. Cindye Coates understands the biblical method of interpretation. "Study to show yourself approved" (2 Timothy 2:15). That's what Cindye has done, and she's taken her many years of study of Bible prophecy and made it available to Christians who know that "searching the Scriptures" (Acts 17:11) is the necessary and only starting point. Put her work to the test. Compare her work to what the Bible says. She is willing to put it all on the line for the sake of truth.

I love the way she starts her book by asking five important questions related to Who, What, When, Where and Why. These have always been fundamental questions to ask for any study. The Who and the When are the keys that unlock Bible prophecy.

If you ignore these keys, you will be locked out from the truth and be led astray by every prophetic wind of doctrine vying for attention. It's why many prophecy "experts" ignore timing indicators and original audience. It messes with their brand of futurism.

Instead of hopscotching through isolated verses, Dr. Coates takes the reader through a verse-by-verse study of Jesus' account of His coming, comparing Scripture with Scripture. Her study will serve as an interpretive prism that will give meaning to this verse: "For the word of God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword, piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of marrow, and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart" (Hebrews 4:12).

You are in for a great adventure because eschatology matters.

Gary DeMar - President of American Vision
Author of ***Last Days Madness***

Endorsements

Dr. Cindye Coates functions in the Body of Christ as an Apostle—Teacher. She certainly is one sent with a message to bring clarity and understanding to difficult or challenging Scripture. She loves research and history.

As a pastor, college professor and trainer, I appreciate her meticulous detail for historical context and her passion for God's people to have accurate understanding. In her book, ***The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus***, she brings historical facts to help the reader to be assured of accuracy. She has written the book in a very concise and logical manner. Her language is easy for anyone to understand. The book might challenge personal theology.

Also, you will learn historical facts you never encountered. Therefore, I encourage the reader to put all concepts on hold until you have finished reading the book. I enjoyed the logical way the book was written. I also see that I must encourage her to take other difficult passages and explain so Christians can have more accurate understanding. I will recommend this to my clients and students.

Dr./Rev Carolyn Driver
Christ Discipleship Ministries
The Driver Institute of Leadership and Education

Dr. Cindye Coates has written a bold, insightful, and thought provoking book about one of the most misunderstood and debated topics of the Bible! While teaching History, her son began asking questions about Revelation which led her to seek out the truth about "the rapture." Dr. Coates' book will challenge man-centered religious beliefs which the church has taught for years, and it is well worth reading.

As followers of Jesus Christ, we are to be ever learning and ever growing both spiritually and emotionally, so I encourage you to do your research and trust the Spirit of Truth to lead you in all truth that will set you free. The teaching comes when the student is ready, and I believe you are ready!

Germaine Copeland
Author, Speaker Founder of Prayers That Avail Ministries
Author of the ***Prayers That Avail Much*** Book Series,
A Global Call to Prayer, & ***365 Days to a Prayer-Filled Life***

The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus provides an excellent historical and theological review of Matthew 24 and related passages in a clear and comprehensive fashion. The book is not designed to answer all questions regarding eschatology from a fulfilled perspective but adds to the discussion, scholarly researched material for the general Christian reader. Well, done and well worth the read.

Stan E. DeKoven, Ph.D., D.Litt., MFT
President Vision International University

Before you construct, you must deconstruct. This book does both. It deconstructs centuries worth of religious, man-made traditions, and it constructs a true Biblical foundation for you to build your faith upon.

Dr. Cindye Coates does not give her opinion or a denominational doctrine, she gives the absolute historical truth which has come from thousands of hours of research and study. This book will release joy and an empowerment to live in the place where heaven and earth dance together in this dimension.

Terry Tripp
Author, Speaker, Recording Artist
Terry Tripp Ministries

Preface

Finally! After 25 years of research, writing articles, and teaching this material in conferences, seminars and Zoom meetings, I finally found the focus and support to get this book done! God has been so faithful to send people who had skills I lacked and move on the hearts of kind friends who felt compelled to send financial support so I could focus on getting this message out there. I am forever grateful to everyone who saw in me what I could not see in myself.

Some may ask why it took so long. As an only child I cared for my aging parents until they crossed over to their eternal reward. As a wife and mother, I was focused on taking care of my family which included homeschooling our sons for 20 years. As an educator, my attention was on lesson plans and projects dealing with high school and college students. As a minister, I was helping my husband pastor a church, host conferences and worship events. Life was full and something was always more pending than finishing this book.

Although I was consumed with the demands of life, I was frustrated with the vast amounts of misinformation out there concerning Bible prophecy. Christian TV, radio, social media, and books were constantly pumping the dispensational futuristic flawed view of the end of the age.

This had to be challenged! I could not stand by and agree with something so dishonest. As a high school Ancient World History teacher, I was quick to see Bible prophecy as historically fulfilled. Cognitive dissonance was prevalent among people I dearly love but I simply could not let that nullify what was clearly being revealed to me. I had to take a bold stand on God's Word against all opposition, at a great cost.

I never burned a bridge over doctrine, although others would do so. The older I get the more I realize we are all on a journey to unlearn and relearn. It's just a part of daily life, and those who refuse to grow become stuck and complacent—waiting to escape this world or waiting for Jesus to come back and do what He told us to do. It was always good to get a text or a voice message from a friend who had an "ah ha" moment. As a teacher, it thrills me when people see truth. Much of the material

in this book is from the notes I made while writing my doctoral dissertation. The research is scholarly, but the language is simple and intentionally repetitive because this is how people learn best, and that is my objective. I pray you, my friend, find great joy in ***The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus!***

Dr. Cindye Coates

Introduction

What This Book Is About:

This book contains proof of a first-century fulfillment of Jesus' prophecies concerning the end of the age recorded in Matthew 24 (Mark 13 and Luke 21) and Matthew 25 while speaking to His disciples during the last week of His earthly ministry.

Why This Book Was Written:

This book was written to eliminate confusion and bring clarity when studying Scripture by applying comprehensive reading skills, basic grammar and knowledge of first-century Ancient World History.

How This Book Should Be Read:

This book is a simple verse-by-verse study of Matthew 24-25 (also known as the Olivet Discourse), which includes Jesus' prophecies concerning the end of the age. Jesus said these prophecies would be fulfilled during the lifetime of His disciples and not two thousand years later. This book provides the proof that these prophecies were fulfilled by AD 70 just as Jesus promised they would be.

Part 1

The Basics

Chapter 1

How to Read Using the 5 W's

How to Read Using the 5 W's

When studying the Bible, it is important to always ask five questions to gain clarity and avoid confusion. This basic comprehensive reading method makes complicated things simple and easy to understand. Making it a habit to always use the 5 W's will be a great benefit as it sharpens your study skills by allowing time to think and allow the Holy Spirit to reveal treasures you might not find otherwise.

Applying the 5 W's method in reading Matthew 24-25:

Section 1: **Who?**

More specifically: Who is writing? Who is speaking? To Whom (the audience)?

Who is writing? Matthew is writing.

Matthew was a Jewish tax-collector. He was one of Jesus' disciples whom He commissioned as one of "The Twelve" apostles, sent to proclaim the Gospel to the new Jewish believers in the Early Church.

Who is speaking? Jesus is speaking to His disciples.

To whom is Jesus speaking?

In Matthew 24:3, it says, "as Jesus was sitting on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to him privately." We could say Jesus is speaking to "the disciples".

In Mark 13:3 however, the disciples were named: "As Jesus was sitting on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple, **Peter, James, John and Andrew** asked him privately."

Section 2: **What?**

What is Matthew 24-25 about?

The answer to this question is found in the headings within the passage: **Jesus Predicts the Destruction of the Temple, The Signs of the Times and the End of the Age, The Great Tribulation & The Coming of Christ**

Section 3: **Where?**

Matthew 24-25 takes place on the **Mount of Olives,** a mountain ridge covered with olive groves east of the city of Jerusalem. **This is why Matthew 24-25 is known as The Olivet Discourse.**

Matthew 24: 1-3 "Then Jesus went out and departed from the temple, and His disciples came up to show Him the buildings of the temple. And Jesus said to them, "Do you not see all these things? Assuredly, I say to you, not one stone shall be left here upon another, that shall not be thrown down."**Now as He sat on the Mount of Olives**, the disciples came to Him privately…"

Section 4: **When?**

When did the Olivet Discourse take place? Matthew 24-25 took place the last week of Jesus' earthly ministry just before the last supper, followed by His betrayal, arrest, trial, and crucifixion. This would have been during **Holy Week** in the **Spring of AD 30 or 33** depending on the calendar used to calculate.

Section 5: **Why?**

Why was Jesus prophesying to His disciples about the destruction of the Temple, the end of the age, and the coming of the Son of man?

Jesus wanted His disciples to be prepared and understand how and when these things would transpire and what they were to do to protect themselves and their loved ones. The Roman siege of Jerusalem and the destruction of Herod's Temple was the most horrific event in ancient Jewish history as their entire culture and way of life was centered on that city and that religious system.

Chapter 2

Three First Century Historians To Know

Three First-Century Historians to Know

Why Study Historical Context?

Before we are introduced to three highly credible first-century historians, let's remember a few reasons why we need historical context when studying the New Testament. First, the New Testament was written almost 2,000 years ago.

Those who wrote it and those who were its first readers lived in a time when Rome ruled the world. The language spoken was Koine (Common) Greek. No one in the first century ever heard the English language as it was not spoken until 700 years later. To really understand the New Testament, we must learn some things about the ancient Roman Empire, the culture of the first-century Jews, and the language they shared.

Because this book specifically deals with Matthew's Gospel, we must realize it was written about a decade after Jesus' earthly life and ministry. At that time Herod's Temple was still standing in Jerusalem where the Jews were still burning animal sacrifices until it was destroyed in AD 70.

There is no mention of Herod's Temple being destroyed in the New Testament because it had not happened yet. In other words, the entire New Testament was written before the Romans destroyed the Temple in AD 70.

Note: A chronological list of the books of the New Testament is in Appendix G.

In the Olivet Discourse (Matthew 24-25), Jesus was not addressing a modern-day audience. He was specifically speaking to four disciples (Peter, James, John, and Andrew) who were among The Twelve Apostles Jesus commissioned after His resurrection to continue making disciples and expanding the kingdom of God to all nations.

Under Roman rule and occupation, the people of Israel believed their Messiah would bring political freedom—not spiritual freedom, and so they were disappointed when Jesus didn't overthrow the Romans. As we study Matthew 24-25 from a historically fulfilled perspective, we must determine how it fits into the history timeline. What was going on in the world at that time? Who was in power? What were the circumstances of God's people at that time? For example, when we read the four Gospels—Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John, we notice some tension surrounding

Jesus. The atmosphere was politically charged and the religious leaders were being challenged by the popularity of Jesus' ministry of healing and hope.

The intention of this book is to help readers feel more grounded in the Word with solid historical context to bring deeper insight. Most people were not taught this historical information. In addition to Scripture, we must refer to outside resources like these three ancient historians, Josephus, Tacitus, and Suetonius, who witnessed the historical fulfillment of Bible Prophecy.

Section 1: **FLAVIUS JOSEPHUS (AD 37-100)**

Josephus was a first century historian best known for writing ***The War of the Jews***. He was a Roman Jew, born in Jerusalem, which was then part of the Roman province called Judea. He became a military leader, a general who led the Jewish Revolt in Galilee against the Roman Empire, which became the "First Jewish-Roman War." He surrendered in AD 67 to Roman General Vespasian and his son, Titus, who both later became emperors.

Josephus insisted the Jewish messianic prophecies were referring to Vespasian becoming Roman emperor. In response, Vespasian decided to keep him as a slave whose job was to be an interpreter. After Vespasian became emperor in AD 69, he granted Josephus his freedom and made him a Roman citizen. It was then, Josephus assumed the emperor's family name of Flavius.

Flavius Josephus became an advisor and friend of Vespasian's son, General Titus. Josephus served Titus as a translator when he led the siege of Jerusalem in AD 66 as a result of the Jewish Revolt, and the destruction of Herod's Temple in AD 70.

Josephus made detailed records of the Great Jewish Revolt against Roman occupation from AD 66–70, in his most important work, ***The War of the Jews*** completed in AD 75.

Josephus' records are a credible source for the history of ancient Israel as it relates to the New Testament. As an eyewitness, he kept a detailed journal of first-century events and gave accounts of Jesus, James (the brother of Jesus), John the Baptist, Pontius Pilate, and Herod the Great. ***The War of the Jews*** serves to confirm the fulfillment of the events Jesus prophesied would happen during the lifetime of His disciples.

Section 2 - **TACITUS (AD 56 - 120)**

Tacitus is regarded by scholars as one of the greatest Roman historians. His two most famous works are the ***Annals*** and the ***Histories***, which span the history of the Roman Empire from the death of Caesar Augustus (AD 14) to the death of Emperor Domitian (AD 96). This timeline includes the reign of emperors Tiberius, Caligula, Claudius, Nero, Galba 68-69, Otho 69, Vitellius 69 and Vespasian 69-79.

Note: AD 69 is known as the "Year of the Four Caesars". In the ***Annals*** Tacitus provides precise references of Jesus, His crucifixion, and the persecution of the Early Christians in Rome. (Annals Book 15, Chapter 15)

As a young man, Tacitus studied rhetoric to prepare for a career in law and politics. He served in the Roman Senate during the reign of both emperors Vespasian and Titus. Tacitus documented the events during the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70, proving the events Jesus said would occur within the first century did happen, just as He said it would.

Section 3: **SUETONIUS (AD 69-122)**

Suetonius was a Roman historian who wrote, ***The Twelve Caesars***, a set of biographies of twelve successive emperors of Rome from Julius Caesar to Domitian. Scholars refer to ***The Twelve Caesars*** when researching the specific life and times of the following Roman rulers: **Julius Caesar, Augustus, Tiberius, Caligula, Claudius, Nero, Galba, Otho, Vitellius, Vespasian, Titus, and Domitian.**

During the lifetime of Jesus, two Roman emperors were in power: **Caesar Augustus (27 BC - AD 14) and Tiberius (AD 14 - AD 37).** They reigned in a time known as ***Pax Romana*** which is Latin for "Roman Peace."

Suetonius reveals in the biography of **Caesar Augustus** (who is also known as Octavian), how he transformed Rome from a republic into an empire and expanded the Roman Empire by conquering new territories including Jerusalem in 63 BC.

After Augustus, his stepson **Tiberius** became emperor and appointed Pontius Pilate as governor of Judea to preside at the final trial of Jesus.

Suetonius' biographies of emperors **Augustus** and **Tiberius** are necessary when studying the life of Jesus because they were in power during His lifetime. To further understand what happened between the time of Jesus and the destruction of Herod's Temple in AD 70, we can read the biographies of the emperors who came after **Tiberius**.

A few days before He died, Jesus told His disciples on the Mount of Olives that Herod's Temple would be destroyed in their generation. **In Scripture, a generation is forty years.**

From the time that Jesus prophesied these things to His disciples until the time that Vespasian ordered the Romans to destroy the city of Jerusalem was within a forty-

year period. This attack was caused by the Jews revolting, as they expected the fulfillment of the Old Testament prophecies of Daniel to be at hand.

Included in ***The Twelve Caesars*** is the biography **of emperor Vespasian** where Suetonius reveals very important things as it relates to the fulfillment of Bible prophecy. Although Suetonius and Tacitus were neither Jew or Christian, they both said that zealous Messianic hopes fed by an ancient oracle (Daniel) were a primary motive of the Jewish Revolt in AD 66. Both historians said that the Jews anticipated fulfillment at a certain time, and no other Old Testament prophecy marks the time when the Messiah would come. After the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70, orthodox rabbis treated this event as the end of Daniel's "seventy weeks" prophecy as seen in the Book of Daniel.

Chapter 3

Getting Scriptural Context

Getting Scriptural Context

When the books of the Bible were originally written, they did not contain chapter or verse references. The chapter divisions commonly used today were developed by the Archbishop of Canterbury in AD 1227. The Wycliffe English Bible of 1382 was the first Bible to use this chapter pattern. Since the Wycliffe Bible, nearly all Bible translations have followed this format.

To get scriptural context, we need to identify where a story begins and ends, even if it spans through several chapters. For example, we cannot get the context of Matthew 24 unless we go back to Matthew 21 where the story of Holy Week begins. This can be easily seen in the Holy Week Chart in Appendix A.

Holy Week begins on Palm Sunday when Jesus makes His way into Jerusalem on the colt of a donkey in the triumphal entry. From there, we see a chain of events unfold that led up to the prophetic discourse Jesus had with His disciples on the Mount of Olives two days later.

A simple way to get context is to start in Matthew 21. Then, keep reading chapters 22 and 23 to get the backstory leading up to Matthew 24.

To gain an even deeper understanding of context, we must identify the same narrative elsewhere in scripture and tie it all together. **Matthew, Mark and Luke are known as the "Synoptic Gospels," which means they all contain the same narratives with different details.**

When we study Matthew 24, Mark 13 and Luke 21 together, we see Jesus' prophecies from the Mount of Olives come together in context as Scripture interprets Scripture.

Beginning with Matthew 21 and continuing to Matthew 23, we see the final week of Jesus' earthly ministry before going to the Cross in context, as everything had prophetic purpose and meaning. Once we arrive in Matthew 24, we better understand Jesus' prophetic words. As He looks upon the buildings all around Herod's Temple from the Mount of Olives, He begins to prophesy the events leading up to the end of the Old Mosaic Covenant age.

To get context, let's examine the chapters leading up to Matthew 24 beginning with Matthew 21.

Section 1: **Matthew 21 - Overview**

HOLY WEEK begins:

I. JESUS' TRIUMPHAL ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM - (Verses 1-11) Known as Palm Sunday. Fulfilling this prophecy:

Zechariah 9:9 "Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion! Shout, O daughter of Jerusalem! Behold, your King is coming to you; He is just and having salvation, Lowly and riding on a donkey, A colt, the foal of a donkey."

II. CLEANSING OF THE TEMPLE - (Verses 12-17)

Animals were being sold to be sacrificed so sins would be forgiven. The money changers were "a den of thieves" robbing the people of the final true sacrifice – The Lamb of God who gave Himself freely.

III. JESUS CURSES THE FIG TREE - (Verses 18-22)

Adam and Eve used the fig leaves to cover their shame. Jesus cursed mankind's attempt to cover their own sins, symbolic of the fig leaves. Man's efforts to cover his own sins do not bear fruit. Jesus is the only One who can remove shame, not merely hide it.

IV. JESUS' AUTHORITY CHALLENGED - (Verses 23-27)

The apostate religious leaders in the Temple challenged Jesus' authority as they knew He had not received their approval for His ministry and mission. He answered their questions with a question, and they refused to answer in fear of being judged by the people. Jesus spoke in parables (stories with a spiritual meaning) to people who opposed Him.

Psalm 78:2 – Fulfilling scripture.

Ezekiel 24 – The Lord speaks in parables to rebellious people.

Matthew 13:35 – Parables are a sign of the Messiah.

Mark 4:34 – To the group, Jesus spoke in parables. Privately, He explained to the disciples the meaning of the parables.

V. THE PARABLE of the TWO SONS - (Verses 28-32)

"The first son" represents the tax collectors and harlots who repented at the preaching of John the Baptist.

"The second son" represents the religious leaders in the Temple who did not believe John the Baptist.

VI. THE PARABLE of the TENANTS - (Verses 33:46)

The landowner was God.
The vinedressers were the Jewish leaders.
The servants are the prophets.
The son was Jesus.
The vinedressers killed the Son.

"The stone that the builders rejected has become the chief cornerstone." (Psalm 118:22)

Jesus said the kingdom will be taken from the apostate Jews and given to another nation.

"Therefore I say to you, the kingdom of God will be taken from you and given to a nation bearing the fruits of it".

(Matthew 21:43)

Conclusion: These parables point to the Destruction of the Temple in AD 70 and the end of the Old Mosaic Covenant.

Section 2: **Matthew 22 – Overview**

Jesus continues to speak in parables in the Temple before the religious leaders.

I. PARABLE OF THE WEDDING FEAST - (Verses 1-14)

The king is God the Father.
The son is His Son, Jesus.
The servants who invited the guests are the prophets.
The first guests invited were the Jews who killed the prophets.

The king was furious and sent armies to destroy the Jews and burn their city. Then the king sent servants to invite everyone else and the wedding was full. The wedding feast is the spiritual union between the Son with His Church.

Jesus was speaking to the religious leaders in the Temple about what was to come when the Roman Army came to destroy and burn their city from (AD 66 – AD 73). They had a chance to repent and make things right, but they had abandoned their faith.

Jesus concludes this parable with, "**Many are called, few are chosen**."

II. THE PHARISEES: "IS IT LAWFUL TO PAY TAXES TO CAESAR?" - (Verses 15-22)

The Pharisees were closely connected to the common people of the Jewish culture. They were typically merchants or business owners who had become wealthy enough to turn their attention to studying and interpreting the Scriptures. They believed in the strict observance of laws and traditions, and in the resurrection of the dead. The gospels report many encounters in which the Pharisees approached Jesus and tested Him with probing questions. These confrontations ended in humiliating the Jewish leaders as Jesus was on to them, and aware of their schemes and their true intent of testing Him.

Jesus replied to their question, "**Render therefore to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's.**"

III. THE SADDUCEES: "WHAT ABOUT THE RESURRECTION?" - (Verses 23-33)

The Sadducees had a lot of political power because of their long-time connections with Rome and were closer to the wealthy ruling elites than the common people. They were political and religious rivals of the Pharisees. The Sadducees did not believe in a resurrection like the Pharisees, but that didn't stop them from joining forces with them against Jesus.

The Sadducees presented an argument about marriage against the resurrection of the dead to Jesus. Jesus corrected them by stating marital relations don't exist in the resurrection by saying, "**God is not the God of the dead, but of the living**."

IV. THE SCRIBES: "WHICH IS THE GREATEST COMMANDMENT OF THE LAW?" - (Verses 34-40)

The Scribes were Palestinian scholars and teachers of Jewish law and tradition during the first century who transcribed and interpreted the Scriptures. They were responsible to keep records of religious and legal documents during this time. They served as journalists who wrote historical events. They functioned as lawyers.

When the Scribes (lawyers) asked what the greatest commandment of the Law was, Jesus answered by saying, **"You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your mind... 'You shall love your neighbor as yourself.'"**

V. JESUS: "HOW CAN DAVID CALL HIS DESCENDANT LORD?" - (Verse 41-46)

Jesus then silenced them all with a question of His own regarding the Christ as David's son. "How can Christ be both David's son and David's Lord?"

Answer:
David's son by virtue of physical ancestry; David's Lord by virtue of His deity.

Clearly, Jesus was a political threat to the compromised Jewish priesthood who aligned themselves with the Roman Empire.

Section 3: **Matthew 23 – Overview**

Jesus spoke boldly in the Temple for two reasons: He did not want the people to be deceived by the religious leaders and He knew these leaders were the farthest from God and needed to be warned of the coming judgment. What Jesus really wanted was their repentance. However, they had hardened their hearts and brought destruction upon themselves.

I. JESUS PUBLICLY REBUKES THE SCRIBES AND PHARISEES - (Verses 1-12)

They lay oppressive burdens on others. (1-4)
They do their works to be seen and praised by men. (5-10)
Jesus' ministry is all about service and humility. (11-12)

II. EIGHT WOES AGAINST THE SCRIBES AND PHARISEES - (Verses 13-36)

These woes stand in contrast to the eight beatitudes of Matthew 5. Jesus spoke harshly here, not because He was personally irritated but rather as a divine warning condemning the apostate Jewish priesthood. The religious leaders in the Temple were familiar with this prophetic tone as it was the language of the Old Testament prophets.

Examples of such "woes" may be found in Isaiah 5:8-23 and Habakkuk 2:6-19.

Woe to those who shut up the kingdom.
Woe to those who steal from the vulnerable.
Woe to those who lead people the wrong way.
Woe to those who make false and deceptive oaths.
Woe to those who are impure both inside and out.
Woe to those who obsess on pointless matters.
Woe to those who appear good, yet with no life inside.
Woe to those who honor dead prophets, but murder the living prophets.

III. JESUS PROPHESIES THE DESTRUCTION OF JERUSALEM - (Verses 37-39)

Jesus mourned over Jerusalem because He knew the religious leaders were bringing judgment and destruction upon the whole city.

Books like Hosea, Isaiah, and Ezra record God's longing for the Jews to do the right thing and turn from their sin to serve Him. God is not quick to execute His judgments. judgment is usually preceded by a period of extended patience. In this case it would be 40 years until this judgment would happen.

Jesus said in Matthew 23:36

"Assuredly, I say to you, all these things will come upon this generation." He was referring to the generation He was addressing that day in the Temple.

Part 2

Matthew 24: The Prophecies Of Jesus

Chapter 4

Jesus Predicts the Destruction of Herod's Temple

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:1-2; Mark 13:1-2; Luke 21:5-6

Section 1: **Location – Mount of Olives**

Overlooking Herod's Temple

Jesus had just left Herod's Temple after publicly rebuking the religious leaders for being hypocrites and oppressing the people.

He went to the Mount of Olives and His disciples followed Him. He looked out over the buildings of the temple complex that had been constructed by Herod the Great and prophesied the destruction of the city of Jerusalem.

"Then Jesus went out and departed from the temple, and His disciples came up to show Him the buildings of the temple. And Jesus said to them, '**Do you not see all these things? Assuredly, I say to you, not one stone shall be left here upon another, that shall not be thrown down**.'" (Matthew 24:1-2)

The same quote was made by Luke: "Then, as some spoke of the temple, how it was adorned with beautiful stones and donations, He said, '**These things which you see—the days will come in which not one stone shall be left upon another that shall not be thrown down**.'" (Luke 21:5-6)

Section 2: **Audience – Peter, James, John &**

Andrew (Mark 13:3)

The names of the disciples to whom Jesus was speaking are not mentioned in Matthew 24, but are mentioned in the synoptic Gospel of Mark 13.

"Now as He sat on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple,

Peter, James, John and Andrew asked Him privately...."

(Mark 13:3)

By reading the same story in different accounts, we find more details to bring greater clarity. Peter and Andrew were brothers. James and John were brothers. So, we see Jesus sitting on the Mount of Olives with two sets of brothers.

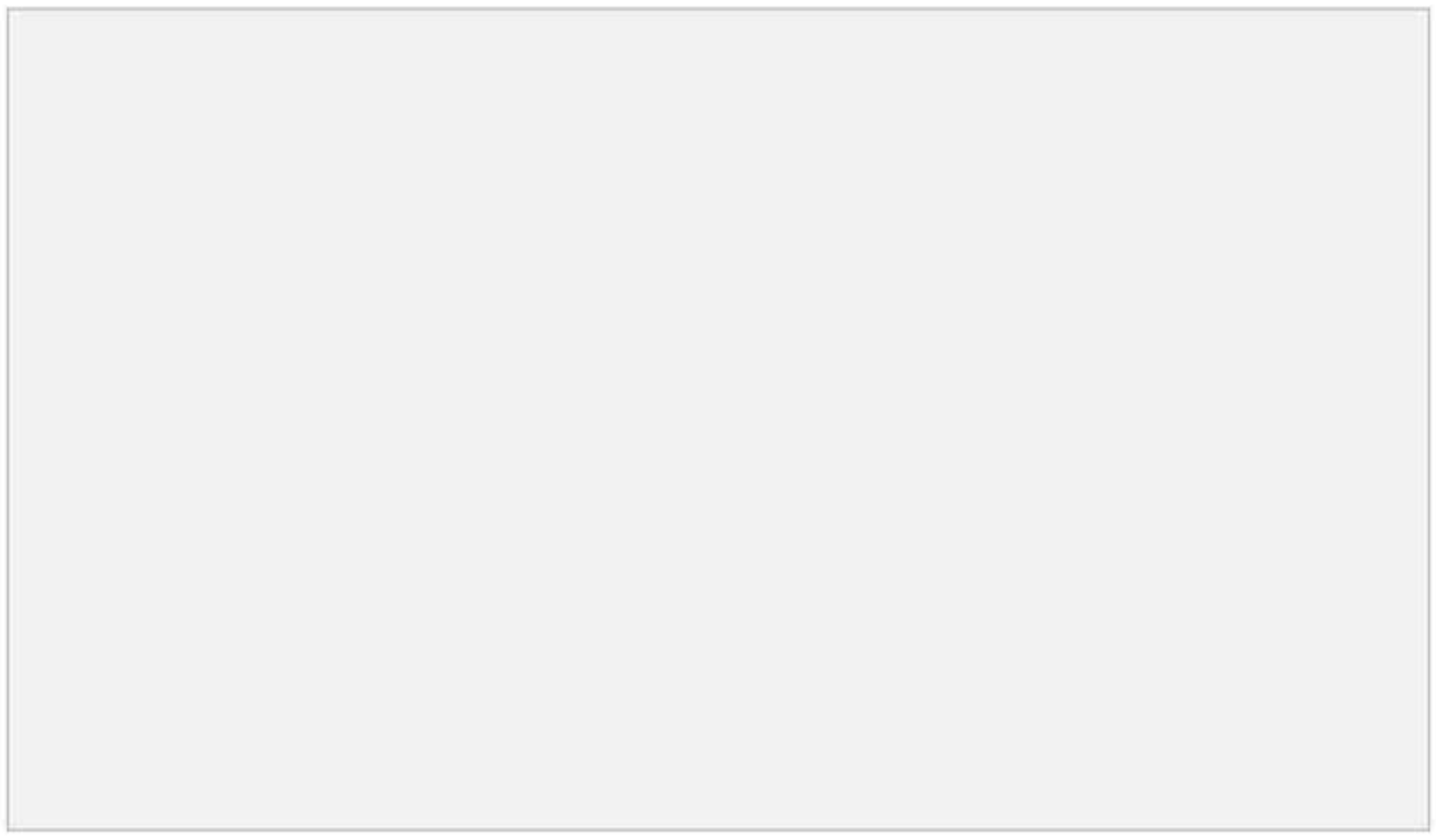
Section 3: **Who is "You"?**

As we continue to read the entire story of Jesus speaking with His four disciples on the Mount of Olives, we know to whom He is speaking. The "**you**" that Jesus was specifically talking to were His disciples Peter, James, John, and Andrew. They are the "**you**" in this passage.

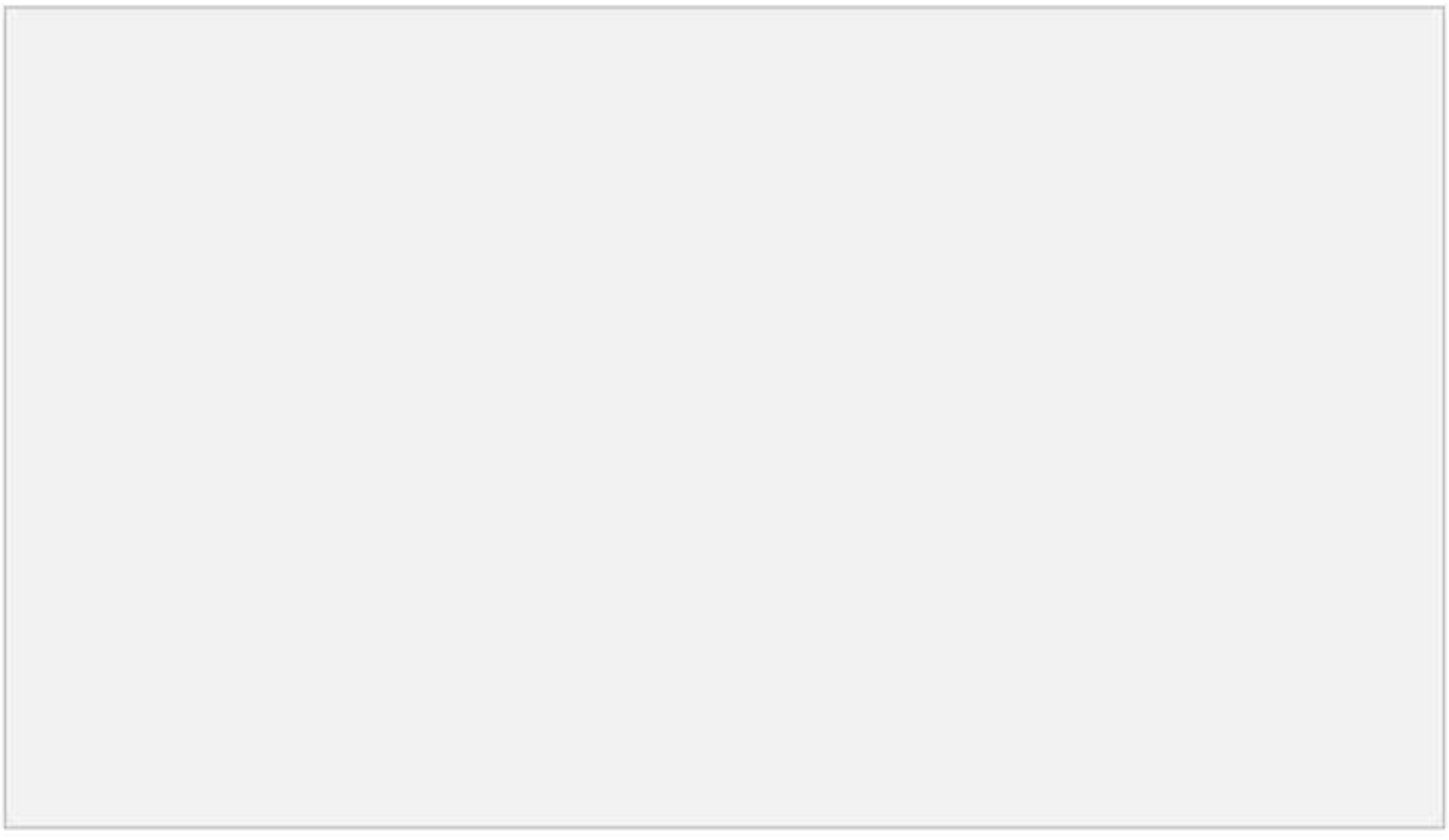
Section 4: **Synoptic Gospels: Matthew 24, Mark 13 and Luke 21.**

Matthew 24, Mark 13 and Luke 21 all have the same narrative with different details. This is why it is important to read the Olivet Discourse in all three books to gain clarity.

Section 5 – **Historical Fulfillment**

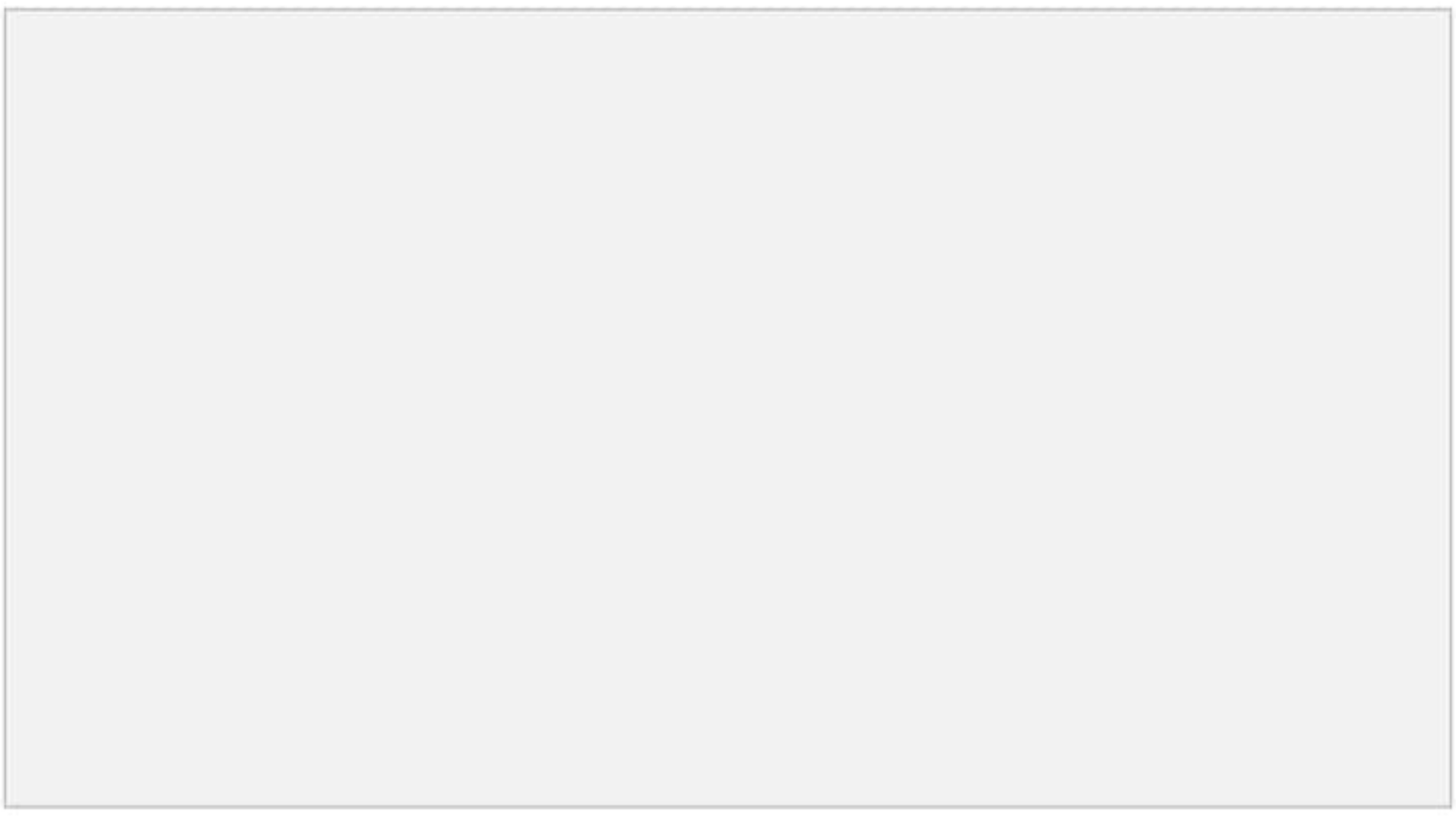


The Siege of Jerusalem by the Romans, AD 70



Ruins of the Temple in modern day Jerusalem

Jesus said "**Not one stone shall be left here upon another, that shall not be thrown down.**" (Matthew 24:2, Mark 13:2 and Luke 21:6)



The Arch of Titus in Rome, Italy

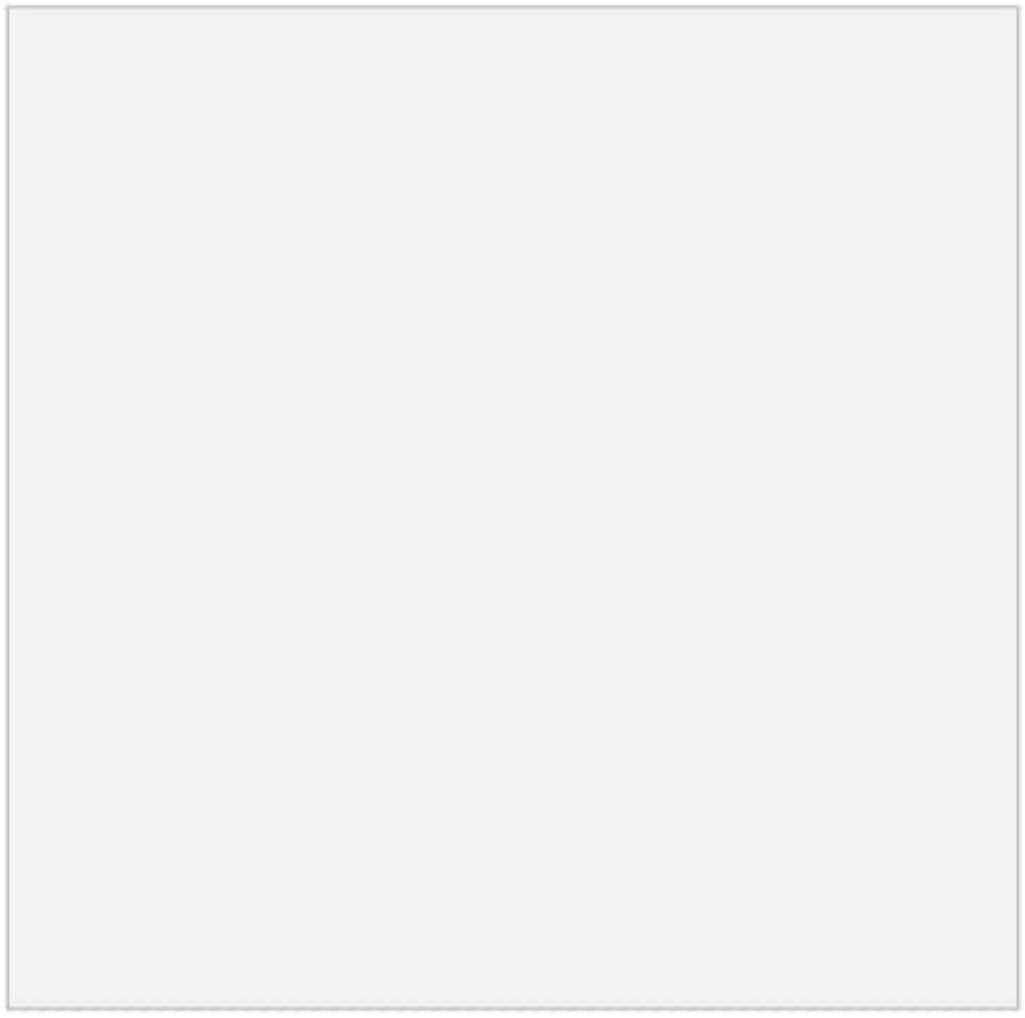
This panel from the Arch of Titus in Rome was constructed in AD 81 by Emperor Domitian shortly after the death of his older brother, Titus, to commemorate his

victory as general of the Roman Army that destroyed Jerusalem under the command of their father, Vespasian.

First-century historians, artists, and architects confirm the fulfilled prophecies of Jesus. The Romans took Jews into slavery as they looted Herod's Temple. As you can see in the image above many things are being carried away from the Temple including a large menorah.

Chapter 5

Sign of the End of the Age



Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:3-14; Mark 13:3-13; Luke 21:7-19

Section 1: **Matthew 24:3**

Now as He sat on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to Him privately, saying, **"Tell us, when will these things be? And what will be the sign of Your coming, and of the end of the age?"**

This verse must be fully understood before reading any further. We have to go back and ask the "**5 W**" questions:

Q**. Who** are the people in this verse?
A**.** Jesus, Peter, James, John and Andrew.

Q. **What** is happening?
A. Jesus' disciples are asking a question about the timing of the destruction of the Temple, expecting Jesus to tell them the answer.

Q. **Where** is this happening?
A. They are sitting on the Mount of Olives looking over at the Temple and the buildings surrounding it.

Q. **When** is this happening?
A. This is happening during Holy Week, between AD 30-33, the last week of Jesus' earthly ministry just before He was crucified.

Q. **Why** is this happening?
A. The atmosphere was charged with religious tension and political energy. The disciples needed answers, and Jesus knew they needed to know what would be happening since it would be relevant to them and the people who were alive during that time.

After Jesus prophesied the Temple would be destroyed, the disciples asked Him one three-part question, all parts being related to the time of the destruction of the Temple.

The one question in three parts was:

When will these things be? (The destruction of the Temple buildings) ...and what will be the sign of Your coming, and of the end of the age?"

They needed to know **when** Herod's Temple would be destroyed.

They wanted to know **what** would be the sign of His coming.

They wanted to know **what** would be the sign of the end of the age.

The Greek word for "**coming**" is ***parousia***. It means **presence**.

The Greek word for "**age**" is ***aion***. It means **period of time.**

Now let's look at the question the disciples asked Jesus with the proper words to gain solid understanding:

When will these things be? And what will be the sign of Your presence and the end of the age?

Note: As long as the Temple remained standing, animal sacrifices were being conducted by the apostate Jewish priesthood. They were going through the religious motions to keep up the appearance of righteousness to deceive the people. The people believed the ark of the covenant was behind the veil in Herod's Temple, like in the Tabernacle of Moses. Since the destruction of Solomon's Temple, there had been no ark in the Holy of Holies. This is why it was significant when the veil was torn from the top to the bottom when Jesus died, to reveal the absence of the ark. The prophet Jeremiah stated clearly **"...'The ark of the covenant of the Lord.' It shall not come to mind nor shall they remember it, nor shall they visit it, nor shall it be made anymore." (Jeremiah 3:16)**

When the disciples asked what the sign of the end of the age would be, they were referring to the end of the age of the Old (Mosaic) Covenant as Jesus was introducing a new and better covenant.

"But now He has obtained a more excellent ministry inasmuch as He is also Mediator of a better covenant, which was established on better promises." (Hebrews 8:6)

Section 2: **Matthew 24:4**

And Jesus answered and said to them: **"Take heed that no one deceives you."**

Jesus was speaking to His four disciples Peter, James, John and Andrew **(Mark 13:3).** When He said, "you" He was referring to them. He is not speaking to us. Comprehensive reading skills must be applied in this verse to understand the following verses in this Olivet Discourse.

Note: Too often we are told to read the New Testament as though it was written to us, but it was not written to us. It was written to the Early Church. The first readers were not English-speaking. They spoke Koine (common) Greek, the most well-known language at the time because Alexander the Great, a Greek, had previously conquered their part of the world, and made Koine Greek the common language.

Jesus told His disciples to guard against deception since there would be fake Messiahs leading people away from the Truth. The Apostle Paul later exhorted the people in the Early Church to stay devoted to the teachings of Christ.

"See to it that no one takes **you** captive through philosophy and empty **deception,** according to the tradition of men, according to the elementary principles of the world, rather than according to Christ." **(Colossians 2:8)**

"Let no one in any way **deceive you**, for it will not come unless the apostasy comes first, and the man of lawlessness is revealed, the son of destruction." **(2 Thessalonians 2:3 NET)**

Note: The letters Paul wrote to the Christians in the Early Church were written before the time of his death in AD 65. When he mentioned **"the man of lawlessness...the son of destruction,"** he was referring to Titus – son of Emperor Vespasian who led the Roman Army in the siege of Jerusalem. He permanently put an end to the practice of the Law of Moses by destroying the Jewish Temple in AD 70 - making it impossible to fully follow its religious customs.

Section 3: **Matthew 24:5**

For many will come in My name, saying, 'I am the Christ,' and will deceive many.

The Apostle John wrote about false prophets and many antichrists that had come into the world in the first century:

"Little children, it is the last hour; and as you have heard that the **Antichrist** is coming, even now **many antichrists** have come, by which we know that it is the last hour." **(1 John 2:18)**

"…**many false prophets** are gone out into the world." **(1 John 4:1)**

First Century False Messiahs (Christs):

After Jesus ascended to heaven, we can see this prophecy was fulfilled in the Book of Acts. Luke, who was the author of Acts, records three false Messiahs: **Theudas, Judas the Galilean, and one unnamed Egyptian Jew.**

Theudas – "For some time ago Theudas rose up, claiming to be somebody. A number of men, about four hundred, joined him. He was slain, and all who obeyed him were scattered and came to nothing." (Acts 5:36)

In his historical work, ***Antiquities***, Josephus, the first-century Jewish historian, wrote about **Theudas** who around AD 45 influenced "the majority of the masses to take up their possessions and to follow him to the Jordan River." He claimed that the Jordan would part for them at his command. However, it didn't, and he and many of his followers paid for their foolishness with their lives.

Judas, the Galilean – "After this man, Judas of Galilee rose up in the days of the census and drew away many people after him. He also perished, and all who obeyed him were dispersed." (Acts 5:36)

Josephus also referred to **Judas, the Galilean,** who apparently had a false prophet called Saddok. Very likely, Saddok presented himself as Elijah, who, according to Scripture, was to precede and announce the coming of the Messiah. The pattern of

false messiahs having false prophets was to become all too familiar. Josephus credits Judas and Saddok with having founded the Zealots.

An Unnamed Egyptian Jew - A hostile mob nearly killed the Apostle Paul. The Roman commander stationed at the Temple arrested Paul. When Paul said something to him in Greek, the surprised commander replied, "Can you speak Greek? **Are you not the Egyptian who some time ago stirred up a rebellion and led the four thousand assassins out into the wilderness?" (Acts 21:38)** Of course, Paul assured him he was not that man.

Josephus also wrote of this incident: "This Egyptian Jew led his followers to the Mount of Olives, threatening to force entry into Jerusalem and liberate it from Roman occupation. Many of his followers were killed during the attack." ***War of the Jews***

Section 4: **Matthew 24:6**

And you will hear of wars and rumors of wars. See that you are not troubled; for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet.

When Jesus said this to His disciples, Tiberius was emperor of Rome and it was during a time called *"Pax Romana"* (Latin for Roman Peace). It was a window of time that began during the reign of Augustus (also known as Octavian) in 27 BC and lasted until the death of Marcus Aurelius in AD 180.

During this period of about 200 years, the Roman Empire achieved its greatest territorial expansion, with a population of 70 million.

This was a time of great prosperity and peace. However, when revolts broke out, the Roman armies were quick to shut them down with great force.

In AD 66, toward the end of Nero's reign, the province of Israel revolted against Rome. The Israelites fought the Romans and also turned their weapons against each other. Civil war broke out all over Israel between those wanting peace with Rome and those seeking sovereignty apart from Rome. In AD 68, the disease of civil war spread to the rest of the Roman Empire. This explains why wars (revolts) and rumors of wars

would precede "the end" of the Old (Mosaic) Covenant System in AD 70 when the Temple was destroyed. This is what was coming to an end, not the end of time or the end of "the world"—planet Earth— as so many teach.

Section 5 - **Matthew 24:7**

For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. And there will be famines, pestilences, and earthquakes in various places.

During the fourth year of the reign of Claudius Caesar (AD 45) (the emperor just before Nero), **a terrible famine struck the region of Judea**. The famine was so severe that the price of food became enormous, and great numbers died from starvation. According to Josephus, Tacitus and Greek Christian historian Eusebius, there were several famines during the reign of Claudius.

Luke wrote the following in the book of Acts: "Then one of them, named Agabus, stood up and showed by the Spirit that **there was going to be a great famine throughout all the world**, which also happened in the days of Claudius Caesar." **(Acts 11:28)**

Earthquakes were prevalent during this time, like one that struck Laodicea sometime between AD 60 and AD 64 during the reign of Nero. It is interesting to note that one of the churches addressed by John in the book of Revelation was a church in this city. (Revelation 3:14-22) Prior to AD 70 there were also **earthquakes in various places:** Crete, Smyrna, Miletus, Chios, Samos, Hierapolis, Colossae, Campania, Rome and Judea.

Section 6: **Matthew 24:8**

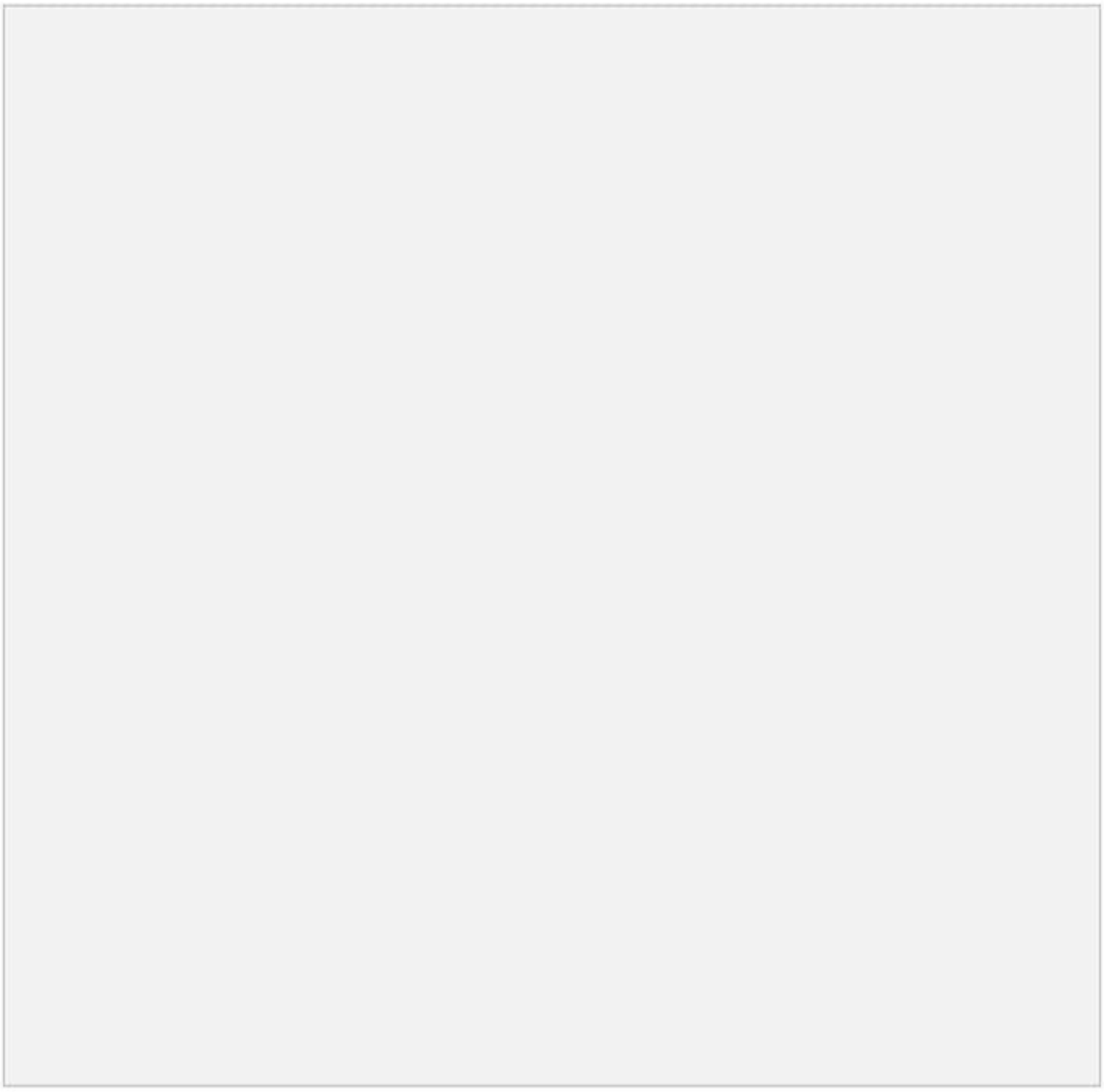
All these are the beginning of sorrows.

The Greek word for **"sorrows"** is ***odin***. It means birth pangs, travail and intolerable anguish.

A New Covenant was being birthed, as this was the time of transition (another birthing term) between **the now and not yet**. (See Appendix B)

Section 7: **Matthew 24:9**

Then they will deliver you up to tribulation and kill you, and you will be hated by all nations for My name's sake.

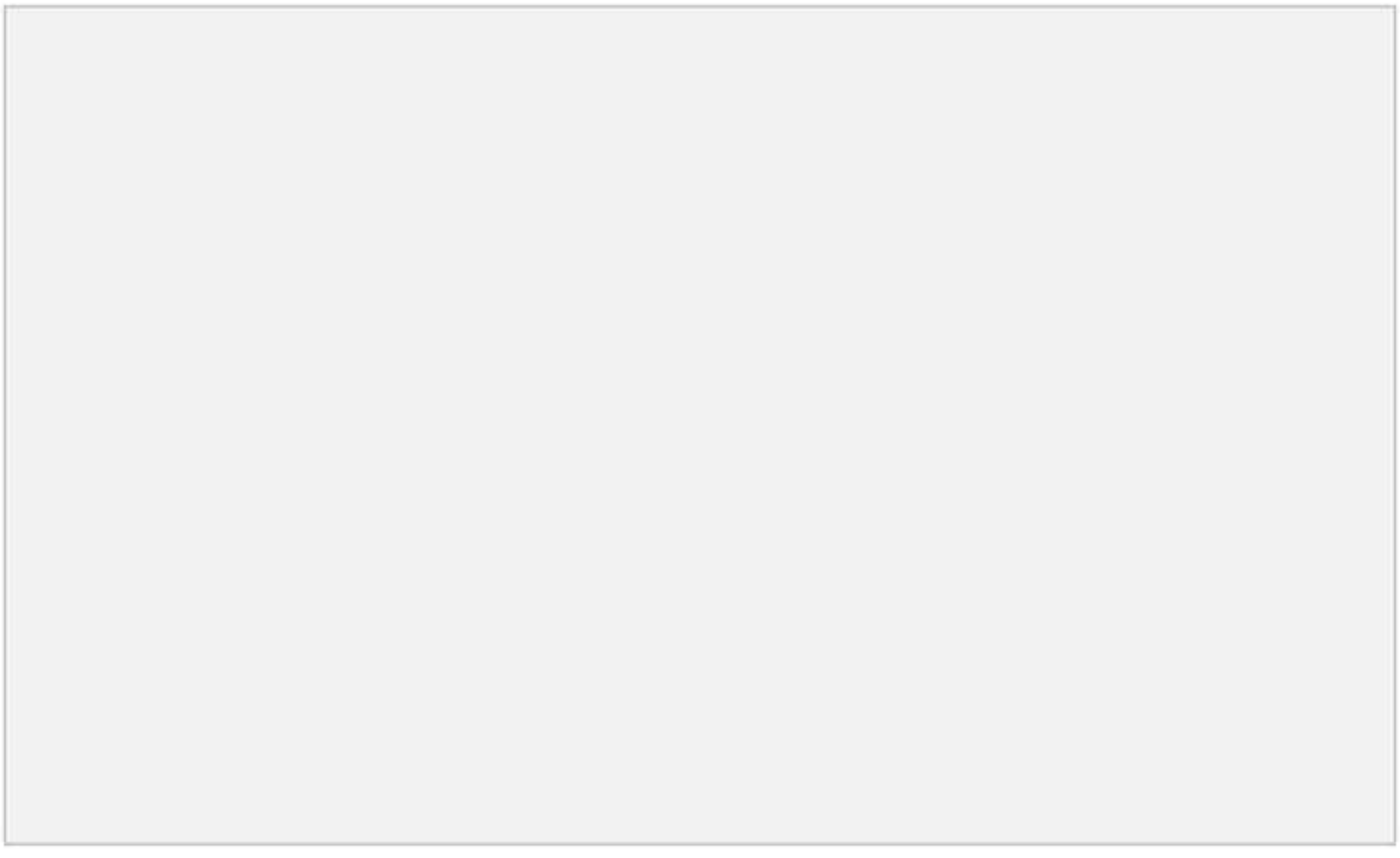


"The Stoning of Stephen" – Acts 7:54-60

Here Jesus addresses His apostles with a warning: They would soon be persecuted and put to death. The persecution spoken of here began just after Jesus' death with the martyrdom of Stephen. This event marked the beginning of a great persecution of Christians in Jerusalem.

In the words of the Greek Christian scholar and historian, Eusebius (AD 260-340): "First they [the Jews] stoned Stephen to death; then James the son of Zebedee and the brother of John was beheaded; and finally, James, the first after our Savior's Ascension to be raised to the bishop's throne there, lost his life in the way described,

while the remaining apostles, in constant danger from murderous plots, were driven out of Judea." ***Church History (Book III)***



Countless Christians were killed in AD 64 in Rome.

Section 8: **Matthew 24:10**

And then many will be offended, will betray one another, and will hate one another.

Persecution in Rome in AD 64 resulted in Christians betrayed by other Christians as they gave information to get others arrested. These Christians who were betrayed by their brethren were draped in animal skins and ripped apart by dogs or crucified in a major public spectacle. At night, these people were burned as torches to light the streets of Rome. According to church historians, it was during this massacre that Peter was crucified and Paul beheaded. Nearly all the disciples were martyred.

According to Josephus in ***Antiques of the Jews,*** Matthew was killed by a sword in Ethiopia. Mark was dragged by horses through the streets of Alexandria. Luke was hanged in Greece. Bartholomew was flogged to death. Andrew was crucified. Thomas was stabbed with a spear in India. Jude was pierced with arrows. Matthias was stoned, then beheaded, and Barnabas was stoned in Salonica.

Section 9: **Matthew 24:11**

Then many false prophets will rise up and deceive many.

The false prophets who deceived many people are mentioned in Josephus' ***War of the Jews:***

"A false prophet was the occasion of these people's destruction, who had made a public proclamation in the city that very day, that God commanded them to get up upon the temple, and there they should receive miraculous signs of their deliverance. Now, there was **a great number of false prophets** suborned [bribed] by the tyrants [zealot leaders] to impose upon the people, who denounced this to them, that they should wait for deliverance from God: and this was in order to keep them from deserting, and they might be buoyed up above fear and care by such hopes."

Josephus states that the zealot leaders of the Jewish rebellion bribed several people to pretend to be prophets. During the war with Rome, these people were instructed to predict that God would deliver the Israelites from their enemies to inspire courage and prevent desertion. These prophecies proved to be false and in fulfillment of this prophecy of Jesus – **"many were deceived."**

The Roman army eventually conquered Jerusalem and destroyed its Temple; and there was not a "place in the city that had no dead bodies in it, but [the city] was entirely covered with those that were killed either by the famine or the rebellion." Josephus, ***War of the Jews***

These and other false prophets who acted before and during the Jewish War are also mentioned in these Scriptures:

First-century Jews are the audience here. The Apostle Peter wrote to them:

"But there were also **false prophets among the people**, even as there will be false teachers among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, even denying the Lord who bought them, and bring on themselves swift destruction. And many will follow their destructive ways, because of whom the way of truth will be blasphemed. By covetousness they will exploit you with deceptive words; for a long time their judgment has not been idle, and their destruction does not slumber." **(2 Peter 2:1-3)**

The Apostle John wrote this letter to the Early Church.

"Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits, whether they are of God; **because many false prophets have gone out into the world." (1 John 4:1)**

Section 10: **Matthew 24:12**

And because lawlessness will abound, the love of many

will grow cold.

The Israelites of the first century had turned their backs on God. In **Matthew 12:39**, Jesus calls His contemporaries "**a wicked and adulterous generation**." This is also mentioned by Josephus in ***War of the Jews:*** "Neither did any other city [Jerusalem] ever suffer such miseries, nor did any age ever breed a generation more fruitful in wickedness than this was, from the beginning of the world."

Section 11: **Matthew 24:13**

But he who endures to the end shall be saved.

The Greek word for **endures** is ***hypomeno*.** It means to abide and remain. The Greek word for **saved** is ***sozo*.** It means to rescue from danger and make well.

We know that Jesus saved the world on the Cross. However, in this passage He is specifically speaking of the destruction that is coming during the lifetime of the disciples– which occurred 40 years after the time of this prophecy. Here, Jesus is telling His disciples that those who abide in Him through all this tribulation will be rescued from the dangers of the coming destruction. This happened, as none of His followers joined with those who revolted. They all fled Jerusalem before the Roman Army arrived under general Titus to siege and destroy the city.

Section 12: **Matthew 24:14**

And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in all the world as a witness to all the nations, and then the end will come.

The Greek word for **world** here is ***oikoumene.*** It meant all the nations in the Roman Empire, including the land inhabited by the Greeks. It does not mean planet Earth.

It meant the Gospel would need to go forth into all the Roman Empire before the end of the Old (Mosaic) Covenant would come to an end by the destruction of Herod's Temple in AD 70.

The following Scriptures written by Paul prove the Gospel had been preached in all the world (Roman Empire).

Romans 1:8
"First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for you all, that **your faith is spoken of throughout the whole world**."

Romans 10:18
"But I say, have they not heard? **Yes indeed**: '**Their sound has gone out to all the earth, And their words to the ends of the world**.'"

Colossians 1:5,6
"...because of the hope which is laid up for you in heaven, of which you heard before in the word of **the truth of the gospel, which has come to you, as it has also in all the world, and is bringing forth fruit**, as it is also among you since the day you heard and knew the grace of God in truth..."

Colossians 1:23
"...if indeed you continue in the faith, grounded and steadfast, and are not moved away from the hope of **the gospel which you heard, which was preached to every creature under heaven,** of which I, Paul, became a minister."

Note: This fulfilled the Great Commission Jesus gave His disciples in Mark 16:15: "**Go into all the world, preach the gospel to every creature**."

Before the end of the Old (Mosaic) Covenant age, Jesus claimed that the gospel would be preached throughout the world. Paul confirmed in his letters this had been

fulfilled. Approximately five years after Paul's death in AD 65, the end had come as the Temple was destroyed in AD 70.

How could all the world have heard the gospel in that generation? As illustrated in Luke 2:1, the expression "**all the world**" simply means the known inhabited Roman world.

According to Luke 2:1 "**all the world**" was enrolled in the Roman census by orders of Caesar Augustus. "And it came to pass in those days that a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that **all the world should be registered.** This census first took place while Quirinius was governing Syria. So, all went to be registered, everyone to his own city." **(Luke 2:1-3)**

Did Caesar Augustus decree the whole planet be registered? Were the Native Americans in North America registered under Rome? Of course not. Yet, "world" is so often misinterpreted as "planet Earth" by those attempting to teach Bible Prophecy without understanding the original Greek language in which the Scriptures were written.

By the time of the Jewish Revolt in AD 66, the Gospel had spread from Britain to the Black Sea, from Gaul (France) to Galatia (Greece), and from Egypt to the banks of the Euphrates River, covering the Roman Empire into India where the apostle Thomas was martyred. We also see the expressions "all nations" and "every nation" mean those that make up the Roman Empire at that time in history.

"...but now made manifest, and by the prophetic Scriptures made known to **all nations**, according to the commandment of the everlasting God, for obedience to the faith..." **(Romans 16:26)**

"And there were dwelling in Jerusalem Jews, **devout men, from every nation** under heaven." **(Acts 2:5)**

Chapter 6

The Great Tribulation

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:15-28; Mark 13:14-23;

Luke 21:20-24

Section 1: **Matthew 24:15**

Therefore when you see the 'abomination of desolation,' spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing in the holy place (whoever reads, let him understand).

What did the prophet Daniel say about the **"abomination of desolation"**?

"And forces shall be mustered by him, and **they shall defile the sanctuary fortress**; then **they shall take away the daily sacrifices**, and place there the **abomination of desolation**." **(Daniel 11:31)**

Jesus said a sign of the end of the Old (Mosaic) Covenant would be when these things would happen in the **"holy place"**. That was a chamber inside the Temple in Jerusalem. There was the Outer Court, **Holy Place**, and the Holy of Holies. The Holy Place was where the Jewish priests would minister. In AD 70, the **"abomination of desolation"** was when the apostate Jewish priesthood stood in the Holy Place with the Roman (Gentile) Army.

The Synoptic passage in Luke 21:20 Jesus says this: "**And when you shall see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, then know that the desolation is near.**"

Keep in mind, Jesus is saying these things to His disciples on the Mount of Olives. When He says, "**when you shall see"** Jerusalem surrounded by armies – **"you"** means Peter, James, John, and Andrew **(Mark 13:3)** – not us. He is speaking to them about what they will see come to pass in their lifetimes.

When the Romans worshiped the image of Vespasian in Herod's Temple, General Titus ordered the army to slaughter all the people left in Jerusalem. The Roman Army was the **abomination** that brought **desolation**.

Section 2: **Matthew 24:16**

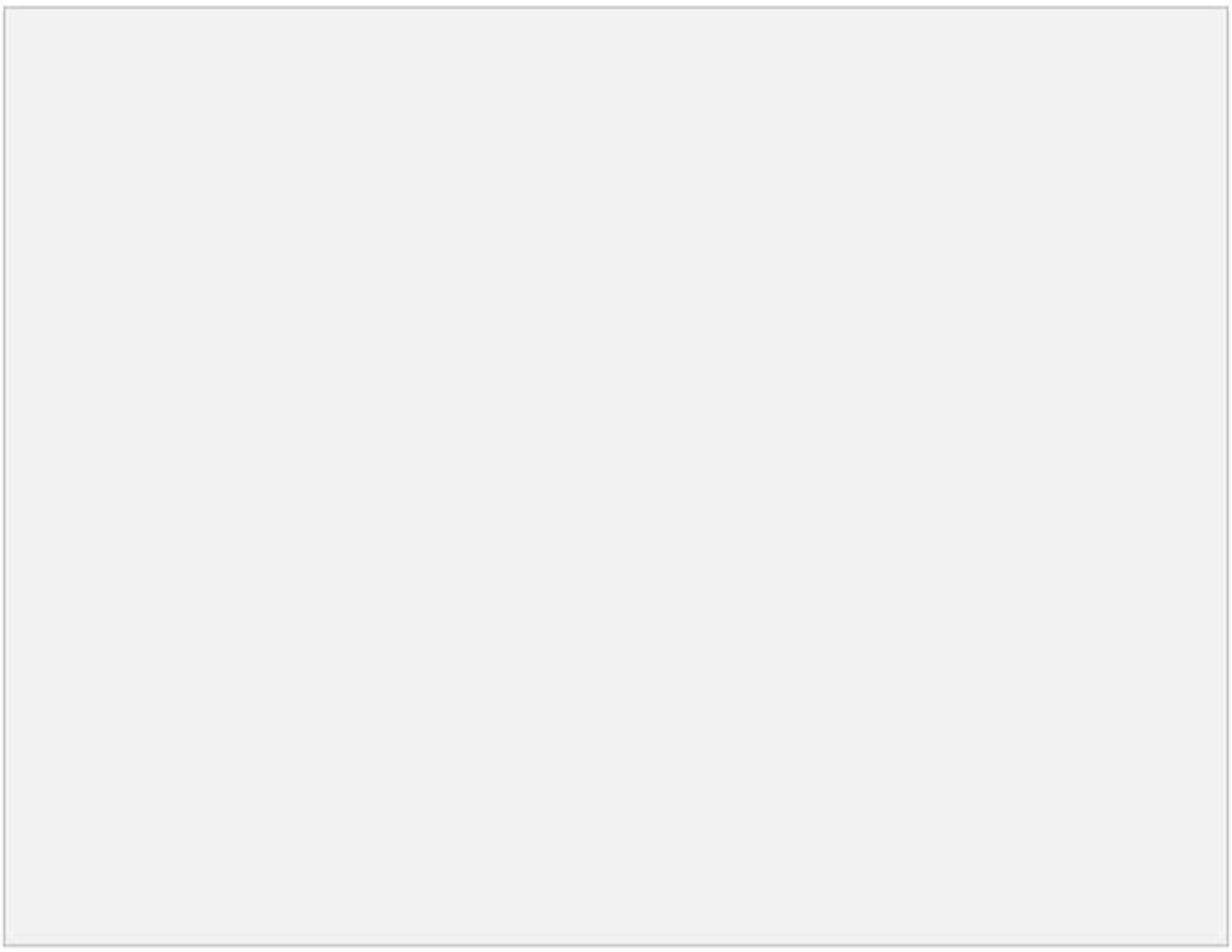
...then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains.

Because Jesus was giving these specific instructions to His disciples, they were very familiar with the mountain regions in Judea. This verse alone would remove all speculation of Matthew 24 being applied to any other place in the world.

The name Judea is a Greek and Roman adaptation of the name "Judah", which originally referred to the territory belonging to those in the tribe of Judah.

Judea is a mountainous region, part of which is considered a desert and sometimes used as the name for the entire region, including parts beyond the river Jordan.

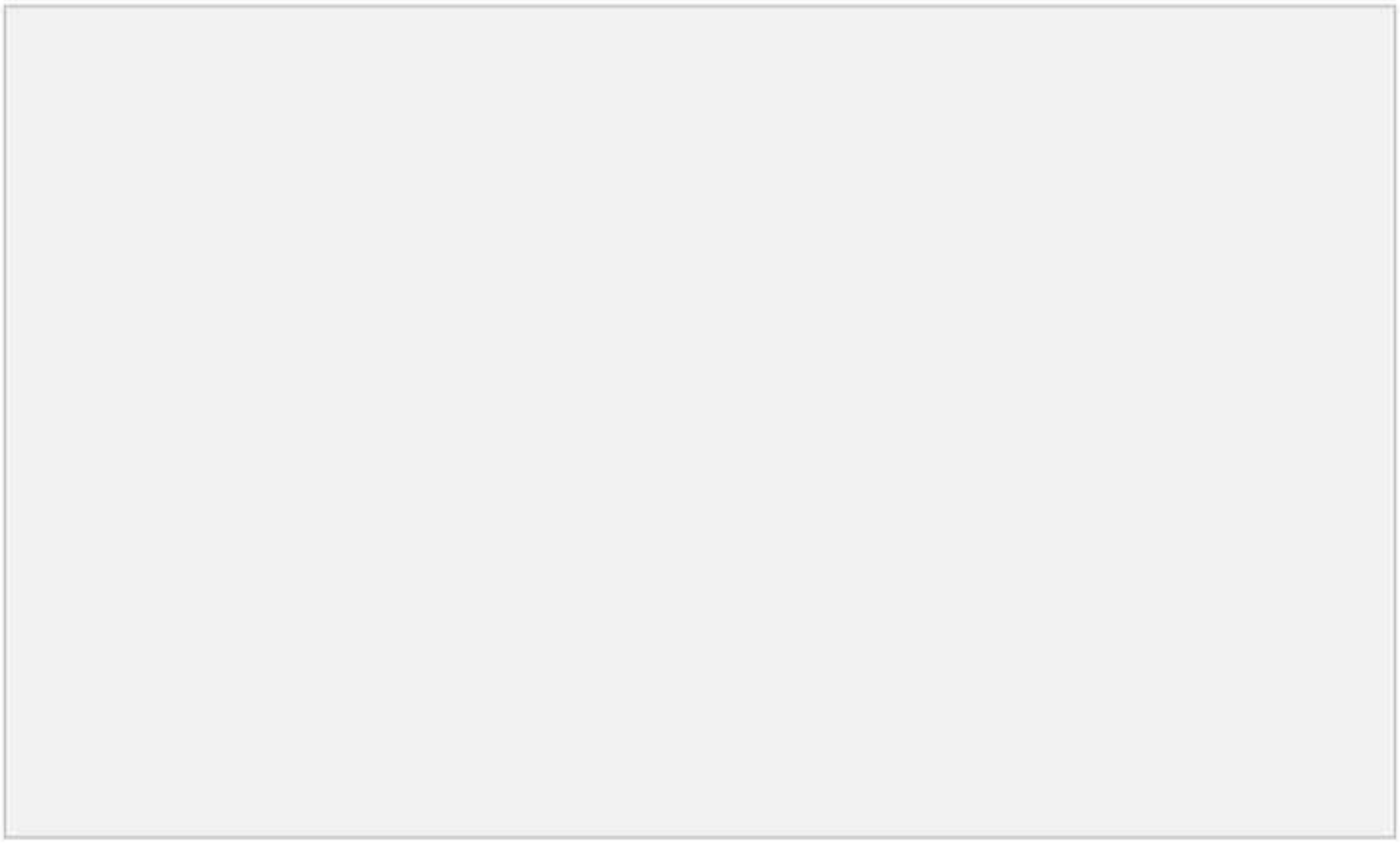
In 66 AD, the Jewish people rose up against Roman rule in a revolt that was unsuccessful. Jerusalem was burned in AD 70. Herod's Temple was destroyed, and those who did not flee to the mountains for safety were killed or enslaved. Fleeing to the mountains was taking the high ground—a position of less danger.



The mountains of Judea were south of Jerusalem.

Section 3: **Matthew 24:17**

Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of his house.



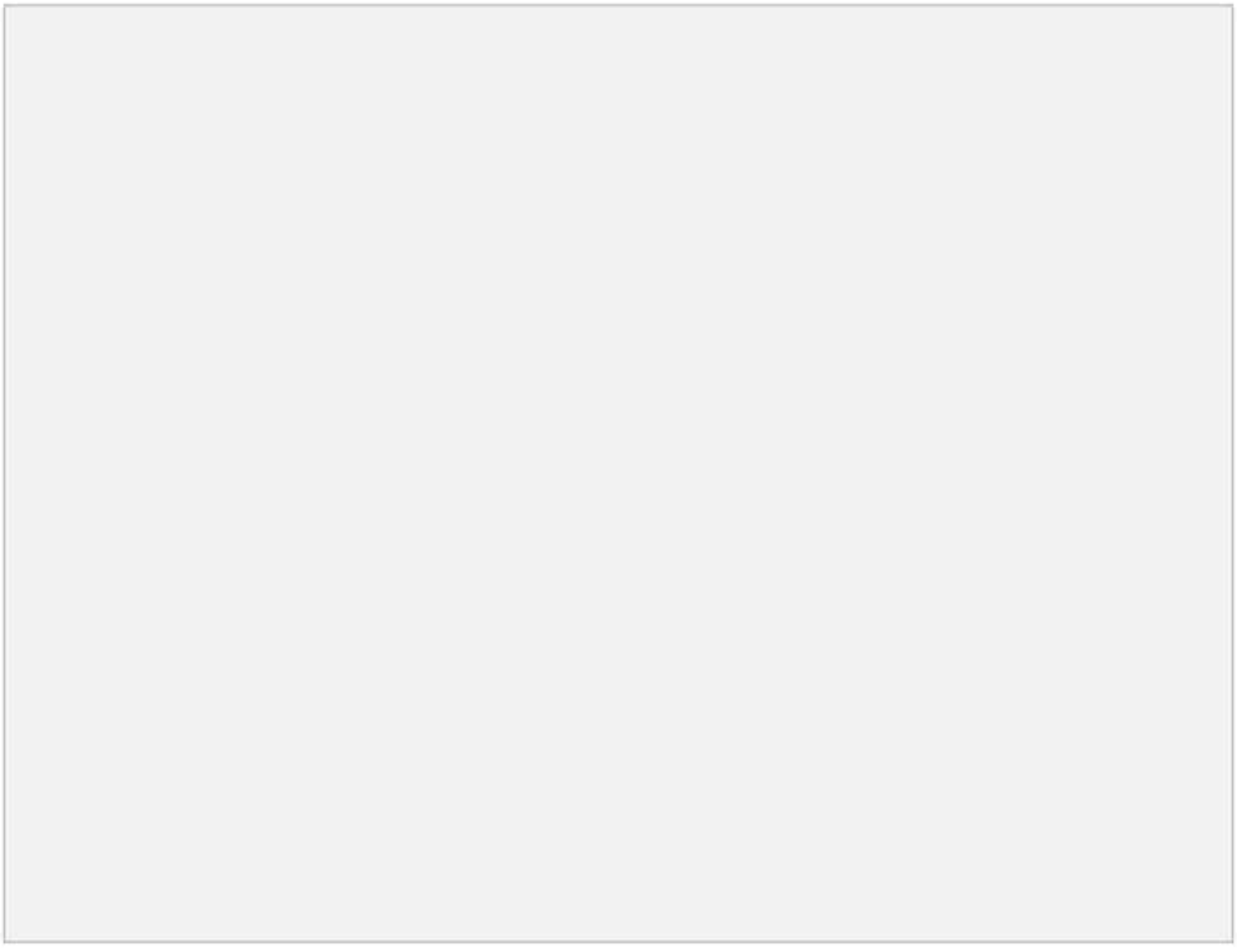
The homes in Ancient Israel had flat roofs where they would dry things in the sun like herbs, spices, and clothing. They would often have family meals on the house tops.

Knowing this historical fact reveals the time and location relevant to these instructions Jesus gave His disciples. Because it would be highly possible for people in first-century Judea to be on housetops as a lifestyle, they would be able to see the Roman Army approaching.

They were not to go down and take things out of the house, but rather be ready and be prepared to quickly flee to the mountains and escape danger.

Section 4: **Matthew 24:18**

And let him who is in the field not go back to get his clothes.



The fields were on low, flat land where the workers could be easily seen by the Roman Army. It would have been too dangerous to run back to their homes to gather clothes. Instead, they were to have extra clothes and supplies with them whenever they would go to the fields to work so they could flee to the mountains of Judea.

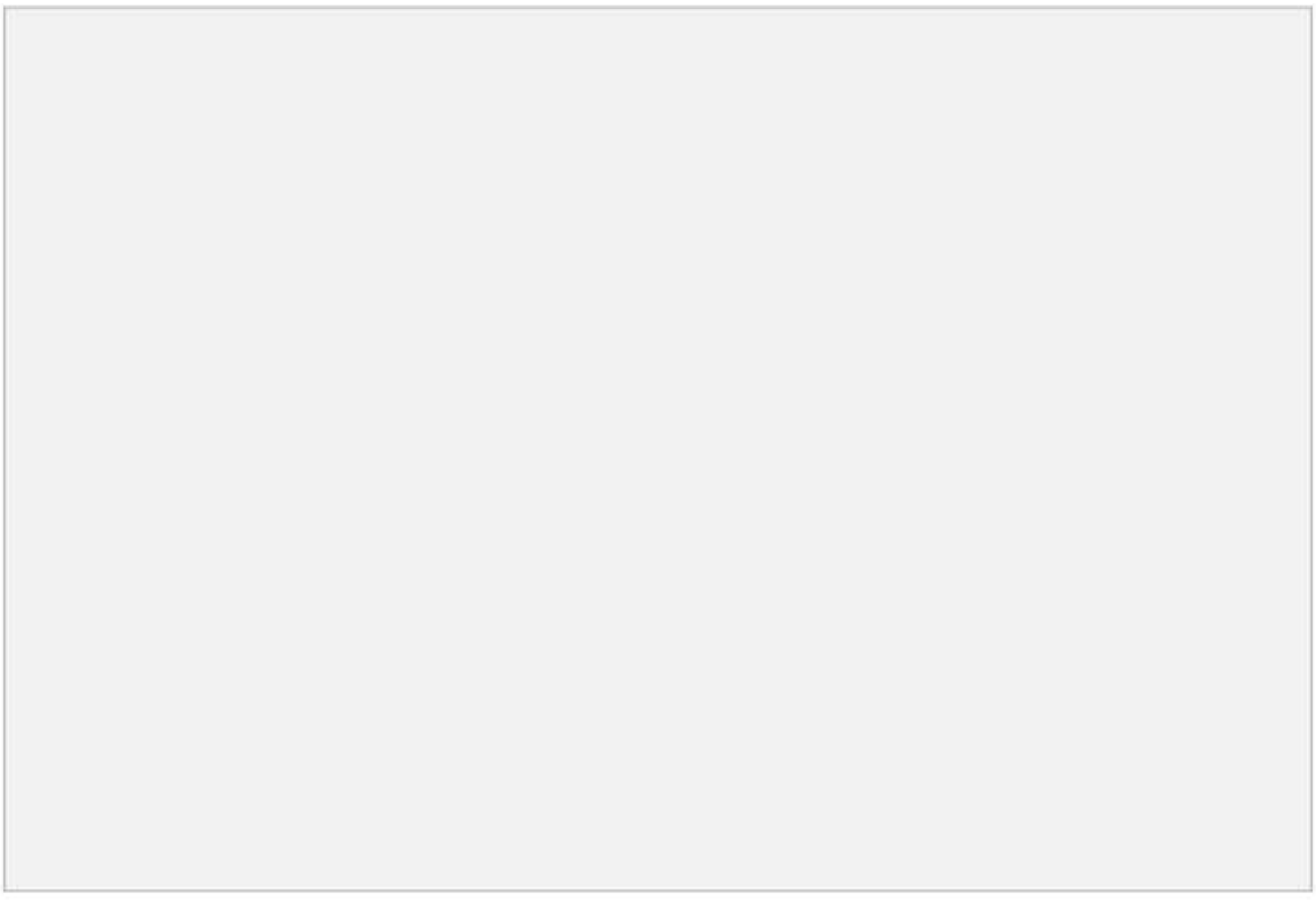
Section 5: **Matthew 24:19**

But woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing babies in those days!

Luke (a Greek physician) confirms this concern of Jesus as well. Mothers living in Israel had to make special preparations to flee when Rome invaded Jerusalem. They had to be mentally and emotionally stable to endure this dangerous situation.

From the time of this prophecy until the time they had to flee to the mountains was about 40 years. These things had to be taught to the younger women by the older women so that they would not forget what Jesus had taught them. Luke also wrote:

But woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing babies in those days! For there will be great distress in the land and wrath upon this people. (Luke 21:23)



Jesus warns the daughters of Jerusalem of apostate Israel's judgment to come on His way to the cross.

"And a great multitude of the people followed Him, and women who also mourned and lamented Him. But Jesus, turning to them, said, **'Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for Me, but weep for yourselves and for your children. For indeed the days**

are coming in which they will say, 'Blessed are the barren, wombs that never bore, and breasts which never nursed!' Then they will begin to say to the mountains, 'Fall on us!' and to the hills, 'Cover us!' For if they do these things in the green wood, what will be done in the dry? (Luke 23:27-31)

Because Matthew 24 has been incorrectly taught to be relevant to a modern-day church as opposed to its true first-century audience, Christian teens have had abortions based on this scripture. I was horrified to discover this years ago when speaking at a local high school and a cheerleader told me she wanted to have an abortion because Jesus said, "**woe to those who are pregnant in those days**." This young lady was told by her ministers that we were in "**those (last) days**." No telling how many children were aborted because of Dispensational Futuristic Eschatology.

Note: This story had a happy ending and I reveal it in "My Story" in Chapter 13 at the end of this book.

Section 6: **Matthew 24:20**

And pray that your flight may not be in winter or on the Sabbath.

The Greek word for flight is ***phyge*.** It means escape.

Winter Travel: For obvious reasons Jesus warned them not to travel in winter as adverse weather conditions would hamper an escape and put the people at risk facing the elements.

Sabbath Travel: The gates in Jerusalem were locked on the Sabbath in Jesus' day. He was concerned the Zealots would not allow the Christian Jews to leave the city. Also, the Law frowned on a long journey on the Sabbath. A "Sabbath's day walk" (Acts 1:12) was a short distance. Jesus told them to flee to the hills—a long journey.

Seeing this, a modern-day application seems ridiculous. Why would Jesus not want people 2,000 years later to buy plane tickets (flights) in winter on a Saturday or Sunday (depending on what you call "Sabbath")? Sadly, this has been the way some Bible Prophecy teachers have presented this. It truly is an insult to our intelligence, and we should refuse to support this erroneous idea now that we understand the true meaning of Jesus' words.

Section 7: **Matthew 24:21**

For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been since the beginning of the world until this time, no, nor ever shall be.

According to Jesus the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70 was **the great tribulation.** He explained it was worse than anything since the beginning of the **world** (***kosmos***-universe). Jesus also reassured His disciples that there would never again be another tribulation like this.

When people accept the fact that the destruction of the Temple and the sieging of Jerusalem by the Roman Army **was the great tribulation** spoken of in this verse, they will often include an idea that "history will repeat itself" in the future.

Clearly Jesus refuted that. It will not repeat itself. It was a one-time event.

The Great Tribulation is **not** in our future – it is in our past!
There will **never** be another Herod's Temple.
There will **never** be another Emperor Vespasian.
There will **never** be another Great Tribulation.
The Old (Mosaic) system of animal sacrifices **no longer exists.**

The prophecies of Jesus were **fulfilled just as He said they would be** within the time frame He specified – **during the generation of His disciples.**

The historian Josephus was an eyewitness of this great tribulation and he documented the things that went on during the war, which confirmed that the prophecies of Jesus were fulfilled.

"Women ate their own children from starvation; the Jews within the city fought each other as well as the Roman Army; on August 10, AD 70, the city was stormed and there was a universal massacre; 1,100,000 persons perished, and 100,000 survivors were sold into slavery." ***War of The Jews***

Some may argue that the holocaust was worse for the Jews than this, because six million Jews were killed by Nazis in Europe. Although the number of deaths in

WWII exceeds the number of deaths in AD 70, the holocaust was not due to God's judgment.

The destruction of Jerusalem was a result of a rebellious apostate priesthood who had abandoned the faith and become political. The Old (Mosaic) Covenant age was being brought to an end and the New Covenant was being established. There will never be a great tribulation in the land of Israel/Judea like there was in AD 70.

Note: In addition to Jewish casualties, five million non-Jews were killed during the holocaust by the Aryan ethnic cleansing efforts.

Section 8: **Matthew 24:22**

And unless those days were shortened, no flesh would be saved; but for the elect's sake those days will be shortened.

It seems that the arrival of the Roman Army outside of Jerusalem in AD 66 served as a sign for Christians in Jerusalem to flee the city at that time. The assault was cut short so that the saints would not meet the same fate as their persecutors.

The church historian Eusebius confirms that the church of Jerusalem was preserved during this war when he said that Christians fled to Pella before the siege of Jerusalem in AD 70. Some Christians were preserved from the tragedy of that siege, others were not as fortunate.

For example, the church of Jerusalem that was kept safe during the war appears to be the 144,000 of Revelation, chapter seven.

Yet after mentioning the preservation of the 144,000, Revelation 7:9-14 then goes on to say that "**a great multitude...from every nation, tribe, people and language**" came **"out of the great tribulation."**

The assault on Israel led by Vespasian and Titus lasted three and a half years, "forty-two months" as mentioned in Revelation 13:5, "**And he was given a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies, and he was given authority to continue for forty-two months.**"

Some Christians suffered throughout the Jewish War and the siege of Jerusalem of AD 70, but most escaped.

Section 9: **Matthew 24:23**

Then if anyone says to you, 'Look, here is the Christ!' or 'There!' do not believe it.

Jesus had cautioned His disciples against false christs and false prophets before, but He gives more specific caution against the time of the siege and destruction of Jerusalem.

Josephus, Tacitus and Suetonius – ancient historians – wrote about how Jesus' followers were being deceived and trapped in dangerous situations. In the scripture above, Jesus was protecting them by letting them know not to follow those who claimed they had special knowledge as to where Christ was.

Section 10: **Matthew 24:24**

For false Christs and false prophets will rise and show great signs and wonders to deceive, if possible, even the elect.

As the Temple literally was burning, Josephus records, "Of so great a multitude, not one escaped. Their destruction was caused by a **false prophet**, who had on that day proclaimed to those remaining in the city, that 'God commanded them to go up to the Temple, there to receive the signs of their deliverance.' There were at this time many prophets suborned (bribed) by the tyrants to delude the people, by bidding them to wait for help from God, in order that there might be less desertion, and that those who were above fear and control might be encouraged by hope.

Under calamities man readily yields to persuasion; but when the deceiver pictures to him deliverance from pressing evils, then the sufferer is wholly influenced by hope. It was that the impostors and pretended messengers of heaven at that time beguiled the wretched people." Josephus***, War of the Jews***

We also find in Luke's account in the Book of Acts the following proof of the fulfillment of Jesus' prophecy in Matthew 24:24.

Acts 8:9-11

"But there was **a certain man, called Simon, which before time in the same city used sorcery, and bewitched the people of Samaria**, claiming that he was someone great...."

Acts 13:6

"Now when they had gone through the island to Paphos, they found **a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew whose name was Bar-Jesus**..."

Acts 13:8

"But **Elymas the sorcerer (for that is what his name means) opposed them** and tried to turn the proconsul from the faith."

Section 11: **Matthew 24:25**

See, I have told you beforehand.

God's prophetic nature shines light to show us the path ahead. This is why we see a pattern in Scripture to this effect.

"Surely the Lord GOD does nothing, Unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets." **(Amos 3:7)**

Jesus said: **"However, when He, the Spirit of truth, has come, He will guide you into all truth; for He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak; and He will tell you things to come." (John 16:13)**

Jesus told His disciples the things which were to come because it was relevant to them as they would be alive and witness these things take place. Jesus did not want them to be unprepared to face the specific danger and deception that was to come. He wanted them to be well-informed and wise.

Section 12: **Matthew 24:26**

Therefore if they say to you, 'Look, He is in the desert!' do not go out; or 'Look, He is in the inner rooms!' do not believe it.

It is understandable that people would be desperate during the great tribulation. They most likely were looking for a Moses-like deliverer to remove them from such horrible persecution. Jesus warned them not to follow false prophets into the **desert** and **inner rooms** of the Temple. Sadly, some did not adhere. The reason Jesus warned His disciples not to go out into the **desert** to meet these false Messiahs is because many who followed these men were killed or captured there by the Jewish civil authorities.

"The Roman Commander mistook Paul for an Egyptian false prophet saying: 'Are you not the Egyptian who some time ago stirred up a rebellion and led the four thousand assassins out into the wilderness?'" (Acts 21:38)

Josephus wrote about this in ***War of the Jews***: A false Egyptian prophet led 4,000 assassins into the desert, but they were taken or destroyed by the Roman governor Felix. Also Jonathan, a weaver, led many to follow him in the **desert**, but he was taken and burned alive by Vespasian.

In the ***Antiquities of the Jews*** by Josephus, he wrote how false prophets led followers to believe they would be delivered by entering the inner rooms of the Temple. Josephus writes: "A multitude of men, women, and children, went up; accordingly, but instead of deliverance, the place was set on fire by the Romans and 6,000 perished miserably in the flames."

Section 13: **Matthew 24:27**

For as the lightning comes from the east and flashes to the west, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be.

The word "**coming**" in Greek is ***Parousia***. It means **presence**. ***Parousia*** is used four times: Matthew 24:3, 27, 37 and 39.

The **coming / presence /*Parousia*** of Christ would strike fast, fiercely, and be visible for all to recognize, perceive and understand. His coming presence would set things right by His judgment upon that wicked generation and its corrupt religious system of death.

Jesus mentions this again in Matthew 26:64: "**It is as you said. Nevertheless, I say to you, hereafter you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Power, and coming on the clouds of heaven.**"

Even Caiaphas, the apostate high priest would understand that this ***Parousia*/coming presence** upon **figurative clouds of judgment** was prophetic language, common among the Jews.

Here are more scriptures referring to clouds of judgment:

Isaiah 19:1 - The prophecy against Egypt:

"Behold, **the Lord rides on a swift cloud**, and will come into Egypt; The idols of Egypt will shake at His presence, And the heart of Egypt will melt in its midst."

Psalm 18:11-14 - David's deliverance from Saul:
"He made darkness His secret place;
His canopy around Him was dark waters
And thick clouds of the skies.
From the brightness before Him,
His thick clouds passed with hailstones and coals of fire.
The LORD thundered from heaven,
And the Most High uttered His voice,
Hailstones and coals of fire.
He sent out His arrows and scattered the foe,
Lightnings in abundance, and He vanquished them."

In AD 66, the Roman Army entered Judea on the **east** side and carried on their conquest **westward**, being compared to the **"lightning flashing from the east to the west,"** as Jesus clearly stated.

Section 14: **Matthew 24:28**

For wherever the carcass is, there the eagles will be gathered together.

This has both a literal meaning and a symbolic prophetic meaning. First the literal meaning: the dead were not buried during the Jewish Revolt and the Roman siege of Jerusalem, so they literally became the food that the eagles would have survived on, just as Jesus said.

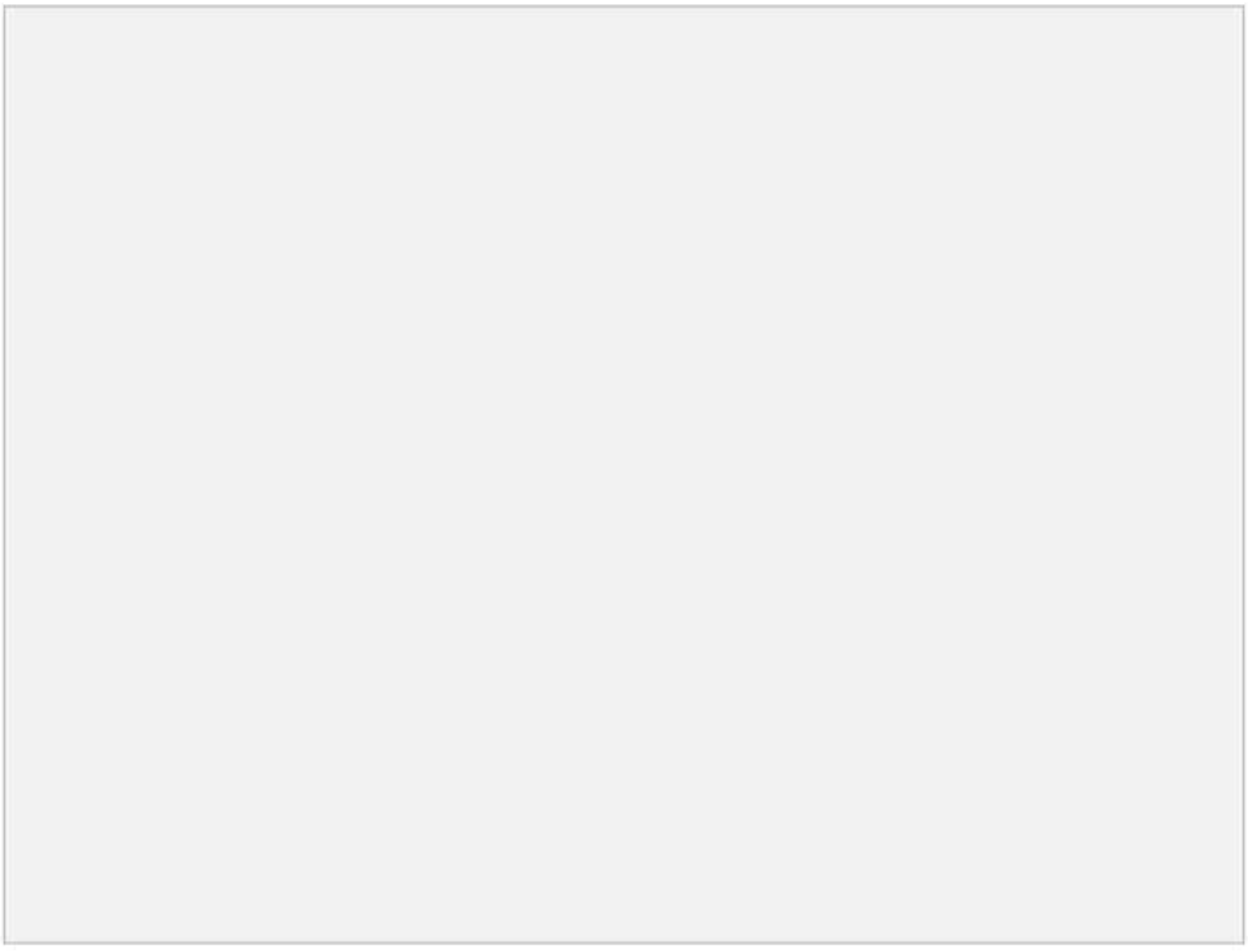
Just prior to the fall of Jerusalem, the remaining Jewish rebels fled to the Temple fortress for refuge. Eventually the Romans broke into the Temple causing a great massacre. Concerning the aftermath, Josephus writes:

"Nor was there any place in the city [of Jerusalem] that had no dead bodies in it, but what was entirely covered with those that were killed either by the famine or the rebellion; and all was full of the dead bodies of such as had perished, either by that sedition or by that famine." Josephus, ***War of the Jews***

These unburied bodies became physical food for the eagles. However, the symbolic, prophetic implication of this verse in Matthew 24:28 explains it's past fulfillment in the first century.

Now the symbolic prophetic meaning: **"the carcass"** in this verse implies **the Temple**, which as indicated at the beginning of this chapter was soon to be demolished.

The eagle was the national symbol of Rome. When the Romans seized the Temple in AD 70 they carried their ensigns into the temple courts. Rome's main ensign was the Aquila, an eagle, pictured below. The Roman army offered sacrifices to these eagle images representing Rome, while the Temple was in flames. With these literal and symbolic interpretations, we appreciate the richness of what Jesus meant when he said, **"Wherever there is a carcass, there the eagles will gather."**



The Aquila (Eagle), Roman Military Symbol

SPQR - Senatus Populus Que Romanus

Chapter 7

Coming of the Son of Man

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:29-31; Mark 13:24-27;

Luke 21:25-28

The Coming (*Parousia*) of Christ was Expected in the First Century:

Matthew 10:23

The disciples had no time to travel before His coming.

Matthew 16:28

Some in His audience would still be alive.

Matthew 24:34

Christ would come during the generation of the first Christians.

Matthew 24:44

Christ instructed the first Christians to be prepared for His coming.

Matthew 26:64

The Jewish High Council would see Christ come.

John 21:22

The apostle John would still be alive.

Romans 13:12

The day was at hand.

1 Corinthians 1:7

The Corinthians waited eagerly for Christ.

1 Corinthians 1:8

Christ would keep the Corinthians blameless until He comes.

1 Corinthians 7:29

The time was short.

1 Corinthians 10:11

The end of the age had come to the Christians.

2 Thessalonians 1:6-8

The Thessalonians would find relief at His coming.

Hebrews 1:2

The first Christians were in the last days.

Hebrews 10:37

It would only be a little while, Christ would not delay.

James 5:9

The judge was already at the door.

1 Peter 4:7

The end was near.

1 John 2:18

They were in the last hour.

Revelation 1:1

Everything would take place shortly.

Revelation 3:10

Christ encouraged the first Christians to hold on until His coming.

Revelation 22:20

Jesus promised the first Christians He would come quickly.

When Jesus said He was **"coming in the clouds,"** the apostate Jewish priesthood accused Him of blasphemy. Why? They knew He was claiming deity! His ***Parousia* (coming)** was going to be in the same way God had always come before in the Old Testament. He was making Himself equal to Yahweh.

It was Yahweh Who was the great cloud rider in judgment.

A Prophecy Against Egypt.

"Behold**, the LORD rides on a swift cloud**, and will come into Egypt; The idols of Egypt will totter at His presence, And the heart of Egypt will melt in its midst. "I will set Egyptians against Egyptians; Everyone will fight against his brother, And everyone against his neighbor, City against city, kingdom against kingdom." **(Isaiah 19:1-2)**

The Lord punishes the guilty on clouds of dust.

"The Lord is slow to anger and great in power, And the Lord will by no means leave the guilty unpunished. In the whirlwind and in the storm the Lord has His way, and **clouds are the dust beneath His feet." (Nahum 1:3)**

God rides on the clouds.

"There is none like the God of Jeshurun, **who rides on the heavens to your help, and in His majesty on the clouds." God sets the clouds as His chariots (Psalm 104:3).**

"He lays the beams of His upper rooms in the waters. **He sets the clouds as His chariots**; He walks on the wings of the wind…" **(Deuteronomy 33:26)**

Note: The apostate Jews accused Jesus of blasphemy because He was claiming that His coming (***Parousia***) was going to be in the same way that God had always come before, making Himself equal to Yahweh.

Jesus said: **"Most assuredly, I say to you, the Son can do nothing of Himself, but what He sees the Father do; for whatever He does, the Son also does in like manner." (John 5:19)**

Clearly, the Father did not come physically in the clouds. He spiritually rode on the clouds in judgment. Any time God used a nation to destroy and judge another nation in the Old Testament, it is described as God coming down and riding on clouds. Jesus

did the same at His coming through Rome's siege and destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70.

Like Father, like Son; Jesus' ***Parousia*** was in the same manner as Yahweh in the Old Testament, bringing judgment upon the Old (Mosaic) Covenant apostate Israel, destroying and removing the Temple and the Law of Moses, and therefore bringing salvation for those believers in Christ Jesus who were eagerly waiting for Him in the first century.

Section 1: **Matthew 24:29**

Immediately after the tribulation of those days the sun will be darkened, and the moon will not give its light; the stars will fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken.

Sun will be darkened.
Moon will not give its light.
Stars will fall from heaven.
Powers of the heavens will be shaken.

We must understand this is symbolic prophetic language understood by those who knew the Old Testament Scriptures – the Jews in the Early Church. Look at the first mention of "two great lights": sun, moon and stars.

"Then God said, 'Let there be **lights in the firmament** of the heavens to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs and seasons, and for days and years; and let them be for lights in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth;' and it was so. Then God made **two great lights**: the greater light to **govern** the day, and the lesser light to **govern** the night. He made the **stars** also.'" **(Genesis 1:14-16)**

Look at the prophetic symbolism in Joseph's dream:

"Then he [Joseph] had another dream, and he told it to his brothers. 'Listen,' he said, 'I had another dream, and this time the **sun** and **moon** and eleven **stars** were bowing down to me.'" **(Genesis 37:9)**

His Father, Jacob, had the interpretation:

"When he told his father as well as his brothers, his father rebuked him and said, 'What is this dream you had? **Will your mother and I and your brothers actually come and bow down to the ground before you**?'" **(Genesis 37:10)**

The answer to the question became apparent years later, as the dream was prophetic. Joseph eventually became governor, ruling over the whole land of Egypt and the

dream was fulfilled in **Genesis 42:6-9.** Those who ruled over Joseph became ruled by him. Beyond the prophetic symbolism of "sun, moon, and stars" – known also as governing bodies – are the omens the Jews in Ancient Israel recognized to be judgment, war and the end of an age.

Celestial omens mark the fall of kingdoms in the Bible. When Jesus said, **"the sun and moon will be darkened and the stars fall from the sky,"** He was referring to the times this had occurred some 600 years earlier as recorded by the prophets in the Old Testament:

The fall of Babylon - **Isaiah 13:9-13**
The fall of Edom - **Isaiah 34:4-5**
The fall of Judah - **Jeremiah 4:23-26**
The fall of Egypt - **Ezekiel 32:7-9**

And just as the fall of these kingdoms were met with heavenly omens, the same was going to happen in the fall of Jerusalem at the end of the Old Covenant age. We know this was fulfilled in AD 70.

The reason the sun and moon darken and the stars disappear at the fall of various kingdoms in the Bible, as predicted in Matthew 24:29, is because these are all unavoidable signs marking the coming of God on the clouds in judgment. Whenever God came on the clouds of heaven, the sun, moon and stars would all darken.

According to **Psalm 18:7-14** when God came on the clouds in judgment on a city, He rode dark storm clouds, accompanied by lightning and thunder that often masked the brightness of His appearance.

"The **earth trembled and quaked**, and the foundations of the mountains shook; they trembled because He was angry… He parted the heavens and came down; dark clouds were under his feet. He mounted the cherubim and flew; he soared on the wings of the **wind**. **He made darkness his covering, His canopy around him—the dark rain clouds of the sky** out of the brightness of His presence **clouds advanced**, with hailstones and bolts of **lightning**. The Lord **thundered** from heaven, the voice of the Most High resounded. He shot his arrows and scattered the enemy; with great bolts of **lightning,** He routed them."

The dark storm clouds that mark the presence of the Lord reflect clouds in judgment and are presumably the cause of the darkening of the sun and moon mentioned in Matthew 24:29 and the lightning in verse 27. The fact that the storm clouds marked the coming of the Lord on the clouds in judgment on a nation were the reason that the sun, moon and stars were darkened.

This is clearly stated in **Ezekiel 32:7:**

"When I snuff you out, I will **cover** the heavens and **darken their stars**; I will **cover the sun with a cloud**, and **the moon will not give its light**."

Perhaps "the sign of the Son of Man" that "will appear in the sky" are all the signs mentioned above? The darkening of the sun, moon and stars (verse 29), lightning (verse 27), and the shaking of the heavenly bodies all normally follow a violent thunderstorm.

Violent storms are also generally accompanied by lightning like that predicted in verse 27 as well as thunder which appears to shake the sky just as predicted in verse 29: **"and the heavenly bodies will be shaken."** When the Jews saw all these signs in the absence of a rainbow **(Genesis 9:12-16)**, they feared that God might be coming in judgment.

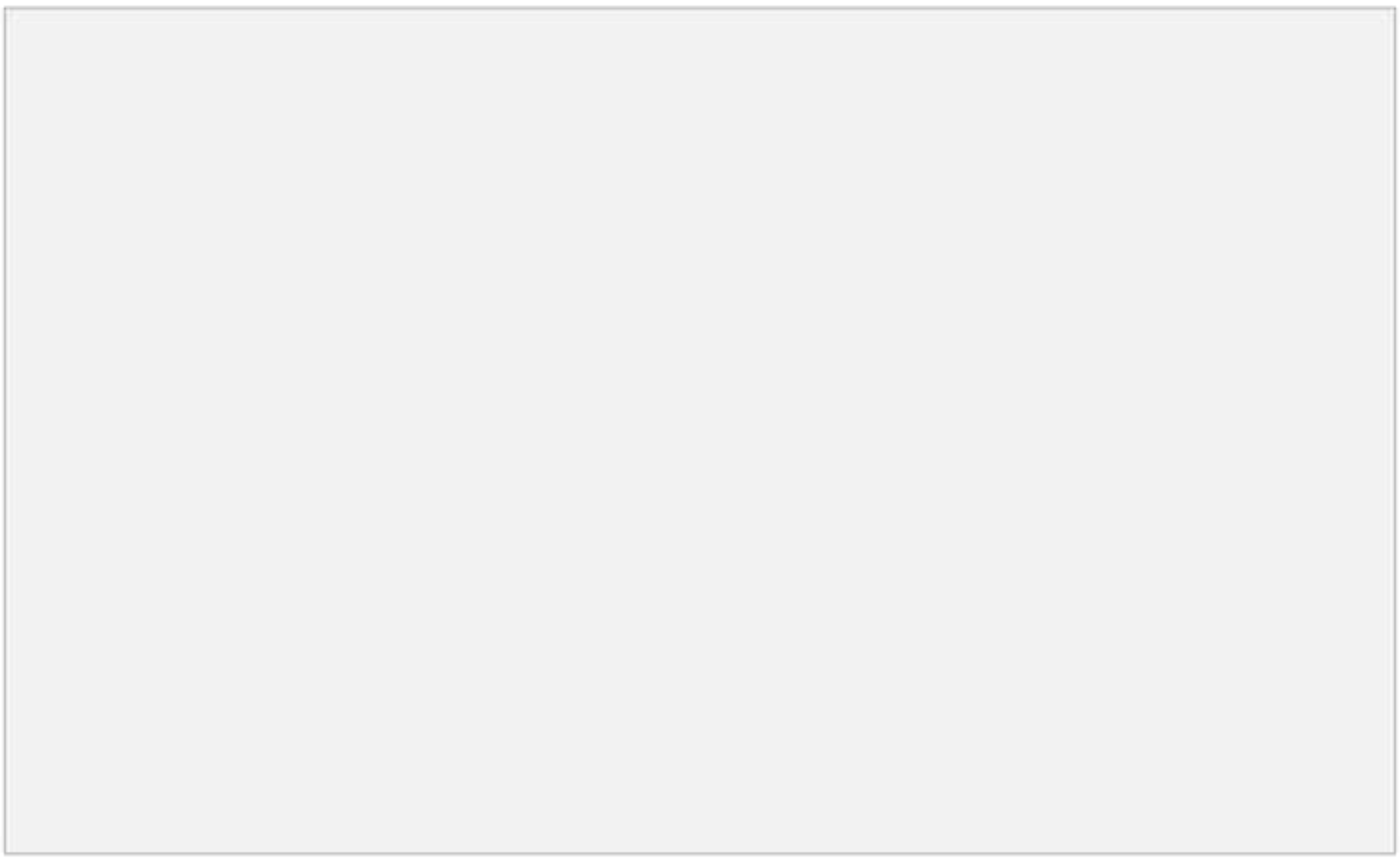
Now we see more clearly what was meant by **"Immediately after the tribulation of those days the sun will be darkened, and the moon will not give its light; the stars will fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken."**

This meant immediately after the Temple was destroyed (the tribulation), there would be an end of the age (the Mosaic Covenant age) and the beginning of the everlasting kingdom of the New Covenant – to which there would be no end.

"Unto Him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen." (Ephesians 3:21)

Section 2: **Matthew 24:30**

Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.



Here Jesus is using language His disciples understood to mean God's judgment on the oppressive Jewish leaders in the Temple.

The expression, "**coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory**" – meant a war that God allowed to bring judgment, just like He did 600 years earlier.

When Jesus said, all the **"tribes of the earth will mourn" –** He was speaking of the 13 tribes of the earth (Israel): Judah, Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Zebulun, Issachar, Dan, Gad, Asher, Naphtali, Ephraim, Benjamin and Manasseh.

The Greek word for **earth** is ***ge*.** It means land. The only Land recognized by the Jews was the Land of Judea: Israel. All other places on earth were not even acknowledged. They would have been called "foreign lands." However, ***ge* meant Judea** to the first century Jews, This makes sense because **"all the tribes of the earth" would mean all the 13 tribes of Israel (Judea).**

Summary:

"The Sign" - Destruction of Jerusalem AD 70.

“Son of Man” - Jesus Christ.

“All the Tribes of the Earth” - Jewish People / Land.

“Coming in the Clouds” - judgment Metaphor.

Section 3: **Matthew 24:31**

And He will send His angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they will gather together His elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.

To understand what Jesus was saying to His disciples about the coming destruction of the Temple, we have to know what He meant by certain terms like, "**gathering angels**", "**sound of a trumpet**", "**elect**", and "**four winds.**"

Angels in Greek is ***angelos (aggelos).***

It means special **messengers** sent by God**.**

(Matthew 11:10, Mark 1:12, Luke 7:24, James 2:25)

Trumpet in Greek is ***salpigx.*** It means a **quivering vibration**. It was for bringing the people into oneness in victory for a purpose and it announced God's presence.

(Exodus 19:16, Numbers 10:3, Isaiah 27:12-13)

1 Corinthians 14:8 –Trumpets to prepare for battle.
Revelation 1:10 – The voice of God as a trumpet.
Revelation 8:13 – Trumpets given to angels.

Elect in Greek is ***eklektos.*** It means **chosen because they accepted salvation.**
Romans 8:33 – Believers are elect. **1 Timothy 5:21** – Messengers are elect.
Titus 1:1 – Believers are elect. **1 Peter 2:9** – Chosen generation are elect.

Four winds is an expression meaning all directions within the territories of the Jewish people, north, south, east and west.

"Against Elam I will bring the **four winds** from the four quarters of heaven, **and scatter them toward all those winds;** There shall be no nations where the outcasts of Elam will not go." **(Jeremiah 49:36)**

Jeremiah said the **four winds** would be brought upon Elam and they would be scattered **to those four winds**, to every nation (tribes of Israel). Jesus said His angels would gather the elect **from the four winds**, from all nations. One is a scattering **to** the four winds; the other is gathering **from** the four winds. One is a punishment; the other is a reward.

Elam was a descendant of Shem. **Elam** means hidden.

Jesus' disciples understood Him to mean He will send His angels (messengers) with a great sound of a trumpet, and they will gather together **His elect (first century believers) from the four winds (every nation-tribes of Israel), from one end of heaven (the dwelling place of God – His Spirit) to the other.**

Chapter 8

This Generation

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:32-35; Mark 13:28-31;

Luke 21:29-33

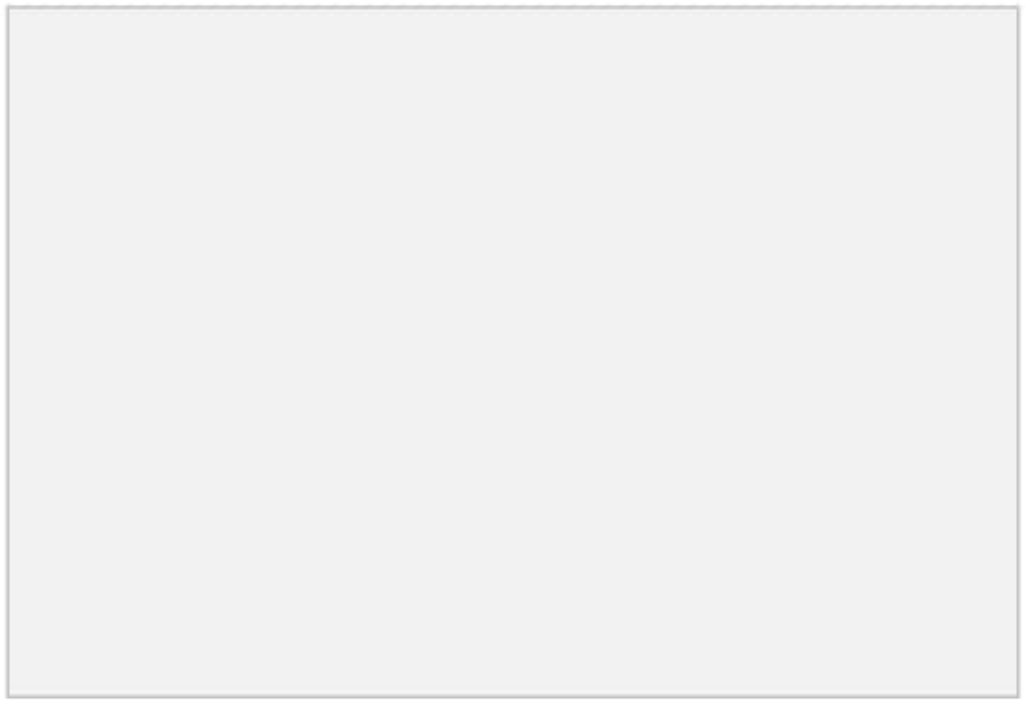
Section 1: **Matthew 24:32**

Now learn this parable from the fig tree: When its branch has already become tender and puts forth leaves, you know that summer is near.

Jesus is giving His disciples a specific time reference on when these things will be taking place. Note that previously He said **(Matthew 24:20)** it would be difficult to escape the danger during the winter. This reassures them they should prepare to flee to the mountains of Judea in the springtime.

The historian Josephus in his ***War of the Jews*** describes the time when the Roman general Titus began his siege of Jerusalem. **A few days before Passover, on April 14,** three Roman legions surrounded the city on the western side, and a fourth legion on the Mount of Olives to the east. It was at this time a vast number of people had come to celebrate **Passover in the springtime.**

The budding of the fig tree was a noticeable sign of the war that was sure to come. Those who heeded Jesus' words were spared but those who ignored them sadly met their demise.



Section 2: **Matthew 24:33**

So you also, when you see all these things, know that it is near—at the doors!

Remember when Jesus said, **"you,"** He is not speaking to a modern-day audience. He is speaking to the four disciples sitting with Him on the Mount of Olives. Their names

are not mentioned in Matthew, however in **Mark 13:3** they are identified as **Peter, James, John and Andrew**. We must continually recognize this throughout the entire Olivet Discourse to understand that this prophecy was for the first-century people who lived in Judea, governed by the Roman Empire.

James, the brother of Jesus used this same illustration, **"standing at the door"** to speak to his brethren of the nearness of the Lord's coming (***Parousia*** – presence). The disciples in the first century were anticipating the coming of Christ just like He promised He would come in their lifetime.

"Therefore be patient, brethren, until the **coming** of the Lord. See how the farmer waits for the precious fruit of the earth, waiting patiently for it until it receives the early and latter rain. You also be patient. Establish your hearts, for the **coming** of the Lord is at hand. Do not grumble against one another, brethren lest you be condemned. **Behold, the Judge is standing at the door!" (James 5:7-9)**

Section 3: **Matthew 24:34**

Assuredly, I say to you, this generation will by no means pass away till all these things take place.

The pattern continues with Jesus saying **"you"** to His disciples. since this prophecy was the answer to a question, they asked Him in **Matthew 24:3** - "Tell **us**, when will these things be? And what will be the sign of Your coming, and of the end of the age?"

Jesus said, **"this generation"** meaning the generation He was speaking to that day on the Mount of Olives.

"This" means something is near, in close proximity.

"That" means something is far, at a distance.

Jesus said **"this"** not "that."

If He was speaking of a generation 2,000 years in the future, He would have said, "that generation." Instead, He was referring to the generation near and close to Him when He said, **"this generation."**

The word **generation** in Greek is ***genea*.**

It means those living at the same time.

Genea – Defined in Greek-English lexicons:

Thayer's Greek-English Lexicon –
"The whole multitude living at the same time."

Arndt and Gingrich Greek-English Lexicon –
"...basically, the sum total of those born at the same time, expanded to include all those living at a given time. Contemporaries."

Obviously, it would be absurd to conclude that Jesus was addressing a modern-day Church. Yet, how many times do we hear people quote Jesus in Matthew 24 as though we are living in the "last days" and the "end times?" It is ridiculous to think so after applying comprehensive reading skills and logic.

Various Bible translations bring even more clarity:

New English Bible: **"I tell you this: the present generation will live to see it all."**

Today's English Version: **"Remember this! All these things will happen before the people now living have all died."**

Moffatt's Translation: **"I tell you truly, the present generation will not pass away, till all this happens."**

Weymouth's Translation: "**I tell you in solemn truth that this present generation will certainly not pass away until all this has taken place."**

One Bible translation that has served to mislead many people for over a century is the ***Scofield Reference Bible***. In the margin notes of his bible, **C.I. Scofield switched the word "genea," which means those living at the same time, to "genos," which means race** (and he referred to the Jews as a race of people). This was ridiculous as Jews were scattered all over the world. There were Ethiopian Jews, Arab Jews and Roman Jews. Sadly, entire denominations are still affected by this misguided translation of the term "**generation"** in Matthew 24:34.

The ***Scofield Reference Bible*** was printed by the Oxford Press in 1909 – owned by the Rothschilds – who were self-acclaimed Zionists. Their obvious intentions were to tamper with the New Testament to carry out their political agenda just before World War I. Those bibles were distributed to the soldiers thinking the world was coming to an end.

A generation is 40 years. Most Bible scholars agree that **a generation is forty years** based on many scriptures like these that set a precedent:

Genesis 25:20

Isaac was **forty years** old when he took Rebekah as his wife.

Exodus 16:35

The sons of Israel ate manna **forty years.**

Numbers 32:13

God made them (children of Israel) wander in the wilderness **forty years** until all the generation which had done evil in the sight of Jehovah was destroyed.

Deuteronomy 29:5

I have led you **forty years** in the wilderness.

Judges 3:11

And the land had rest **forty years**.

Ezekiel 29:12

"And I will make the land of Egypt a ruin in the midst of the ruined lands; and her cities shall be deserted **forty years** among the cities that are laid waste."

1 Kings 2:11

The days that David "reigned over Israel were **forty years**. Seven years he reigned in Hebron, and thirty-three years in Jerusalem."

1 Kings 11:42

"And the days that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel were **forty years.**"

Acts 13:21

"And afterward they asked for a king. And God gave them Saul the son of Kish, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, for **forty years**."

Note: Jesus was 33 years old when He told His disciples their generation would not pass away until all the things He prophesied on the Mount of Olives were fulfilled. We know this was fulfilled in AD 70 within the time window of a 40-year generation.

Section 4: **Matthew 24:35**

Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will by no means pass away.

Jesus was not referring to literal earth and literal heaven passing away. After all, if heaven were to pass away, where would God live? When making an effort to understand concepts like these, we must look to ancient historians who help us identify things common to those to whom Jesus was speaking – living in the first-century Jewish culture.

Jewish people in the first century understood the Tabernacle had three separate divisions: The Outer Court, the Holy Place, and the Holy of Holies. The Holy of Holies was where the ark of the covenant was placed containing the presence of God. The Holy Place was where the priests ministered to the Lord, and The Outer Court was where everyone outside the priesthood gathered.

Jesus' disciples would have known exactly what He was saying when He spoke of "**heaven and earth**" as those were sections of the Tabernacle of Moses which became linked to the Temple.

The Tabernacle of Moses, pictured above, was the pattern for Solomon's Temple which became the model for Herod's Temple on a much larger scale. (See Appendix C)

Jesus was declaring the destruction of Herod's Temple: "**heaven and earth will pass away."** However, He added that **"My words will by no means pass away."**

Knowing this brings a whole new level of understanding to the following verse in Revelation as it was also speaking of the destruction of the Temple in AD 70.

"Now I saw a **new heaven and a new earth,** for the first **heaven and the first earth had passed away**. Also, there was no more sea." **(Revelation 21:1)**

Once we see that "the first heaven and earth" was depicting the Holy of Holies (heaven) and the Holy Place (earth) in Herod's Temple that was destroyed – we are

then able to see the **new heaven and new earth** as the new Temple not made by human hands – the new dwelling place of God – in the Body of Christ, the Church!

We are the new heaven and the new earth. We are the new Jerusalem. The Church is the new creation in Christ Who is the Word of God that **will not pass away.**

Chapter 9

No One Knows The Day Or Hour

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:36-44; Mark 13:32-37;

Luke 21:34-36

Section 1: **Matthew 24:36**

But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven, but My Father only.

No one knew the day or the hour all these things would take place, but they understood it would be within their lifetime. The disciples who were with Jesus that day on the Mount of Olives were young. Jesus was not any older than 33. Peter, James, John and Andrew were younger than Jesus. We don't think of them as younger men, but they were.

According to Josephus, Peter was twenty years old when he started following Jesus. His younger brother Andrew would have been in his late teens, as well as James and John. Their generation would live to see the worst tribulation Israel would ever know and experience. Jesus wanted them to be fully informed and prepared.

There was no set date and time, but they knew they needed to be ready to flee Jerusalem and go into the mountains of Judea in early Spring at some point in their lifetime.

The Christians in the first century were expecting Jesus' coming, ***Parousia,*** in their lifetimes, because Jesus and John the Baptist taught during their ministries:

"The kingdom of heaven **is** at hand." **(Matthew 3:2)**
"The kingdom of heaven **is** at hand." **(Matthew 4:17)**
"The kingdom of heaven **is** at hand." **(Matthew 10:7)**
"The kingdom of God **is** at hand." **(Mark 1:15)**

Matthew 24:34
"**This generation** will not pass away until all these things take place."

Mark 13:30
"**This generation** will not pass away until all these things take place."

Luke 21:32
"**This generation** will not pass away until all things take place."

Luke 10:9
"The kingdom of God has come near **to you."**

These are time indicators as to when the ***Parousia (coming)*** of Jesus would occur. There is no question, Jesus promised He would come to the first-century Church, and He did.

Further confirmation of this fact is found in John's letter to the seven churches in Asia Minor (Ancient Greece – which is modern-day Turkey). We know this letter to be the book of Revelation. However, it was never intended to be a book. It was a letter written by the Apostle John on the Isle of Patmos. He had been exiled there by Nero before AD 68.

The seven remaining churches planted by the Apostle Paul were: Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia and Laodicea.

Paul would have written letters to these churches, but he had been beheaded in Rome in AD 65. Jesus quickened John from the heavenly realm to write the vision (prophecy) in a letter because the Christians in these churches needed to know that the coming ***Parousia*** of Christ was soon! They needed to understand what was happening and to be encouraged to prepare.

Jesus Speaking to the Seven Literal Churches Before AD 70:

Revelation 1:3 - "The time is near."
Revelation 3:11 - "I am coming quickly."
Revelation 22:7 - "Behold, I am coming quickly."
Revelation 22:12 - "Behold, I am coming quickly."
Revelation 22:20 - "Yes, I am coming quickly."

For more understanding go to Appendix J –

“Dating the Book of Revelation”

Section 2: **Matthew 24:37**

But as the days of Noah were, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be.

Jesus said His coming ***Parousia*** would **be as the days of Noah.** So why do we sing, *These Are the Days of Elijah*? Jesus never said it would be like the days of Elijah.

What does the siege of Jerusalem and the destruction of the Temple have to do with the days of Noah? Let's allow Scripture to interpret Scripture!

1 Peter 3:20
God waited patiently in **"the days of Noah"** while the ark was being built. In the ark a few people, only eight souls, were saved from water.

As Noah lived 950 years **(Genesis 9:29)**, he built the ark. He also preached, calling people to repent, for 120 years. God patiently waited for a change of heart; however, only a very few people were saved. The rest were wicked and were taken away by the flood.

In like manner, God waited patiently for the apostate Jews to repent. Jesus rebuked the Pharisees in AD 33. They had almost 40 years to turn their hearts to God. They heard the Gospel preached as The Twelve and many others continued the ministry of Christ.

We could even go as far back as the book of Daniel, 600 years before Jesus was born. The prophet Daniel wrote about the last days, then he sealed the book as the time for the end of the age was not yet. It was for the first century – 600 years later in AD 70.

Daniel 8:26 "And the vision of the evenings and mornings which was told is true; Therefore, **seal up the vision, for it refers to many days in the future."**

The Lord quickened John to realize what Daniel had prophesied was about to happen. It was time for the vision that was once sealed to be opened and read.

Revelation 22:10
"Do not seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the time is near."

We see here that God waited even more patiently with the Jews than He did with those in Noah's day. More grace was given to them, but they would not repent.

Section 3: **Matthew 24:38**

For as in the days before the flood, they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noah entered the ark.

When Jesus, the Lamb of God, gave Himself as the final sacrifice for the remission of sins, the apostate Jewish priesthood refused to recognize the salvation that God had extended through Him to them as well as everyone in the world.

The Jewish priests continued to demand daily animal sacrifices from the people to atone for their sins. As long as Herod's Temple was still standing and the rituals were prolonged, the facade remained in effect. You see, the people had no idea there was no ark in the Holy of Holies of Herod's Temple. It had been missing since Solomon's Temple. The whole thing was blatantly deceptive.

Even though Jesus had made a way for all of mankind to be saved as He established the New (and better) Covenant, the Old Mosaic Law continued in Jerusalem, ignoring the redemption of Christ.

"But now He has obtained a more excellent ministry, inasmuch as He is also Mediator of a better covenant, which was established on better promises." (Hebrews 8:6)

Just as the people in Noah's day were continuing to live as they always did, they did not listen to the warnings and the call to turn to righteousness by the preaching of repentance. God was longsuffering and patient with them, but when He saw there was no change in their hearts, He gave them over to their own demise.

Section 4: **Matthew 24:39**

...and did not know until the flood came and took them all away, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be.

Jesus compared His coming ***Parousia*** to the flood in the days of Noah, which means the wicked would be taken away and the righteous would be saved. The pattern we must see here is how God deals with Israel in judgment. He spares the righteous and removes and destroys the wicked and rebellious.

It was the rebellious Jews in Jerusalem that were destroyed in AD 70 by the Roman Army. Those Jews refused to listen to the Gospel preached by Jesus and His disciples. They had hardened their hearts toward grace. They allowed their dead works and religious pride to destroy them.

Among Bible Prophecy teachers, we have all heard the theory that the good people are taken away and the bad people get left behind. In fact, an entire media franchise was built on this notion and many people bought it. The last count was 70 million copies sold of the *Left Behind* fiction books; there were 16 books in the series. That does not include the additional books modified for children, and video games.

But are these books suitable for solid research, or are they fiction novels that belong on the "Christian Horror" shelf at the local bookstore? Believe it or not, that is actually a book genre now, with a dystopian Sci-fi theme that misuses the Bible by going far beyond the original scriptural intent.

The mainstream evangelical church culture has gone off on a tangent and it will take time and a lot of effort to deconstruct this flawed belief. It will take dedicated Bible teachers to ground Christians in the Word so they learn how to think – not be told what to think.

Section 5: **Matthew 24:40**

Then two men will be in the field: one will be taken and the other left.

The culture of the first century was agrarian. It would be very common to see shepherds or farmers in the field at any given time. They would be visible, and it would be dangerous to be in a field in plain sight when the Roman Army started approaching.

When Jesus said one would be taken, He was not talking about a rapture. He was speaking of slavery. The Romans were always taking men and women into slavery. They had no mercy and no regard for anyone who was not a Roman citizen.

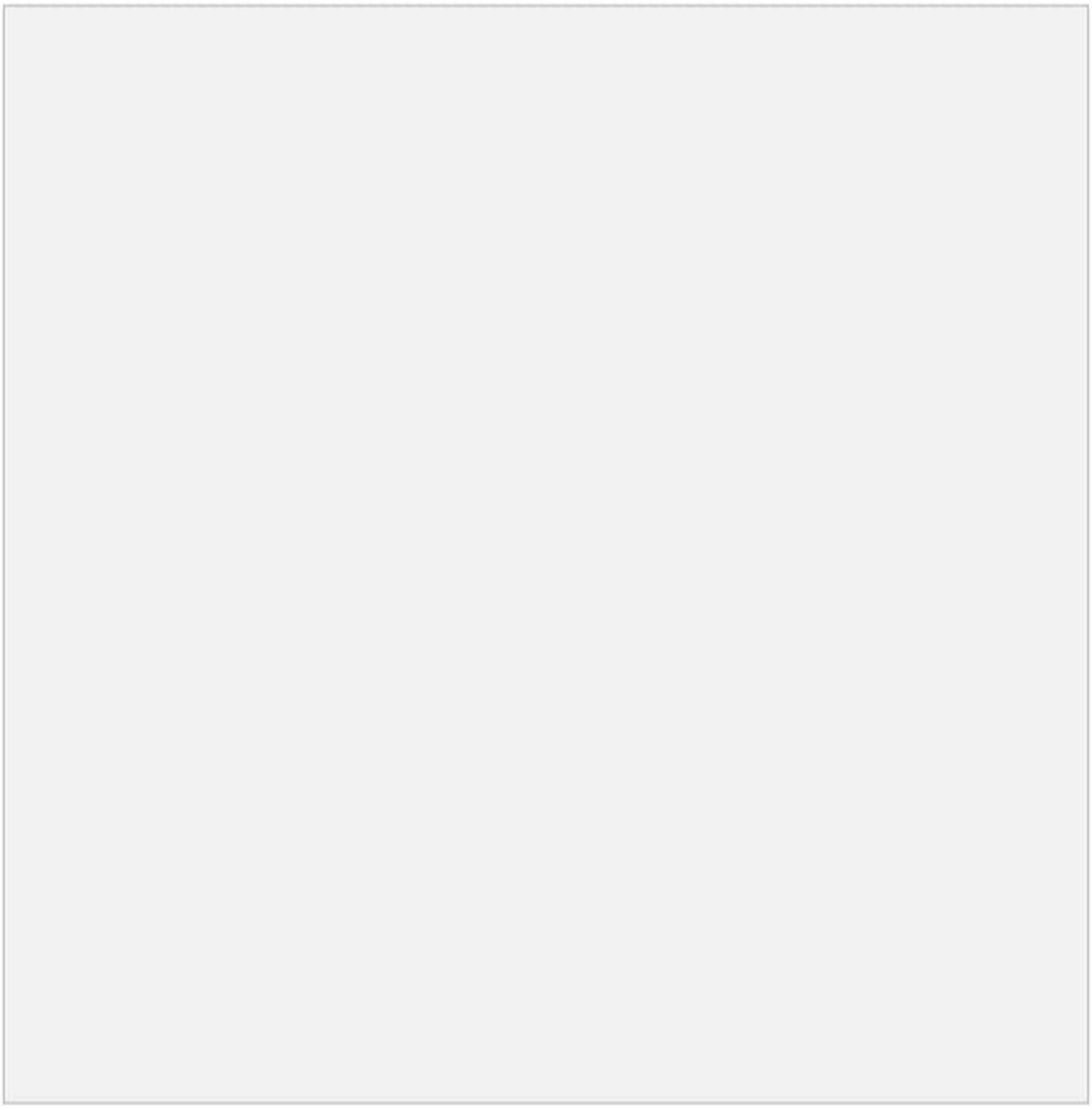
When the Emperor Vespasian ordered the siege by his son, General Titus, there were four legions of men. They captured slaves to grow their food, cook their meat, and use any skills they had to serve the Roman Empire with no pay.

Section 6: **Matthew 24:41**

Two women will be grinding at the mill: one will be taken and the other left.

In first-century Israel, it would be common to see women focused at a millstone grinding corn and wheat to make flour and meal for bread. Jesus wanted to warn His disciples to make sure the women were watchful and aware of their surroundings. The Roman Army attacked fast and unless they were ready to flee, they too could risk being taken captive.

The Romans would be interested in taking working women into slavery as they already were accustomed to being productive. In this case they were preparing food, and the army would need these types of servants to maintain the food supply.



Section 7: **Matthew 24:42**

Watch therefore, for you do not know what hour your Lord is coming.

Jesus wanted His disciples to always be prepared and ready to do all that He instructed them to do so they would be safe. Now we know the coming ***Parousia*** of the Lord happened 40 years after the time He spoke these things. The disciples would have been middle-aged men with families and people to protect from the dangers of the war to come.

They did not know the exact "**hour**" in time, so they had to keep trusting the Lord and stay faithful. They were being trusted to continue the ministry of Jesus: teaching and preaching the Gospel starting in Jerusalem and Judea. They could not lose heart. They needed to stay in faith without knowing specific details.

Section 8 - **Matthew 24:43**

But know this, that if the master of the house had known what hour the thief would come, he would have watched and not allowed his house to be broken into.

Jesus used the example of a house being robbed to illustrate the situation that would happen when the Roman Army marched into Jerusalem. If they knew when this would happen, they would be watching for them to arrive. However, they did not know when they would come, so they needed to continue with their lives but just be ready to flee the city when "the robber" (Roman Army) comes.

Section 9: **Matthew 24:44**

Therefore you also be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect.

In using the "5 W's" method of reading the Scriptures, we must remember "Who" is speaking and to "Whom" is He speaking.

Who is **"you"?**

"You" does not refer to us or anyone beyond that generation.

The **"you"** that Jesus spoke of were His disciples, Peter, James, John, and Andrew. He told them to be ready for His coming ***Parousia***.

They did not know the exact hour, but they knew it would be in the first century–it would be in their lifetime. We can see this confirmed throughout many Scriptures in the New Testament.

Chapter 10

Parable of the Faithful Servant and The Evil Servant

Synoptic Gospels:

Matthew 24:45-51; Luke 21:41-48

Section 1: **Matthew 24:45**

Who then is a faithful and wise servant, whom his master made ruler over his household, to give them food in due season?

Jesus' disciples often called Him, "Master" so this expression was something they understood. These men were in their early 20's and younger. Jesus was 33 and much wiser than they were. He was their rabbi-teacher. They were honored to serve Him.

In the first century Jewish culture, young Jewish men would seek out a rabbi to serve. In the beginning of this rabbi – student relationship, the student was often called a servant. But when the servant became trustworthy and mature, their relationship changed. Jesus had already let His disciples know this as He was putting them in charge.

"No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not know what his master is doing; but I have called you friends, for all things that I heard from My Father I have made known to you." (John 15:15)

This entire chapter will be contrasting the faithful servants to the evil ones. Those who lack faith are considered evil as "whatever is not of faith is sin." **(Romans 14:23)**

There were almost 40 years (a generation) between the ascension of Jesus and the destruction of the Temple. Jesus knew His disciples needed encouragement for the long and difficult labor to which they were called.

Section 2: **Matthew 24:46**

Blessed is that servant whom his master, when he comes, will find so doing.

Jesus is referring to Himself as the master. He is speaking a blessing over the faithful servant(s). Although He is talking to a group (His first century disciples), He is also speaking to them individually. This also connects with the parables that Jesus is about to tell regarding being faithful and then being blessed for staying in faith and trusting God.

Section 3: **Matthew 24:47**

Assuredly, I say to you that he will make him ruler over all his goods.

The Master, Jesus will make His faithful servants ruler over all His goods. This is so very exciting as "the earth is the Lord's and the fulness thereof." (1 Corinthians 10:26) This is a restoration of the original intent God had for all of mankind:

"Be fruitful, multiply, replenish, subdue, have dominion." (Genesis 1:28)

The faithful servant was given dominion to rule and govern. **Isaiah 9:6** is a Messianic prophecy speaking of Jesus as He was the Son that was given to mankind to bring redemption. He is the Head of the Body of Christ **– the shoulders are on His body – the Church.**

"For unto us a Child is born, unto us a Son is given; And the government will be upon His shoulder."

Section 4: **Matthew 24:48**

But if that evil servant says in his heart, 'My master is delaying his coming,...'

This is very important – Jesus calls the servant "evil" that says in their heart, He is delaying His coming ***Parousia***." Yet how many times do we hear TV preachers say, "Should the Lord tarry?" Has He seriously delayed His coming for 2,000 years after He first said He would come during the lifetime of His disciples in the first century?

Why is this evil? Because it is calling Jesus "a liar" when He said in Matthew 24:34 "**this generation shall not pass away until all these things be fulfilled**."

C. S. Lewis, the novelist known for his books ***The Screwtape Letters***, ***The Chronicles of Narnia*** and ***Mere Christianity*** was a brilliant English professor at Cambridge. However, he knew little about eschatology and went as far as to say Jesus misled His disciples when He said, "**this generation shall not pass away until all these things be fulfilled."** In other words, as it concerns the ***Parousia*** of Christ, Lewis claimed Jesus was delaying His coming.

This is why we must never limit our studies to the opinions of famous Christian novelists, but base our beliefs on the very words of Christ Himself!

Section 5: **Matthew 24:49**

...and begins to beat his fellow servants, and to eat and drink with the drunkards...

Josephus, the historian and eyewitness of the Roman siege of Jerusalem, spoke of how the Jewish zealots would fight the other Jews called Herodians in the streets of Jerusalem during the revolt. They turned on each other. The Herodians would eat and get drunk with the Roman soldiers because they were aligned with Rome for political favors. Both Zealots and Herodians rejected the teachings of Jesus and His kingdom message. They chose violence over peace.

Jesus was encouraging His followers not to grow weary and compromise. If they got tired and discouraged, they would regret not living by faith – trusting He would come in their lifetime. Today we have nothing to wait for – He has already come! He is here!

Section 6: **Matthew 24:50**

...the master of that servant will come on a day when he is not looking for him and at an hour that he is not aware of,...

Jesus wanted His followers to know that His coming ***Parousia*** would be a sudden surprise because it would be when the Roman Army invaded Jerusalem. He is speaking of the hour (specific time) when (God the Son) would return to destroy the Temple and establish the New Covenant.

The evil servant would be so busy living in lasciviousness with no boundaries, they would not even know destruction was at hand and there would be no way to escape. Jesus is warning His first-century disciples to avoid the danger that would surely come during their lifetime. (See Matthew 24:34)

Section 7: **Matthew 24:51**

...and will cut him in two and appoint him his portion with the hypocrites. There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Jesus knew the disciples would be tempted to compromise and live a double life, this was His warning to them. If they decided to pretend to be a part of the Apostate Jewish Legal System, they would be punished if they were found out to be one of His disciples.

They would not be able to live like this, but had to make a choice to follow the prophecies of Jesus to flee Jerusalem as stated in the previous Scriptures when they saw the Roman armies marching into Jerusalem.

Jesus was showing them they must be faithful and loyal in order to survive as a pioneer of the New Covenant Church, and possibly die an honorable martyr's death. Those were the choices and He was making it very plain.

The Greek word: ***dichotemeo*** means to cut in two.

The Greek word: ***hypokrites*** means actors, pretenders.

"Cutting in two" is how the Hebrew culture punished criminals who lived a double life. This is why the evil servant was double-minded and would be appointed with the hypocrites who were pretenders.

Chapter 11

Matthew 25: The Olivet Discourse Ends with Three Parables

The three parables about to be explained were included in the prophecies previously spoken. Jesus is still speaking to His four disciples, Peter, James, John, and Andrew while sitting on the Mount of Olives just after publicly admonishing the apostate Jewish priesthood in Herod's Temple. It's important to get context anytime we study the Scriptures.

Also, keep in mind **there were no chapter divisions in the original text**. There was a continuous flow. The original Gospels were not written in book form; they were written more like a report or a story.

Matthew 24 spills over into Matthew 25 as the Olivet Discourse continues. Jesus ends His prophecies in Matthew 24 with three parables in Matthew 25 to further compare wicked servants to faithful servants.

Jesus spoke in parables fulfilling **Psalm 78:1-2**:

"Incline your ears to the words of my mouth. I will open my mouth in a parable."

Section 1: **Matthew 25:1-13**

The Parable of the Ten Virgins

"Then the kingdom of heaven shall be likened to ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Now five of them were wise, and five were foolish. Those who were foolish took their lamps and took no oil with them, but the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps. But while the bridegroom was delayed, they all slumbered and slept. And at midnight a cry was heard: 'Behold, the bridegroom is coming; go out to meet him!'

Then all those virgins arose and trimmed their lamps. And the foolish said to the wise, 'Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.' But the wise answered, saying, 'No, lest there should not be enough for us and you; but go rather to those who sell, and buy for yourselves.' And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the wedding; and the door was shut.

Afterward the other virgins came also, saying, 'Lord, Lord, open to us!' But he answered and said, 'Assuredly, I say to you, I do not know you.' Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour in which the Son of Man is coming."

Jesus often used prophetic symbolic language to convey spiritual truths to His followers. We see in this parable and the one that follows how He used the number 10. In Scripture the number **10 symbolizes wholeness or completeness.**

When Jesus speaks about the kingdom of heaven in parables, He uses the number 10 to symbolize the kingdom of heaven as whole and complete. There is no reason to look beyond the kingdom of God because everything is contained therein.

In biblical times, lamps were essential sources of light. They provided illumination and guidance in the darkness. Oil, on the other hand, was the fuel that sustained the lamp's flame. Without oil, the lamp would eventually go out, leaving them in darkness.

In a spiritual context, the lamp represents our faith by trusting the **Word** of God. **So, then faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God. (Romans 10:17)**

Jesus was the Word of God. **And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us. (John 1:14)**

The 10 virgins each had a lamp which represented the Word. **Your word is a lamp to my feet, and a light to my path. (Psalm 119:105)**

It's the oil that keeps the lamp lit. The lamp is the Word; the oil represents the anointing of the Holy Spirit.**". . . how God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, who went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him." (Acts 10:38)**

Once again, a reference is made that anointing is an act normally done with oil by the Holy Spirit. Lamps are needed to see in the darkness. Jesus was telling His disciples who were still with Him on the Mount of Olives that day, that the days ahead would be dark. Likewise, virgins would need His Word (lamp) and the Holy Spirit (oil) to keep from stumbling in the darkness and see the path leading to the day of His coming ***Parousia*** – as He, Jesus is the bridegroom in this parable.

Jesus was making sure His disciples realized what was required to have faith in the Word and be led by the Holy Spirit – staying devoted, especially during the great tribulation that would happen in their lifetime.

Section 2: **Matthew 25:14-30**

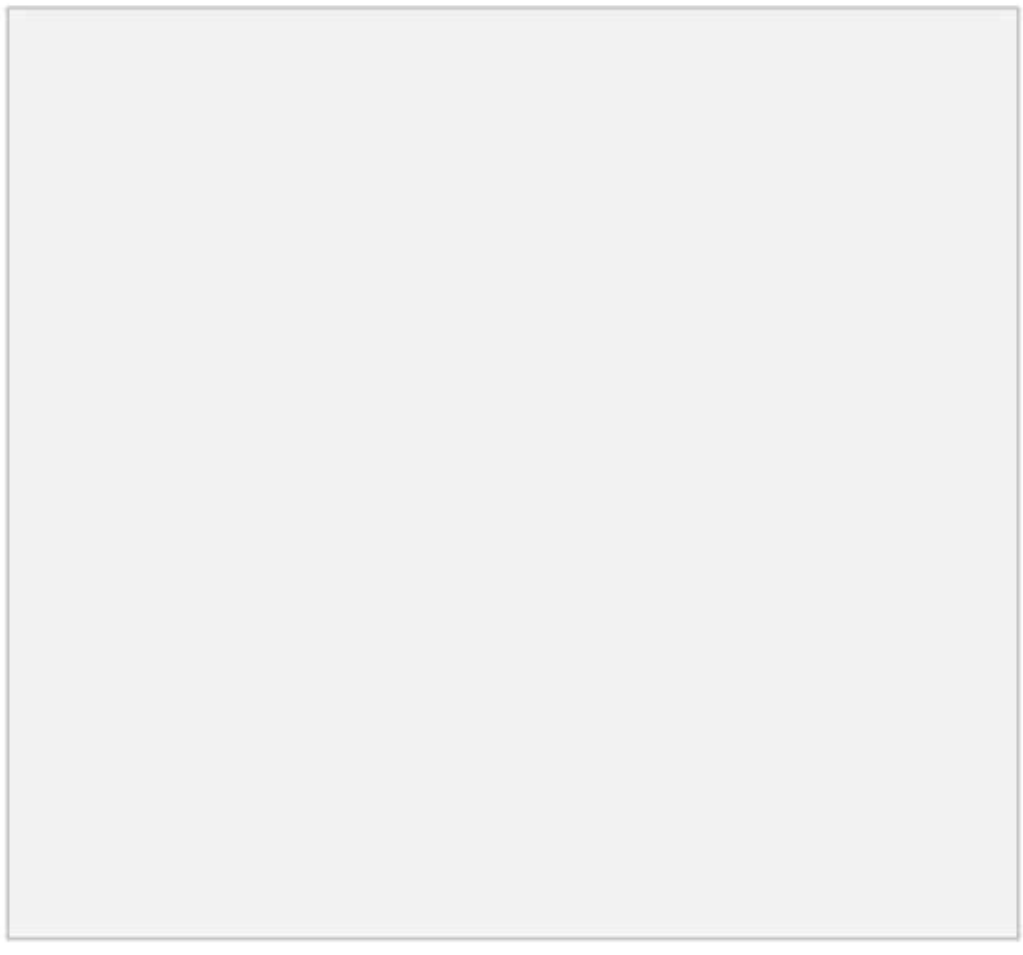
The Parable of the Talents

"For the kingdom of heaven is like a man traveling to a far country, who called his own servants and delivered his goods to them. And to one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one, to each according to his own ability; and immediately he went on a journey. Then he who had received the five talents went and traded with them and made another five talents. And likewise, he who had received two gained two more also. But he who had received one went and dug in the ground and hid his lord's money. After a long time, the lord of those servants came and settled accounts with them.

"So, he who had received five talents came and brought five other talents, saying, 'Lord, you delivered to me five talents; look, I have gained five more talents besides them.' His lord said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant; you were faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.' He also who had received two talents came and said, 'Lord, you delivered to me two talents; look, I have gained two more talents besides them.' His lord said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant; you have been faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.'

"Then he who had received the one talent came and said, 'Lord, I knew you to be a hard man, reaping where you have not sown, and gathering where you have not scattered seed. And I was afraid and went and hid your talent in the ground. Look, there you have what is yours.'

"But his lord answered and said to him, 'You wicked and lazy servant, you knew that I reap where I have not sown and gather where I have not scattered seed. So, you ought to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I would have received back my own with interest. So, take the talent from him, and give it to him who has ten talents. 'For to everyone who has, more will be given, and he will have abundance; but from him who does not have, even what he has will be taken away. And cast the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."



A talent is first century currency in the Roman Empire.

Just like in the parable of the 10 Virgins, Jesus uses the number 10 here with the distribution of 10 Talents. The talent entrusted to the servants was the largest currency unit of the time. The first two servants, by wise trading, doubled the amounts received. The third servant was a man who hid his money.

With His **'after a long time'** statement Jesus hints to the time that will pass until His coming ***Parousia***. The master (Greek- ***Kyrios*** - "Lord") returned from his journey and held these servants accountable. The first two servants were congratulated and rewarded for their ability to increase and prosper. Though their responsibility had been unequal (five talents and two talents) their reward was the same. What matters is wholehearted commitment, not accomplishment. It was not the amount; it was the fact they invested in faith instead of hoarding in fear.

The third servant was the focus of the parable. He received blame and condemnation because he had done nothing. He had been too "afraid" to take a risk and step out in faith. His punishment was for laziness and not honoring what he had been entrusted with. This servant saw the master as harsh. The other two were not afraid and had confidence and freedom to "trade".

Jesus was telling His disciples in the parable to see Him as one who wants them to prosper – to be fruitful and multiply. The kingdom of God is a place of abundance. Jesus wanted His followers to see the difference between one who lives in fear and one who lives in faith. The commodity of the kingdom of God is faith. Anyone who trusts the Lord will receive generously. Anyone who is afraid, hoards, and is selfish will end up losing what little they have.

Section 3: **Matthew 25:31-46**

The Parable of The Sheep and the Goats

"When the Son of Man comes in His glory, and all the angels with Him, then He will sit on the throne of His glory. All the nations will be gathered before Him, and He will separate them one from another, as a shepherd divides his sheep from the goats. And He will set the sheep on His right hand, but the goats on the left.

Then the King will say to those on His right hand, 'Come, you blessed of My Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world: for I was hungry and you gave Me food; I was thirsty and you gave Me drink; I was a stranger and you took Me in; I was naked and you clothed Me; I was sick and you visited Me; I was in prison and you came to Me.'

"Then the righteous will answer Him, saying, 'Lord, when did we see You hungry and feed You, or thirsty and give You drink? When did we see You a stranger and take You in, or naked and clothe You? Or when did we see You sick, or in prison, and come to You?' And the King will answer and say to them, 'Assuredly, I say to you, inasmuch as you did it to one of the least of these My brethren, you did it to Me.

"Then He will also say to those on the left hand, 'Depart from Me, you cursed, into the everlasting fire prepared for the devil and his angels: for I was hungry and you gave Me no food; I was thirsty and you gave Me no drink; I was a stranger and you did not take Me in, naked and you did not clothe Me, sick and in prison and you did not visit Me.'

"Then they also will answer Him, saying, 'Lord, when did we see You hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not minister to

You?' Then He will answer them, saying, 'Assuredly, I say to you, inasmuch as you did not do it to one of the least of these, you did not do it to Me.' And these will go away into everlasting punishment, but the righteous into eternal life."

This parable was the last prophetic message Jesus spoke to His four disciples: Peter, James, John and Andrew. He was letting them know what it will be like once His coming ***Parousia*** arrives. He is speaking in third person referring to Himself as "King". Instead of being exclusive to Israel only, the kingdom would be inclusive as Christ would gather all nations. Christ would separate the nations just as a shepherd would separate the sheep from the goats.

Jesus being the Good Shepherd said, "**I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd gives His life for the sheep." (John 10:11)** He was just about to go to the cross that very week and show His sheep His sacrificial goodness.

Jesus continues in John 10:14-16: **"I am the good shepherd; and I know My sheep, and am known by My own. As the Father knows Me, even so I know the Father; and I lay down My life for the sheep. And other sheep I have which are not of this fold; them also I must bring, and they will hear My voice; and there will be one flock and one shepherd."**

He confirms that there will be sheep in other flocks (nations) but they will be gathered as one flock and have one Shepherd!

The sheep will be known by the Shepherd because of their ability to see Christ in others. They will feed the hungry and give drink to the thirsty, because they will see Christ in them. They will take in strangers, because they see Christ in them. They will clothe the needy, because they see Christ in them. They will visit those who are sick and in prison, because they see Christ in them.

On the other hand, the goats (the apostate Jewish leaders) will not see Christ in others – they will be cast out.

Chapter 12

Conclusion

Section 1: **Scripture & History Prove Prophecy Was Fulfilled**

Many Christians seem confused about the times in which we live. What's been lacking in modern-day teaching and preaching is a basic understanding of Ancient World History along with comprehensive reading skills. However, when we examine biblical language and grammar, we become better educated and less indoctrinated.

How Christians Should Use Scripture to Interpret Scripture:

1. We must honor the **culture** of those who wrote the Scriptures.
2. We must honor the **language** of those who wrote the Scriptures.
3. We must honor **those to whom** the Scriptures were first written.
4. **We must read from Scripture – *exegesis*.**
5. **We must not read into Scripture – *eisegesis*.**

Too many modern-day Bible Prophecy teachers read into Scripture, which leads to error. When Jesus prophesied the destruction of the Temple in Jerusalem, He was not referring to modern times. He was not speaking about nuclear warheads, computer chips and Apache helicopters.

These same Bible Prophecy teachers will read current events (which change from day to day) and swear those are the signs of the last days and the end times. Nothing could be more dishonest and lacking in credibility.

It's wonderful to see so many people moving away from such flawed doctrine and taking the time to read, study and think for themselves.

Much of what we've come to know is wrong and was presented to us as an emotional appeal – often based on ignorance and dreading the future. We cannot know where we are going unless we know where we have been. So, as we unearth the past, we will define the present, so we can imagine the future.

Reasons Christians should learn Ancient History:

1. God instructed that written records be kept.
2. God expects us to learn from a knowledge of history.

3. God's dealings in history show us what He is like.
4. God called Believers to be history-makers.

How God Relates to Historical Events:

1. God leads rulers when they look to Him for guidance.
2. God used heathen nations to accomplish His purposes.
3. God often revealed to His servants (the prophets) future events not known to others.

History was written in Scripture for our instruction and encouragement so we might have hope. "For whatever was written in former days was written for our instruction, that through endurance and through the encouragement of the Scriptures we might have hope." **(Romans 15:4)**

The Book of Acts is a New Testament History book in which Luke recorded Early Church events occurring from Christ's Ascension to Pentecost, and until Paul's last few years in Rome where he was martyred in AD 67.

Although there are other confirming first century historians such as Josephus, Tacitus and Suetonius, we lay a solid foundation of understanding by first knowing what Scripture plainly says. From there, we gain confirmation and proof through commonly known facts in Ancient World History.

Section 2: **History Does Not Repeat Itself**

How many times have we heard, "History repeats itself" as if we are all living in an on-going Groundhog Day scenario and there's nothing we can do to stop it? If we would just think about that for a moment, we would no longer consider it, and certainly stop saying it.

As Christians, we should never claim such a thing as it would make our faith null and void. Let's challenge this idea with some questions:

1. Will there be another virgin birth of Christ?

2. Will there be another Savior of the world besides Jesus?
3. Will there be another crucifixion to redeem mankind?
4. Will there be another resurrection of Christ?
5. Will there be another (Acts 2) "day of Pentecost"?

We can have "Easter" dramas and reenact these events on an annual basis, but they are not actually repeating themselves. When we read the Scriptures, we must honor the "once and for all" nature of the things that took place. There will never be an exact repeat of the life of Christ. Now when we examine the things that Jesus prophesied would happen at the end of the Old Mosaic age during the generation (lifetime) of His disciples, we must see it as a once and for all event. We need to ask the same kind of questions:

1. Will there be another Herod the Great?
2. Will there be another Herod's Temple?
3. Will there be another Roman Army?
4. Will there be another Emperor Vespasian?
5. Will there be another General Titus?

What Jesus said would happen, happened just like He said within the 40-year window of time He said it would happen. To claim otherwise is lacking integrity as well as intelligence.

For years, people in churches have remained ignorant and indoctrinated by a narrative lacking in historical context. The average Christian knew very little if anything about the ancient world in the first-century. Few pastors and ministry leaders took the time to study the historical fulfillment of Bible prophecy. However, this is changing. Knowledge, wisdom, and understanding is coming to the Church!

People are waking up and becoming informed of these historical facts and realizing there will be no repeat and no duplication of what took place to establish the New (and better) Covenant! It has been established. Moving forward, we must be aware of the negligent teaching of Dispensational Futuristic Eschatology – which denies the historical fulfillment of Bible prophecy. This doctrine basically calls Jesus a liar when He said to His disciples in Matthew 24:34:

“This generation shall not pass away until all these things be fulfilled.”

As stated previously, a generation is forty years. Jesus stated this between AD 30 and AD 33. The Temple was destroyed in AD 70. The Math works. **Jesus did not lie**.

Another thing we must challenge is the “history repeats itself” cliché. It's another way of saying, “Yes, Bible prophecy already happened just like Jesus said, but it will happen again.” **Why should it happen again?** Is the New Covenant not established? Was the blood sacrifice of Christ not enough?

There is sadly a politically-motivated push to build another Temple in Jerusalem and start conducting animal sacrifices again to stage a reenactment of what happened nearly 2,000 years ago in AD 70. Who wants to see another war? Who wants another “great tribulation?”

Most likely the people who make money from wars – those who loan money to nations to buy arms. That’s who is behind this propaganda. We must always follow the money trail. The Church needs to stop going along with this as it is certainly not the will of Jesus!

Those who say there is going to be yet another “great tribulation” ignore the specific promise Jesus made concerning the **“great tribulation”** that already happened in AD 70.

“For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been since the beginning of the world until this time, no, nor ever shall be.” (Matthew 24:21)

Does that sound like “history repeats itself?” Jesus made it clear there would never be another “great tribulation” as there would be in the generation of His disciples.

As Christ’s ambassadors, we must be stewards of the Gospel of the Kingdom which is established in the New Covenant. History does not repeat itself. Because we are in Christ, we have been made a new creation. We are living in a new day. His mercies are new every morning. God is doing a new thing.

Section 3: **No Double Fulfillment**

What is “Double Fulfillment?"

A double fulfillment of bible prophecy is a theory that a prophecy has two manifestations: a precise and specific fulfillment in a defined time window as well as a vague, nonspecific fulfillment sometime in the future.

The first prophecy fulfillment is based on concrete and solid biblical time stamps and historically documented proof, whereas the "second fulfillment" is based on whims, rumors, and engineered plots.

We've been told all the bad things that are happening in the world today are because we are supposedly living in the end times and the last days, watching bible prophecy unfold before our very eyes. We have been sadly programmed to accept bad news as the Gospel.

Could it be there is a modern-day manmade system manipulating disasters, wars, famines, earthquakes, and all things "prophetic" so that we will think this is God's doings? Has there been tampering with Scripture? C.I. Scofield, who wrote the famous "Study Bible" clearly altered the intent of Scripture (see Chapter 8, Section 3, "This Generation").

What Did Jesus Say About the Fulfillment of Bible Prophecy?

Jesus said all bible prophecy would be fulfilled at the destruction of Herod's Temple in AD 70. He told His disciples (Peter, James, John, and Andrew) while sitting on the Mt. of Olives looking over the Temple buildings things that would happen in **their** generation.

"This generation will not pass away until all these things be fulfilled." **(Matthew 24:34)**

His generation would see **all** those things fulfilled. A generation is 40 years. Jesus spoke this "end of the age" prophecy around AD 30. This means in AD 70, it would have been a generation. Just before Matthew 24:34, Jesus said this concerning "**the great tribulation:"**

"For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been since the beginning of the world until this time, no, nor ever shall be." **(Matthew 24:21)**

In other words, **"the great tribulation"** would happen once during the lifetime of His disciples and never happen again. We know this occurred at the destruction of Herod's Temple in AD 70. There is **no** double fulfillment according to Jesus, who has the final word.

What Did Daniel Say About the Fulfillment of Bible Prophecy?

Many people refer to the Book of Daniel when examining bible prophecy. Daniel recorded in a book a prophetic message given to him by an angel. This is what the angel told Daniel concerning **when** the prophecy was to be opened and read:

"But you, Daniel, shut up the words, and seal the book until the time of the end." **(Daniel 12:4)**

The "time of the end" referred to the end of the Old Mosaic Covenant age (*see the definition in Chapter 3, Getting Scriptural Context*) which would occur 600 years later during the first century.

What Did the Apostle John Say About the Fulfillment of Bible Prophecy?

While Daniel was instructed by the angel to "seal the book" of the prophecy, the Apostle John in Revelation was told by an angel "**do not** to seal" it because **the time was near** for the fulfillment.

"Then he told me, 'Do not seal up the words of prophecy in this book, because the time is near.'" **(Revelation 22:10)**

Keep in mind, John was on the Mount of Olives with Jesus in Matthew 24. He is mentioned by name in Mark 13:3. Therefore, he was compelled to write what he knew about the end of the age to the churches the Apostle Paul had planted in Asia Minor.

Why "Double Fulfillment" Teaching is Dangerous

Jesus never taught a "double fulfillment" of bible prophecy. The Apostle John never taught a "double fulfillment" of bible prophecy. The Prophet Daniel never taught a "double fulfilment" of bible prophecy.

So where did we get this outlandish idea?

It was never taught until the mid-1800's and the beginning of the 1900's by Zionists who decided to tamper with the King James Bible with "Study Notes" in the margins. C.I. Scofield's "Study Bible" was the tool they used. It was printed by the Oxford Press, owned by the Rothschilds.

In **Isaiah 9:6**, we read:

"For unto us a Child is born, unto us a Son is given: and the government shall be upon His shoulders: And His name shall be called Wonderful, Counselor, the Mighty God, The Everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace."

The **governmen**t shall be upon His shoulders! **The shoulders are on the Body!** This Scripture prophetically points to Christ!

We are His Body!

We are the **government!**

He gave us the authority to have dominion on Earth!

Those who are outside of Christ are not in authority. The only way to weaken our authority and identity as the true government of God, is to deceive us. Just like Adam and Eve were deceived when God had given them dominion to govern the Garden of Eden.

If we are led to believe that bible prophecy has already been fulfilled and will be fulfilled again, we would expect a 2.0 version to unfold. The "double fulfilment" theory is in direct conflict with the written prophecies of Daniel, Jesus, and John.

Instead of ruling this earth, like God originally intended, we will be made to sit back and watch the disasters as though this is God's end of the age plan – again.

That is not a Kingdom Culture whatsoever. It's time to become free from all fear of the future. It's time to let go of false "double fulfillment" theories and stick with the words of Jesus.

Section 4: **What Now? God's Original Intent**

Once we realize the "end of the age" Bible prophecy was fulfilled in the first-century, never to repeat again, we may ask ourselves, "Now what?" After all, most of our mental and emotional energy has been spent toward suspected disasters that were to come "soon" and "the end is (allegedly) near".

Sadly, we were not educated in history but rather indoctrinated to believe an inevitable "biblical" apocalypse would occur in our lifetime. Now that we know better, how do we redirect our focus? What now?

The answer to this wonderful dilemma is found in the book of Genesis - God's original intent for mankind. When Adam and Eve were in the Garden of Eden, God instructed them with five basic things to do with their lives. We lost sight of this in the Fall—but regained it through Christ when He redeemed us back to the Garden—before mankind believed a lie.

You see, mankind was created in the image of God. The voice of the serpent told them **if** they ate of the fruit of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, **then** they would be like God. The truth was – they already were like God. It was a voice other than God that brought their identity into question.

They doubted who they were and that led to deception. However, divine identity was regained through Christ – and all who are in Him have His identity. As He is, so are we in this world. (1 John 4:17)

Adam's one sin brought condemnation to everyone, **but Christ's one act of righteousness brings a right relationship with God and new life for everyone. (Romans 5:18)**

So, what now? See Genesis 1:28:

1. Be Fruitful.
2. Multiply.
3. Replenish.
4. Subdue.
5. Have Dominion.

This is known as **The Garden Mandate.** After reading this book, be sure to look for the next book: ***The Garden Mandate – God's Original Intent for Mankind*** to further your studies and your understanding of the reason God put us here on planet Earth, and how we are to build a fearless future for many generations to come! We are not to wait on evil plans of wicked people to play out when we have been given authority and orders to manifest the Kingdom of God right here and right now!

Chapter 13

My Story

Section 1: **Grandmother's Porch**

When I was five years old growing up in Atlanta. I remember warm summer nights sitting on my grandmother's front porch drinking iced tea with Mama. The air was filled with the sound of crickets chirping, and the sweet smell of magnolias and honeysuckles. Peeking through the branches of the massive oak trees was a bright full moon. Mama would point and say in her warm Southern voice, "See that moon, Cindye? Right before the end of the world, the moon will turn a blood red."

Even at a young age, I was fascinated with the things of God. So, I asked Mama about the moon. "How is the moon going to turn red?" I recall Mama answered me in a stern voice saying, "The Bible says the moon will turn red and we are not to question the Bible." I know she didn't mean to be harsh, but that made a lasting impression on me. Maybe she was unsure of it as well and was caught off guard by the question.

I felt close to Jesus all my life, but I was afraid to question anything in the Bible when I did not understand it. I just politely listened; silently frustrated with many questions and concerns. How could I ever find the answers to the questions I was not allowed to ask? Raising questions about the Bible was considered a dispute and frowned upon; it was viewed inappropriate and disrespectful.

Mama was a hard-working single mother. She sent me to my Aunt Jane's kindergarten, and I would often be the last child to go home in the afternoons. Mama would run errands after work. She would buy a few groceries for dinner or go to the dry cleaners before picking me up. I remember the deep sense of abandonment while staring out the window watching to see her car; tears streaming down my face. I feared it was the end of the world and she had "been raptured." I wondered if I was left behind to be beheaded in the tribulation as she and grandmother had discussed.

When she finally arrived, I clung to her for dear life. It was just awful to be so tormented by something so misunderstood in the Bible. Imagine a child at such a young age with so much fear of the future. Imagine that to be your understanding of God and His plans. God help us!

Section 2: **Youth Choir - Teen Alcoholic**

As a teenager, growing up in the Southern Baptist Church during the early 70's was both wonderful and terrifying. The wonderful part was the excitement of "The Jesus Movement" coming out of California. Following Jesus was cool. Christian rock bands, Jesus Festivals, and revivals were energizing a new generation to follow Christ. I was at church every time the doors opened. It was truly exciting!

At the same time, it was terrifying. A fiction book called; ***The Late Great Planet Earth*** was all the rage. 28 million copies had been sold as people had become obsessed with Bible Prophecy and convinced we were living in the last days.

Famous Christian leaders were promoting it. Local ministers were using this book as a primary teaching resource for their Sunday sermons and mid-week Bible Studies. Imagine using a fiction book as your source for teaching Bible truth.

The "rapture" and the "end times" were on-going themes targeting youth to "get right or get left (behind)". We even sang a song in youth choir called - *Wish We'd All Been Ready*. The lyrics go like this:

Wish We'd All Been Ready
by Larry Norman

"Life was filled with guns and wars
And everyone got trampled on the floor
Wish we'd all been ready –
Children died, the days grew cold
A piece of bread could buy a bag of gold
Wish we'd all been ready –
There's no time to change your mind
The Son has come –
And you've been left behind."

People came to the altar based on fear and as soon as the fear wore off, they were back where they were before – lost in a mistaken identity of sin. I knew something was wrong, but I was not allowed to question, remember? I basically grew up in

"the sit down; shut up generation" programmed to fear the future, indoctrinated by something that was not even taught until the mid-1800's.

In the late 70's, I started attending a prominent Church of God in Atlanta with an impressive music outreach ministry. They needed a costume designer for an upcoming musical production. I was a fashion design student with a professional sewing machine, so I volunteered to help. It gave me a chance to get to know people and I really enjoyed being a blessing to the music department.

Because I had been working behind the scenes making 40 costumes in three days, I was unaware of what the musical was about. So, I was eager to see the production and the new friends who were wearing the costumes I made for them! While sitting in the audience during the performance, the cast came out on stage singing "**Late, late, it's getting late. Late, late, it's getting late**…" It was a musical based on Hal Lindsey's book, ***Late Great Planet Earth***.

There it was once again. Fear-based content had become trendy with mainstream Evangelicals, Pentecostals, and Charismatics. Dispensational Futuristic Eschatology had hijacked the culture of my youth in the 70's. There was no avoiding it. It had flooded vast amounts of contemporary Christian music, fiction books, and movies of that time.

In addition to scary fiction books and songs about "the end times", there were cheesy movies with bad acting and low budgets. *A Thief in the Night* and the three sequels that followed were the most popular movies back then. After all, it was a money-maker. The media in the 70's and 80's was so influential, entire denominations based their worldview on the "Fiction Eschatology" and "Christian Horror" genre.

How can fiction books and Hollywood movies be used as credible resources for Bible study?

This spawned so many false "end-of-the-world" predictions – there were too many to count. It was clear, fear mixed with religion sells and as long as people buy it, they will keep pumping it out there. Nobody ever thought to question the status quo. It was not permitted. We were being indoctrinated and programmed to go along with this agenda even though it lacked credibility and lasting fruit.

Sadly, this flawed Bible Prophecy teaching was traumatizing. It led me to become a teenage alcoholic. I had started driving myself to school, and in the afternoon I would come home and drink Mama's vodka mixed with orange juice. I did not want her to find out so I would fill the vodka bottle up with water. In the mornings, before going to school, I would drink golden grain alcohol with fruit punch. In 10th grade, I stayed drunk most of the time to keep from being afraid about the things I was hearing preached in church.

Thankfully, the next year I was baptized with the Holy Spirit, peace filled my heart and I was delivered from alcohol addiction. God is faithful!

Section 3: **"Last Days" Abortions**

During the 80's, I became a keynote speaker for the Fellowship of Christian Athletes. Because I had been an NFL cheerleader, I was often invited to come speak specifically to high school and college cheerleaders and share my testimony about miraculously overcoming teenage alcoholism.

One morning after an FCA assembly, a high-school cheerleader asked if I would meet with her in private. She confessed she was a Christian and that she just found out she was pregnant. She said she was planning to get an abortion. When I asked her why, she said we were living in the end times and Jesus warned about being pregnant in the last days. She went on to explain that other Christian girls were getting abortions for the same reason.

At the time, I did not know what I know now. But what I did know is that Jesus was not supporting abortions. Clearly, she had taken Matthew 24:19 completely out of context. Or perhaps that Scripture was being used to talk Christian teens into getting abortions. Who knows? See Chapter 6, Section 5 of this book to see what Jesus meant in Matthew 24:19, "But woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing babies in those days!" **Jesus clearly was not condoning abortion.**

By God's grace, I was able to persuade her not to get an abortion and have the baby. She stayed in school, and she raised the child while living with her parents.

I had the joy of meeting this child at the shopping mall during Christmas. The cheerleader I encouraged to have the baby was the mother of a beautiful 8-year-old son. She was so happy to have me meet him. We were connected heart to heart.

I share this testimony without revealing names or even location details because I will never forget how dangerous it is to mis-understand the Bible. In cases like this, it's literally a matter of life and death!

Section 4: **Selling Life Insurance**

I met my husband at church, and we were married in 1984. In the early years of our marriage, we helped people plant churches with very limited budgets. We had to do something flexible to supplement our income, so we became licensed life insurance agents.

We started approaching our church friends about buying affordable term life insurance because they were mainly young families, and this was a wise investment.

We made appointments to meet with our friends in their homes to show them the different plans and how they could rest assured their families would have provision should there be a loss. We were in shock how many people did not want life insurance because they believed "the rapture" would happen soon and they did not see the need to plan for the future.

Many had bought the book, ***88 Reasons Why the Rapture Will Be in 1988***. We were horrified to discover some people went as far as putting their dogs and cats to sleep so they would not suffer during the tribulation when they were left behind! Some people were running their credit cards up thinking they would not be around to have to pay them off after the rapture. You cannot make this stuff up, it was insanity!

One man refused to buy term life insurance because he was sure we were living in the end times and the rapture would happen at any minute. Sadly, this man died suddenly of a massive heart-attack. His family was left destitute. They had nothing because his life was based on a flawed Bible interpretation.

Needless to say, we did not sell life insurance very long. Looking back, we should have approached non-Christians who were unaware of the rapture teaching and the

last days madness which was so predominant among Christians. They had better sense and a more solid worldview, unfortunately.

Section 5: **Taco Bell with Kyle**

In the Fall of 1999, just before the "Y2K" scare, I enrolled our oldest son, Kyle in a 7th grade Life Science Class for homeschoolers. I wanted him to get to know his fellow classmates, many of whom were the kids of local ministers. I suggested to the mothers that we all have lunch at Taco Bell after class. They agreed.

After we all met at the restaurant, about nine students sat together at a table away from the mothers. As I sat at the mother's table, I happened to notice how quiet the kids table was compared to the buzz of conversation and laughter at our table. I excused myself and went to sit with my son Kyle and his classmates, hoping to help them connect with each other.

The kids were just sitting there at the table awkwardly chewing their food but not talking. So I introduced myself as I joined them. I told them we were going to play a game where we go around the table and everyone says what they want to be when they grow up. Keep in mind these were all minister's kids, so I was certain they had visions and goals – this should be fun, I thought!

I looked at the guy to my immediate left and said, "You go first. What do you want to be when you grow up?". He looked at me with a blank stare and mumbled, "I don't know". So, I said, "Okay, you think about it. We will come back to you." Next person, "what do you want to be when you grow up?" The next guy said he had never thought about it. "C'mon", I said, "surely you have thought about it! Nobody will laugh."

Then, he repeated himself saying," I've never thought about it." Maybe they were just shy and did not want anyone to laugh at them, I thought. So, I kept trying to get these kids to connect.

I asked the next student, who also said he did not know what he wanted to be when he grew up. I went all the way around the table asking the same exact question, and not one student knew what they wanted to be when they grew up.

How odd, I thought. These were 12-year-olds, surely, they had not become cynical so young.

The last person I asked what they wanted to be when they grew up was Kyle, who was sitting to my immediate right. He confidently answered, "Well, first, I want to make it out of this Science class and then get through high school, then go to college I suppose, and get an undergraduate degree in English because I like to read and write.

After that I will go to Law School and become a Constitutional lawyer to represent Christians in court. Now, I won't make much money doing this because I will have to do things pro bono, you know for free…because a lot of people don't have money to pay lawyers. I will most likely trade stocks. I have been working with candle stick trades and Mom said if I can do 50 paper trades in a row and not lose money, she would open an E*TRADE account, so I can get started."

As his mom, I was so proud of him being able to communicate such a well-thought-out vision for his future in front of his 7th grade classmates. Everyone sat there staring in amazement. One guy said, "Dude, did you just make all that stuff up?"

"Oh no", answered Kyle, "I have been thinking about this my whole life." This was getting interesting. I was curious why these kids had no dreams and visions for the future, so I came right out and asked them, "Hey guys, why don't you have plans for the future like Kyle?" One guy said, "Well, because of the rapture." At that point, Kyle said, "The what?" You see I never taught my sons about "the rapture". I did not teach them about "the last days" or "the end times". I never wanted them to be traumatized like I was as a child.

The kids were amazed that Kyle had never heard of "the rapture" especially with Y2K soon approaching and so many feared the end was near. I suppose I had protected my kids from these things. I just wanted them to know that Jesus loved them, and God had wonderful plans for their lives.

The kids started explaining to Kyle what "the rapture" was. "Dude, the rapture is when everyone on earth goes up in the air, the devil takes over the world and Jesus comes back on a white horse", said the students. The look on Kyle's face was that of somebody being thoroughly entertained. "Okay", he said, with a little twinkle in his

eye. "So let me make sure I get this right. First, you said everyone on earth is going up in the air. Now if the earth is a sphere, what is up in America is down in Australia. That means everyone would have to go out, not up.

Next, you said that the devil is going to take over the world. But didn't Jesus defeat the devil? And you also said Jesus was coming back on a white horse? Does this mean Jesus is an intergalactic space zombie floating around in Outer Space looking for Hercules' horse, Pegasus to fly back to Earth?

And when Jesus comes back, will He be wearing a robe or an Armani suit?" Then Kyle asked, "Will Jesus and the horse have on space helmets, so they can breathe? They both have lungs you know and will need an oxygen supply."

Kyle had quite an imagination and an expressive way with words. I was deciding whether I should laugh or dig a hole in the floor and crawl out of the Taco Bell quietly and drive away. Everyone had finished their lunch so I told them, "We should get home and finish our science assignments before it gets too late." It was clear I had a lot of studying to do if I was going to introduce my sons to this most confusing topic. On the way home, Kyle asked me what was "the rapture really". I said, "Son, we just need to sit down and study the Bible and try to figure it out." And that is what we did!

This little meeting at Taco Bell with the 7th grade Science class was a turning point for me and my family. We began a quest to learn what Jesus said about "the end of the age". What we discovered led me to write this book. I want to help parents teach their kids accurately and never allow others to lead them into a fear-based distorted view of Jesus' "end time" prophecies ever again.

We started in Revelation but realized we should start in the Gospels to see what Jesus said about this subject in Matthew 24, Mark 13, and Luke 21. That was the solid foundation where we built our understanding and Christ-centered worldview.

Section 6: **Teaching Ancient World History**

When my sons attended a private Christian school, I was asked to join the high school faculty and teach Ancient World History and Biblical Worldview. This forced me to study in great depth the history of the ancient Roman Empire and the First Century Early Church. The vast amount of evidence of a first century fulfilment

of Bible Prophecy was so compelling, I was both relieved and challenged as I was experiencing deconstruction in my thinking. During this time, my understanding expanded immensely concerning the prophecies of Jesus. It became so obvious, I wondered why this was not being taught.

It was during my time teaching this subject, that I wrote a syllabus and lesson plans geared toward high school seniors. I spent countless hours researching and making notes which became the outline to my doctoral dissertation. I was delighted to discover a community of Bible scholars in the field of Fulfilled Eschatology. Many of them advised me to publish my notes in book form and create a course for college level students who need a proper worldview on which to build their lives. After much prayer, I decided to move forward with that idea.

Section 7: **Motherhood – My Motivation**

I never imagined I would one day be a theologian! I thought that job was reserved for old men with long grey beards who drank brandy and smoked pipes. I never saw myself as a pontificator in a room with seminary intellectuals. It was never on my radar until I became a mother and wanted my sons to understand the Bible.

As frustrated as I was with the "last days" and "end times" frenzy, I would have never been motivated to study and teach this controversial topic unless I had a mother's heart. Theological debates never appealed to me. I just desired for my sons and their friends to be educated, not indoctrinated. Instead of telling them **what to think**, I wanted them to know ***how to think*** and how to ask questions. I do not claim to have all the answers, but after 25 years of research in the field of **Fulfilled Eschatology**, I have some solid evidence to offer those who are searching for clarity and an optimistic Christ-centric Biblical worldview.

I have poured countless hours into this book in-between homeschooling, caring for my aging parents, running a business, co-pastoring a church, and overcoming cancer and other health issues. What initially began as my personal Bible Study notes while homeschooling and teaching History in a private school, became the framework of this book.

It is my sincere hope that you, the Reader, find great assurance in the credibility of Jesus by knowing His prophecies were fulfilled in the first century just like He promised they would be. From this clear understanding may you build your life on a fearless future and be established in the integrity of God's Word.

Appendices

Appendices

Appendix A: Holy Week Chart - Synoptic Gospels

Appendix B: The Now and the Not Yet – Venn Diagram

Appendix C: Tabernacle of Moses – Heaven, Earth, Sea

Appendix D: Temple Comparison

Appendix E: Chart of 12 Caesars

Appendix F: Resurrection Chart

Appendix G: Chronological Order of the New Testament

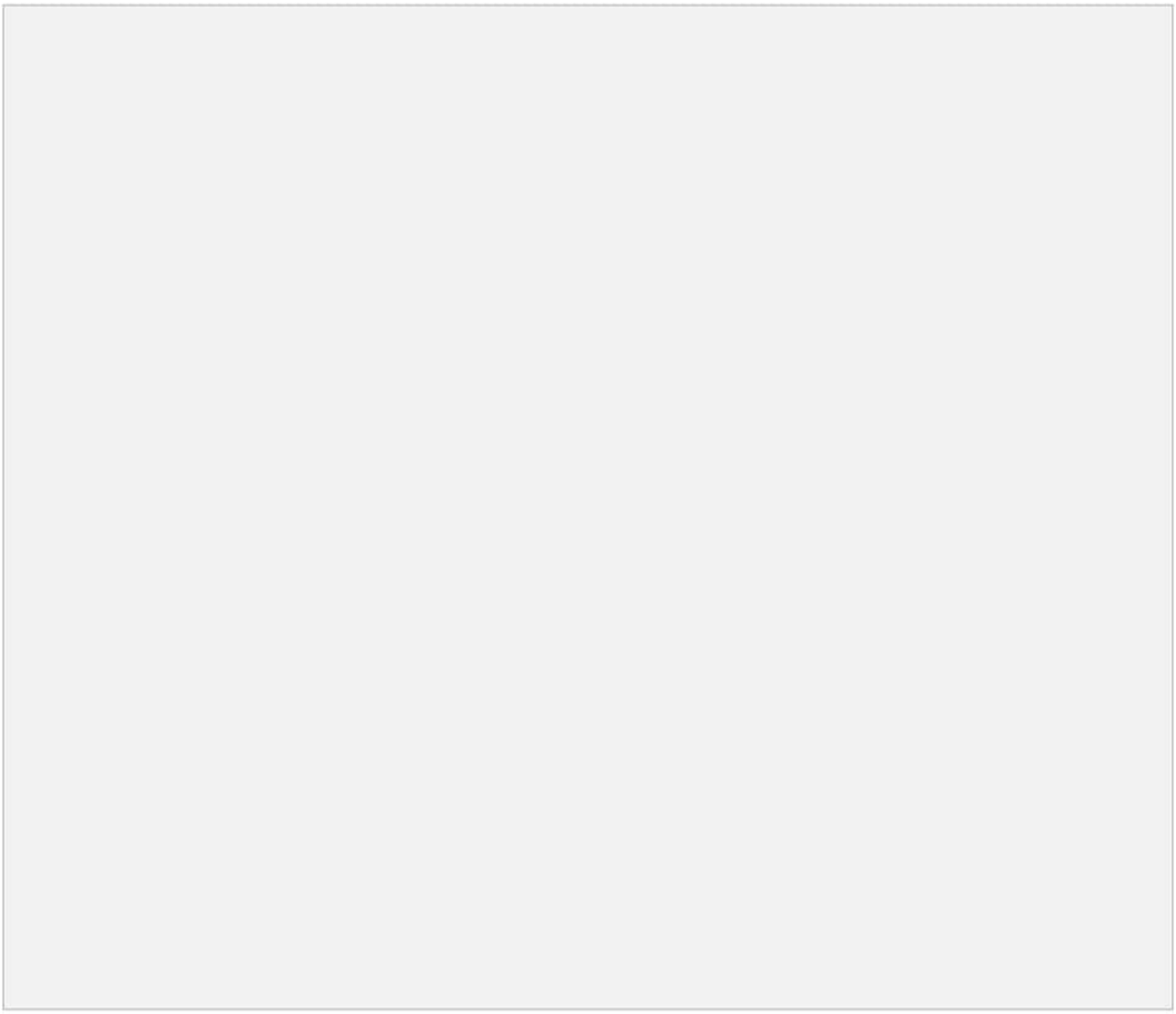
Appendix H: 270 Messianic Prophecies Jesus Fulfilled

Appendix I: Herod the Great

Appendix J: The Dating of the Book of Revelation

Appendix A: Holy Week — Synoptic Gospels

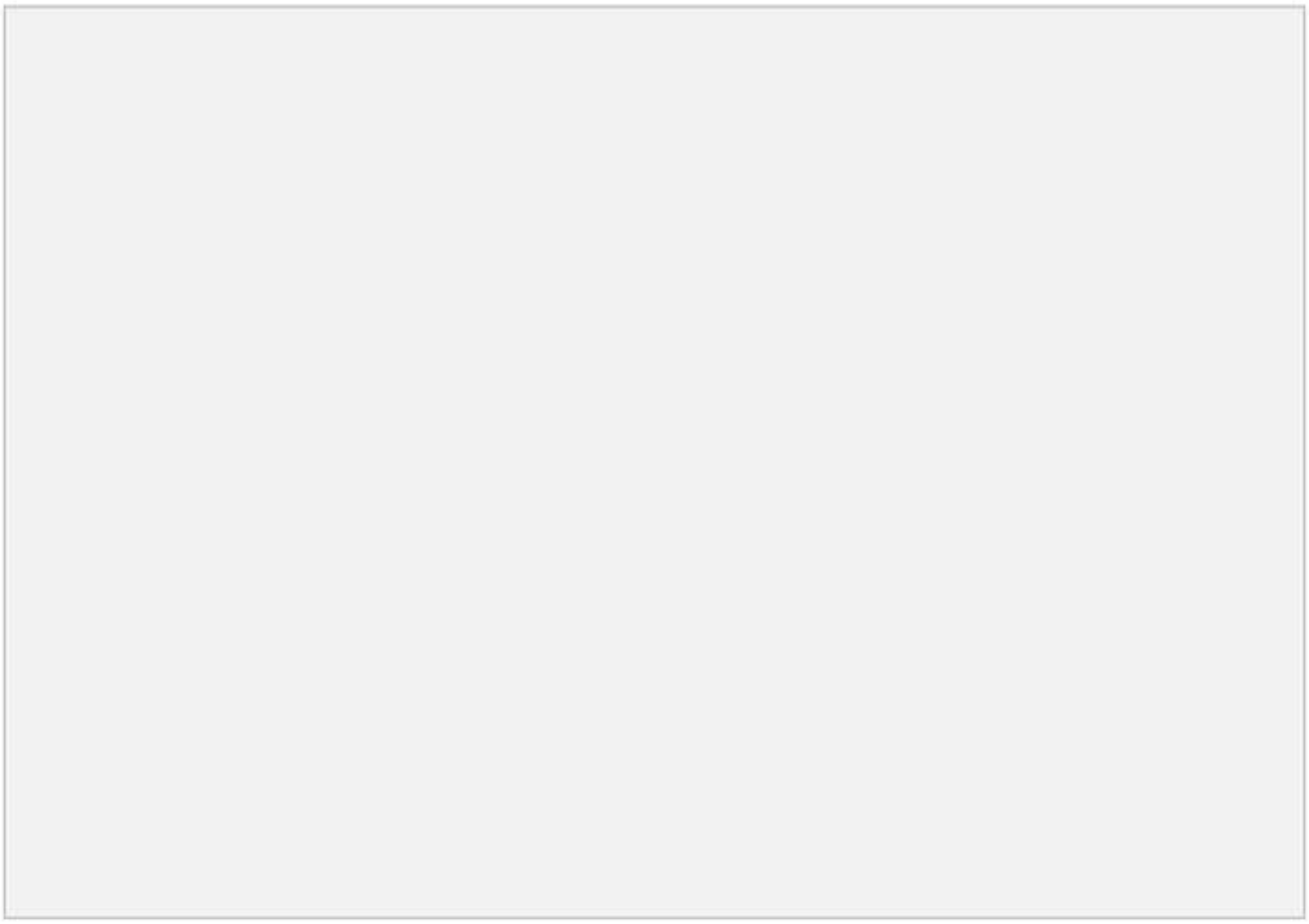
Holy Week Continues (Synoptic Gospels)



Note: This chart is based on a traditional understanding of a Friday crucifixion. Some view the “3 days and 3 nights” literally to mean 72 hours making a Wednesday crucifixion more plausible. **The main point of this book is to reveal the fulfilled prophecies of Jesus in the first century** so we will maintain the more commonly accepted Friday crucifixion to keep things simple.

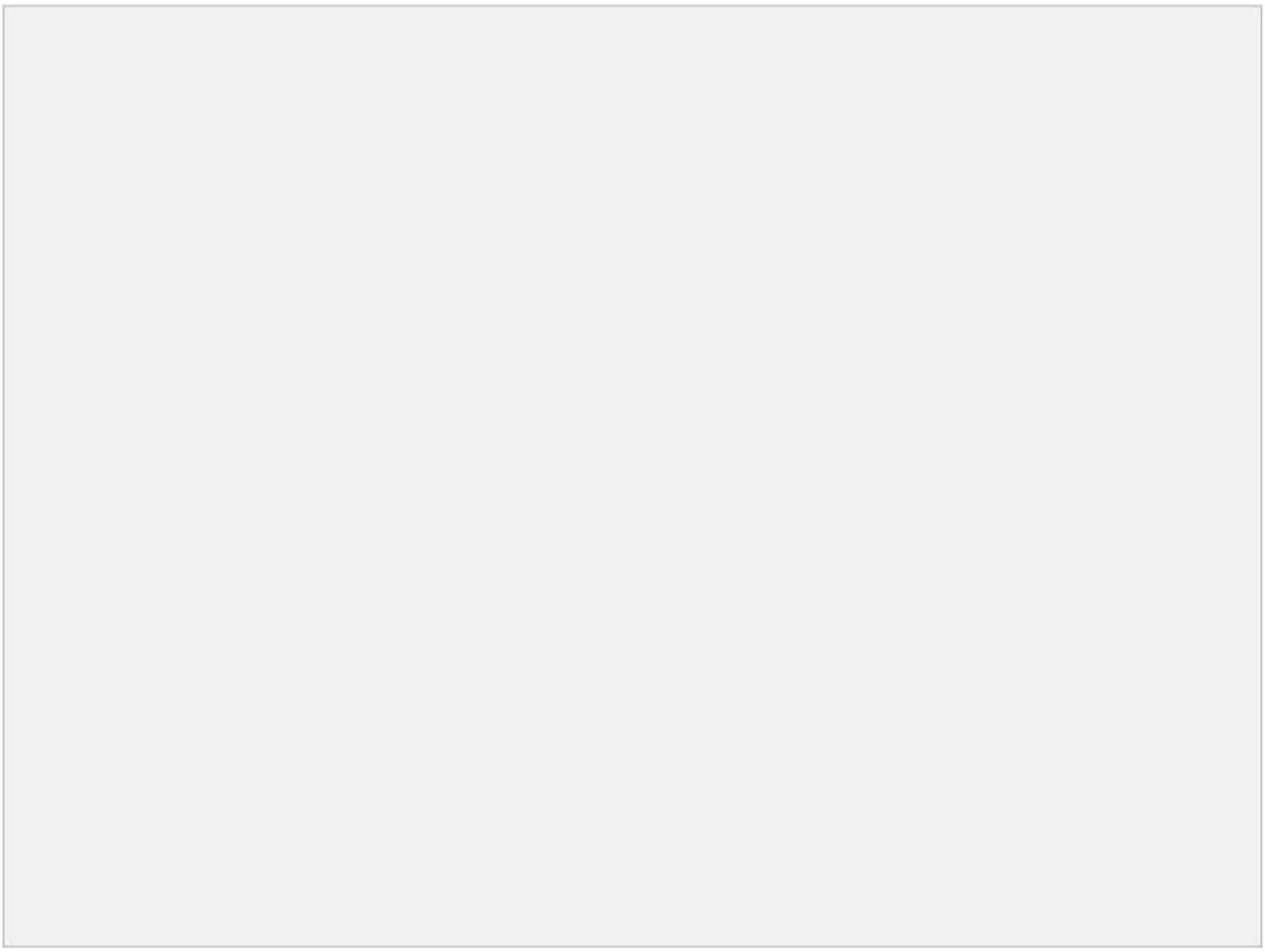
Appendix B: The Now & The Not Yet

The entire New Testament was written during a forty-year time window in between AD 30 (after Christ ascended) and AD 70 (the destruction of Jerusalem). **Although the New Covenant began during the earthly ministry of Jesus, it was not ratified until the destruction of Herod's Temple in Jerusalem in AD 70. It was then the Old Mosaic Covenant had come to an end and the "new and better" everlasting covenant had been established.**



Appendix C: Heaven, Earth, & Sea

(Tabernacle Of Moses)



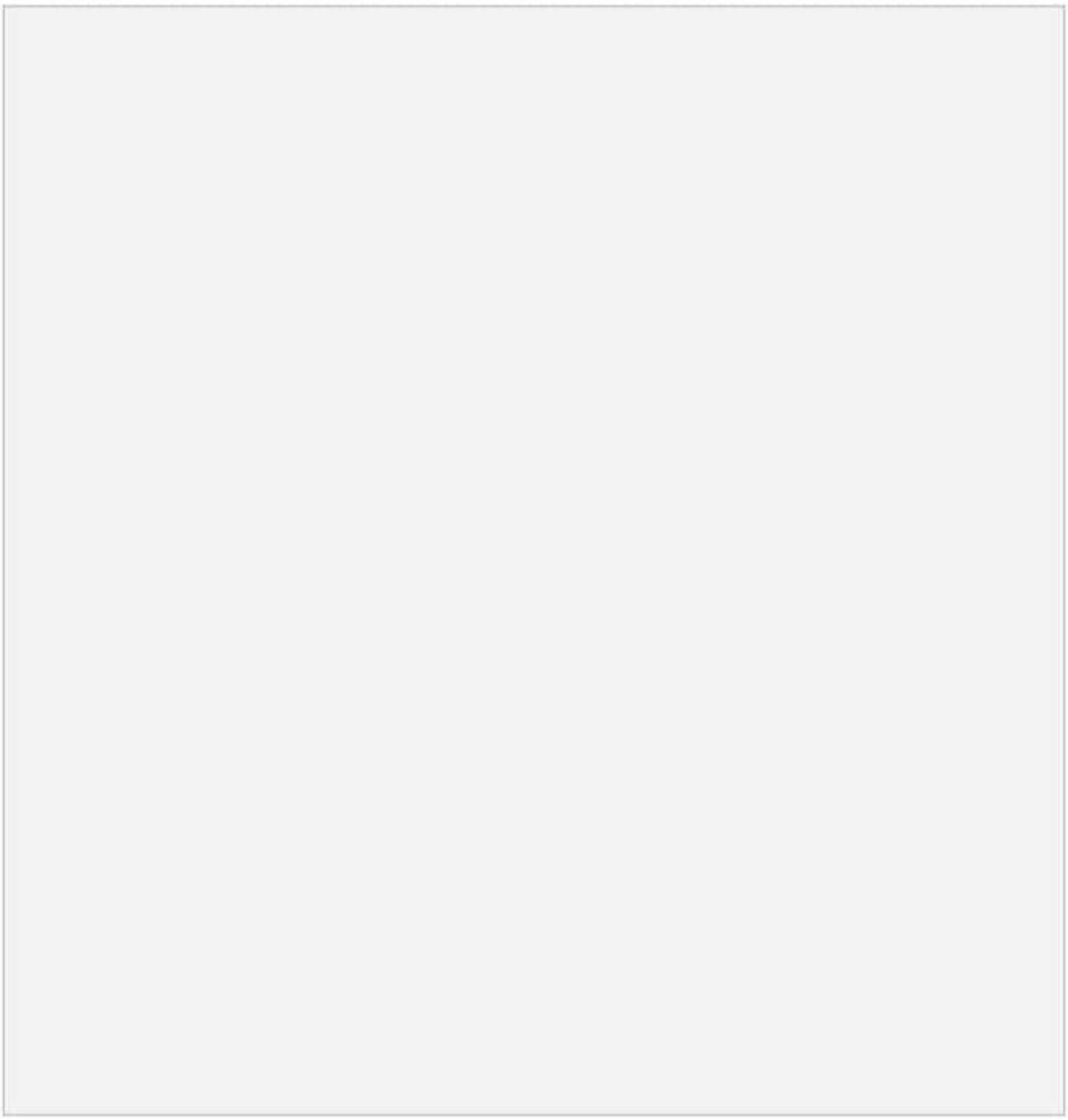
The people in the Early Church were familiar with the terms, "Heaven, Earth, and Sea" as it related to the Tabernacle of Moses. The same pattern was used for Solomon's Temple and later, for Herod's Temple.

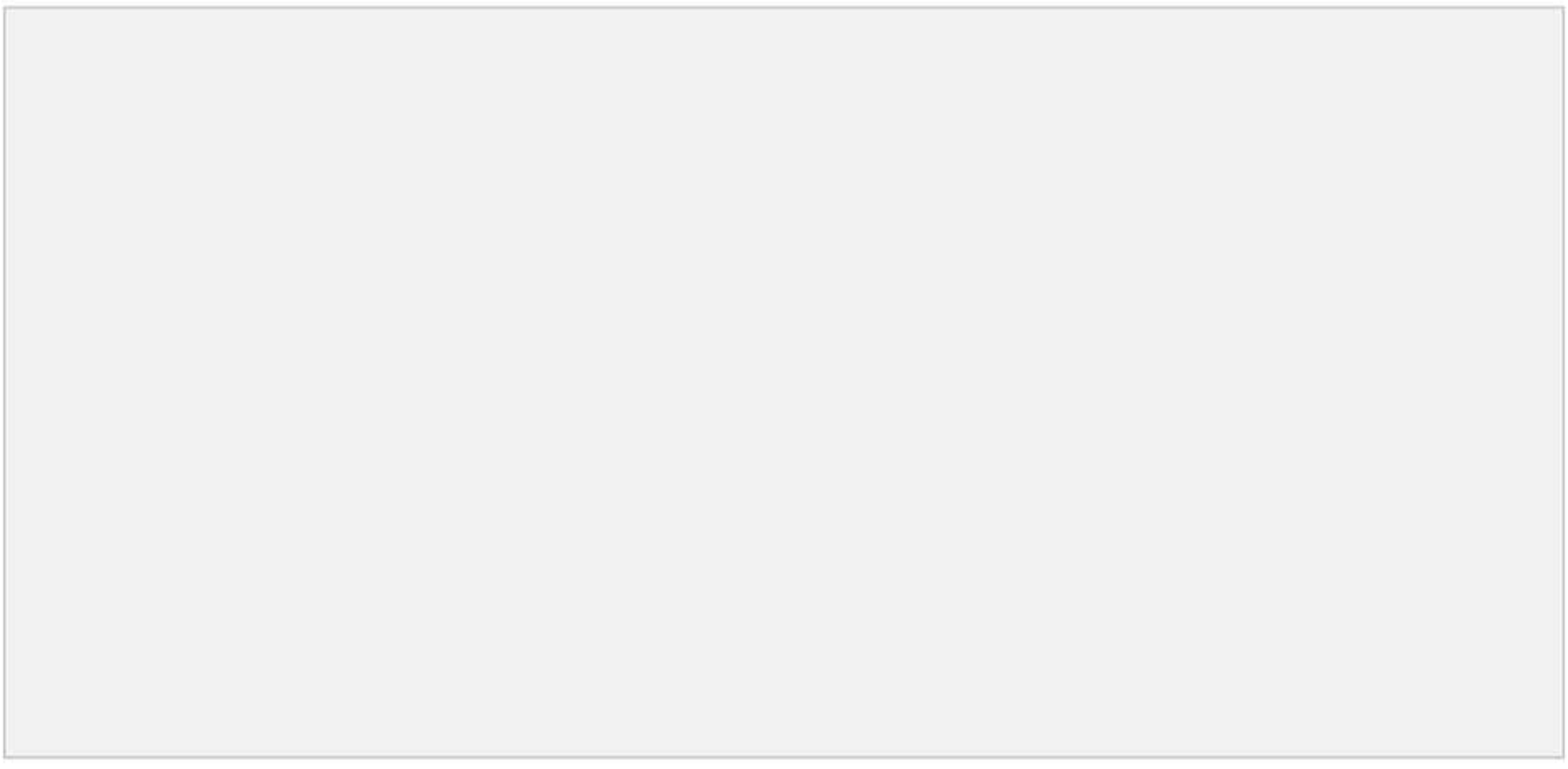
The Holy of Holies was where the presence of God was, so it was called Heaven. The Holy Place was where the priests ministered to God, so it was called Earth. The Outer Court is where everyone else gathered, so it was called the Sea.

The historian Josephus explains this concept in ***Antiquities of the Jews.*** This helps to clarify the statement Jesus made in Matthew 24:35; "**Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will by no means pass away**." He was not speaking about literal Heaven and planet Earth passing away; He is speaking about the Temple passing

away, and it did. We are now the Temple of the Living God. We are the New Heaven and the New Earth.

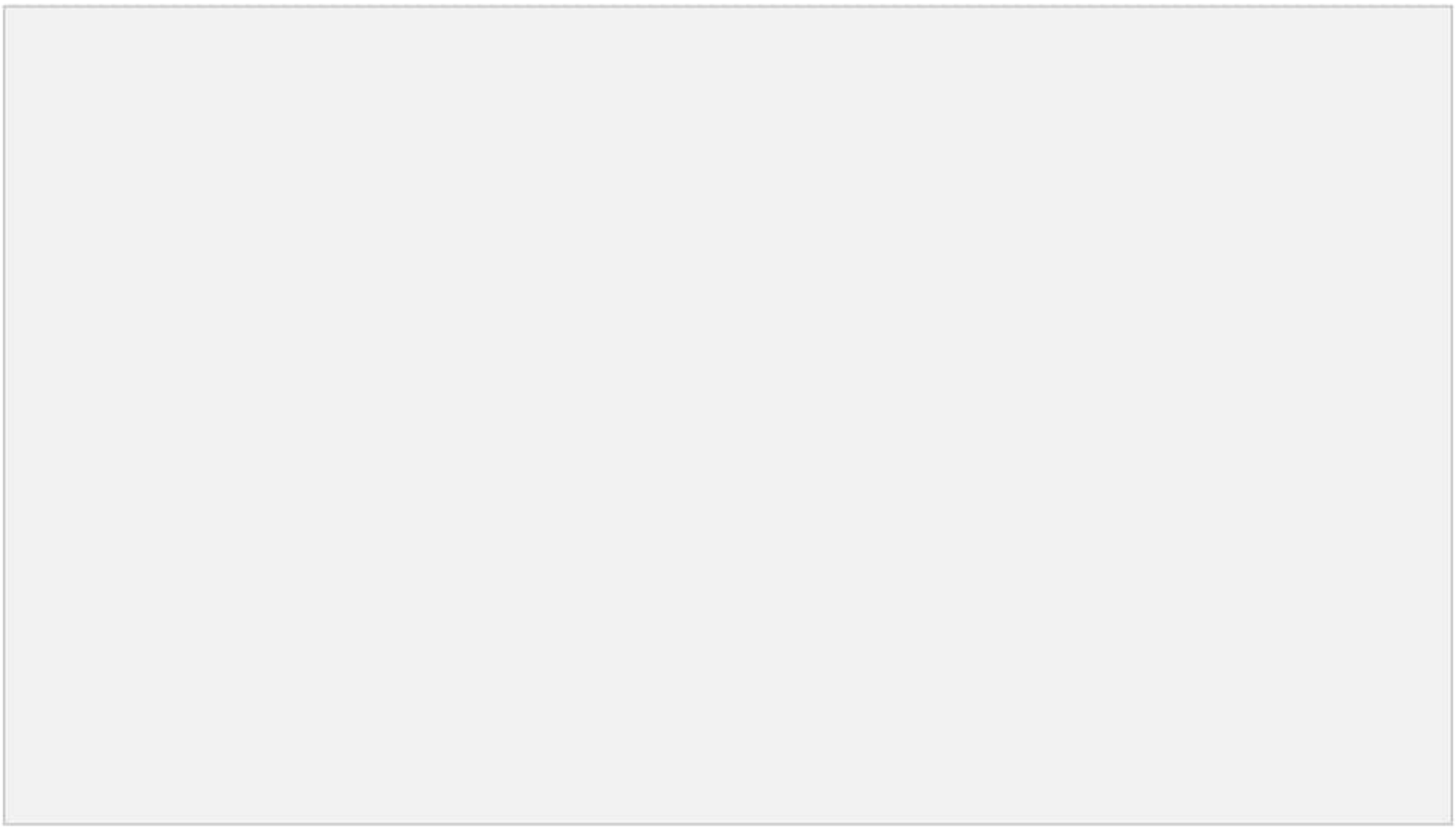
Appendix D: Temple Comparisons





Herod’s Temple

Appendix E: The 12 Caesars



During the lifetime of Jesus and His disciples, Rome ruled the world and the Jewish people had to answer to the Roman emperors just like everyone else.

When Jesus was born, Caesar Augustus (also known as Octavian) was on the throne. However, Tiberius was emperor most of Jesus' life until His death. This was the time of Pax Romana (Roman Peace) as there were no wars.

The Early Church was mostly under the earthly rule of Caligula, Claudius and Nero. Although, it was Vespasian who sent his son, Titus to siege Jerusalem in AD 66 and destroy Herod's Temple in AD 70. The city was completely destroyed by AD 73, which fulfilled the prophecies of Jesus in Matthew 24 and 25.

Appendix F: Resurrection Chart

Based on Matthew 24:34 “this generation”

Appendix G:

Chronological Order of the New Testament

Note: This chronological list of New Testament books is based on scholarly conservative research found in the world's oldest surviving New Testament called the ***Codex Sinaiticus*** located in the British Library.

While the canon of Scripture is indeed inspired, the placement of the books is not. The ***Codex Sinaiticus*** was written in Koine Greek by scribes around AD 350 in Palestine or Egypt. The Latin word, "Codex" refers to the blocks of wood used for writing.

According to the ***Codex Sinaiticus***, the last book in the New Testament was the book of Revelation and was completed in AD 68. The historical and biblical proofs of this fact is found in Appendix J. "**The Dating of the Book of Revelation**".

For more information consult good, conservative study resources like ***Unger's Bible Dictionary*** which has an excellent synopsis under each individual book in the New Testament.

APPENDIX H:

Messianic Prophecies Fulfilled by Jesus

(Fulfillment in bold)

Appendix I King Herod The Great

Herod was born in 72 BC to a high-ranking Roman official, Antipater, who had converted to Judaism and an Arab princess from Petra which is modern-day Jordan. Herod was raised as a Jew. According to Josephus in the ***Antiquities of the Jews***, Herod was a descendant of Eleazar Maccabeus of the Hasmoneans (dynasty of ancient Judea, descendants of the Maccabee family.)

Herod rose to power largely through his father's good relations with the Roman general and dictator Julius Caesar, who entrusted Antipater with the public affairs of Judea, a Roman Province. Herod was appointed governor of Galilee in 47 BC, when he was 28 years old.

There, he established the taxes of that region for the Roman Senate, and he successfully rid that region of bandits. He enjoyed the backing of Rome, but the Sanhedrin condemned his brutality. Herod was politically savvy as he switched sides from Mark Antony to Caesar Augustus (also known as Octavian) who assigned him to be governor of Judea.

Herod is known for his colossal building projects throughout Judea. Most famous among those was the rebuilding and expansion of the Temple in Jerusalem. This enormous undertaking started in 19 BC and took many decades to complete. Jesus, Mary, and Joseph saw it under construction as they visited the Temple. It is possible that Joseph may have worked on one of Herod's building projects as "carpenters" in the first century were also stone masons.

Appendix J

The Dating of The Book of Revelation

We are about to see why it is essential to interpret Scripture with Scripture as opposed to interpreting Scripture with modern-day current events. With the dating of Revelation, we establish the true historical perspective. If we date it early, you have its fulfillment with God's judgment on Old Covenant Israel. If we date it late, we have every man's idea based on politics, headline news, and even the color and positions of the moon. So, dating Revelation plays a very important part in its interpretation. There are differences of opinion as to when this book was written. These opinions can be summed up as the "late date" and the "early date" theories. First, we'll cover the late date theory. Then we'll examine the facts which support the early date theory.

The Late Date Theory

Those who hold to the "late date theory," have Revelation written during the time of Domitian Caesar (AD 95-96). This date is determined based on a statement made by Irenaeus (AD 130 to AD 202), as quoted by Eusebius, the church historian, in AD 325. Irenaeus' statement was something he heard from Polycarp who supposedly knew the Apostle John. No Scripture backs it up, just quotes from Early Church fathers who quoted other Early Church fathers. Some have placed quotes from these men above the actual quotes from Jesus and His Apostles written in Scripture. This is why serious Bible students must allow Scripture to be the basis on which we build our theology. History serves to confirm what Scripture teaches – not the other way around.

The Early Date Theory

We turn to find evidence for the dating of Revelation within the book itself, **Let Scripture interpret Scripture!** It will be shown, from internal evidence that Revelation was written before the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70.

(1) John's Age - he must prophesy again...

The first point to consider in favor of the early date is the fact that John was told that he **"must prophesy again before many peoples, and nations, and tongues, and kings"** (Revelation 10:11). Now, if Revelation was written in AD 95-96, John would have been over 90 years old and it would have been very difficult for him to travel to

the various "nations and…many kings" and preach. However, with Revelation written earlier, John would have been in his mid-60's, making traveling less difficult and more feasible.

(2) The Seven Churches in Asia

Another point is the fact that John wrote Revelation to a specific group of churches in Asia (Revelation 1:4). The importance of this statement cannot be overlooked, even though it has been by many "scholars".

There is only one small window of time in which there were only seven churches in Asia during the early 60's. The apostle Paul established nine churches in that area, only seven were addressed in Revelation.

The reason for this is that the cities of Colosse, Hierapolis, and Laodicea, were all destroyed by an earthquake around AD 61.

Laodicea was rebuilt soon afterwards, but the other two cities were not. This left only seven churches in Asia during the five years just prior to the beginning of the Roman-Jewish War in AD 70.

Something very important to note is the message to the church of Philadelphia (Revelation 3:7-13). In verses 10 and 11, Christ told John to inform them that an "hour of temptation" was "about to come upon all the world" (the Roman Empire). Christ then told them that He was coming quickly and that they should hold fast. The reason this is important (besides the fact that this was addressing an actual church in the first century), is that the first persecution of Christians took place under Nero in AD 64. Therefore, Revelation must have been written before AD 70.

(3) The Temple was still standing

One of the most compelling proofs that Revelation was written before Jerusalem was destroyed is the fact that the Jewish temple was still standing!

"Then I was given a reed like a measuring rod. And the angel stood, saying, 'Rise and measure the temple of God, the altar, and those who worship there. But leave out the court which is outside the temple, and do not measure it, for it has been

given to the Gentiles. And they will tread the holy city underfoot for forty-two months.'" **(Revelation 11:1-2)**

How do we know that this was the temple of the first century and not some future one? First, there is not one verse in the New Testament that speaks of a "rebuilt" Jewish Temple. Not one. That alone should be proof enough.

However, this passage is very similar to Luke 21:20-24. Notice that Jesus told the disciples that they would see this event. They had asked Him about their temple (verse 5), and Jesus told them it would be destroyed before their generation passed away (verse 32). Notice again what Jesus said in verse 24, **"Jerusalem shall be trodden down of the Gentiles."** This is the same thing Christ told John in Revelation 11:2. Therefore, since the disciples' generation has long since passed away, Revelation must have been written before the gentile nations trampled Jerusalem underfoot in AD 70.

(4) The Tribes of the Earth

Most writers consider the theme of the Book of Revelation to be in chapter 1, verse 7. This verse is very similar in context to Matthew 24:30.

Revelation 1:7, **"Behold, He is coming with clouds, and every eye will see Him, even they who pierced Him. And all the tribes of the earth will mourn because of Him. Even so, Amen."**

Matthew 24:30, **"And then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory."**

We can see based on the language; a case can be made that the two verses are speaking of the same event. Matthew 24:30 is a verse that speaks of the fall of Jerusalem in AD 70 which is the same theme in the book of Revelation.

Notice the language of Revelation 1:7. It speaks of those who "**pierced him.**" Although we know that the Romans actually crucified Him, Jesus' followers accused the Jews of the act of murder (Acts 2:23,36). Peter says the "**men of Israel**" and "**house of Israel**" crucified Jesus. He continues to make this point in his following sermons: (Acts 3:15; 4:10; 5:30).

Stephen, in Acts 7:51-52, calls them **murderers**. "You stiff-necked and uncircumcised in heart and ears! You always resist the Holy Spirit; as your fathers did, so do you. Which of the prophets did your fathers not persecute? And they killed those who foretold the coming of the Just One, of Whom you now have become the betrayers and **murderers**…"

The Apostle Paul, in 1 Thessalonians 2:14-15, speaks of the "**Judeans**" (Jews) killing the Lord and "their own prophets". **"…Judeans, who killed both the Lord Jesus and their own prophets, and have persecuted us; and they do not please God and are contrary to all men**…" So clearly the book of Revelation is speaking of the first century apostate Jews as "**they who pierced Him**".

Continuing in Matthew 24:30 where it says, **"…and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn…"**

This view is further reinforced with the phrase, "**all tribes of the earth,"** ("tribes" is from the Greek word ***phule***). This is a direct reference to the Jewish tribal system.

Now, we must identify, from Scripture, who those "tribes" were. To do that, we must keep in mind this simple rule of interpreting the Bible: Scripture interprets Scripture. We can do that quite easily by looking at Zechariah 12:10,11.

"And I will pour on the house of David and on the inhabitants of Jerusalem the Spirit of grace and supplication; then they will look on Me whom they pierced. Yes, they will mourn for Him as one mourns for his only son and grieve for Him as one grieves for a firstborn. In that day there shall be a great mourning in Jerusalem…"

Obviously, this is the foundation for John's statement that "**…every eye will see Him, even they who pierced Him. And all the tribes of the earth will mourn because of Him.**" So, in essence, Zechariah was saying that the "**tribes of the land**" would mourn for Him whom they had pierced. Who were those tribes? "**The inhabitants of Jerusalem**." This also helps us identify the "earth" in Revelation 1:7.

According to Zechariah, the "earth" (Revelation 1:7) is referring to the land, Israel, and Jerusalem. It is those tribes in the land of Israel, who would "**look upon Me**

whom they have pierced." And because of that, "the mourning in Jerusalem" would be great.

With all of this information, we can clearly see that the "tribes of the earth" in Revelation 1:7 is referring to the land and people of Israel which includes Jerusalem.

So, the main purpose of Revelation would be to reveal Jesus to the nation of Israel. The place of this revealing would be Jerusalem. Lastly, this revealing would be to those who pierced Him (the Jews). This is not a general reference to the Jewish people, but to Christ's contemporary generation of Jewish people—those which were alive the same time He was. That generation was destroyed in AD 70 by the Roman Legions. Therefore, the Book of Revelation must have been written before that event.

(5) The Woman

The next thing that we need to look at is "**the woman**" found in chapters 17 and 18. John wrote that he saw a "**woman** drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs of Jesus" (17:6). The "**woman**" had this name written on her forehead: "MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF HARLOTS AND ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH" (17:5). The angel said that "**the woman**" was a poetic symbol of "**that great city**" (17:18;) in whom "was found the blood of prophets, and of saints, and of all that were slain upon the earth." (18:24). Then John wrote, "Rejoice over **her**, O heaven, and you holy apostles and prophets; for God has avenged you on **her**… Thus, with violence the **great city Babylon** shall be thrown down, and shall not be found anymore. (Revelation 18:20,21). So, who was this "**woman**" and what was this "**great city**?"

John gave us a clue in Revelation 11:8, where he wrote, "And their dead bodies shall lie in the street of **the great city**, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, **where also our Lord was crucified**." This shows us, as we saw above, that John was referring to the **Jerusalem** of his day.

To prove this claim, let's look at the term "**Sodom.**" John wrote this as a "figurative" name. That means it does not tell us the actual name of the city, but its spiritual condition. Once more, in letting the Bible interpret itself, we find this is a reference to Jerusalem. In Isaiah, chapter 1, after declaring that he had a "vision…concerning Judah and Jerusalem" (verse 1), Isaiah wrote, "**Hear the words of the Lord, you**

rulers of Sodom." In Jeremiah 23:14, because of the adulterous prophets, **God said that Jerusalem and her inhabitants were "all of them unto me as Sodom."**

But what about "Egypt?" Nowhere in the Bible is Jerusalem called Egypt. However, the first century generation was also in an exodus. While Old Testament Israel's exodus was from the bondage of Egypt, the New Testament Israel's exodus was from the bondage of the Old Covenant Law. The most recognizable passage that depicts this "new exodus" is found in 1 Corinthians 10:11.

Paul wrote, "**Now all these things happened to them as examples, and they were written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the ages have come.**" This statement in context refers to the Old Testament exodus from Egyptian bondage. He wrote that they had passed through the sea. **(1 Corinthians 10:1)**

Continuing in 1 Corinthians 10, they ate manna and drank from the rock (verses 3-4). Paul then says how they wandered in the wilderness (verse 5), became idolaters (verse 7), tried the Lord and were destroyed by serpents (verse 9).

This shows us that, just like the "type and shadow" of the Old Testament and their deliverance from bondage, the New Testament saints were undergoing the same exodus. The only difference was that Paul's generation was a manifestation to which the Old Testament example pointed.

Furthermore, in Luke 13:33-34, Jesus said, **Nevertheless I must journey today, tomorrow, and the *day* following; for it cannot be that a prophet should perish outside of Jerusalem. "O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the one who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her!** Then, in Matthew 23:29-37, Jesus blasted the Jews of His day for killing the prophets. He declared that they are the children of their fathers who also killed the prophets. Then in verse 32, Jesus said that they would complete the sin that their fathers started. But the most crucial evidence is found in Matthew 23:35, where Jesus said, **that on you may come all the righteous blood shed on the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah, son of Berechiah, whom you murdered between the temple and the altar.** In both passages, Jesus told the Jews of His day that they were guilty of "**all the righteous blood shed upon the earth**"(see also Acts 7:51-52).

Therefore, since both of these passages deal with the same crime and the same judgment, the "**great city**" of Revelation must be the Jerusalem of Christ's generation. Which further proves that Revelation was written before Jerusalem fell in AD 70.

(6) The Sixth King - "Nero"

And there are seven kings: five are fallen, and one is, and the other is not yet come; and when he comes, he must continue a short time. Revelation 17:10

So far, we have seen that Revelation deals with the revealing of Jesus to first century Israel. As noted above, "**the woman**" John saw was first century Jerusalem. The "kings," therefore, were the rulers of the known world of John's day (the Roman Empire). The "kings" were not ruling at the same time, for the text stated "five fell," meaning that five of those kings had come and gone. Then "one is," meaning the "king" who was ruling at the time Revelation was written. Here in this verse, we have one of the clearest proofs for dating this book. If we simply examine the list of Roman Emperors, we will be able to determine who the sixth king was, and the time Revelation was written.

Here are the Roman Emperors:

(1) Julius Caesar
(2) Augustus
(3) Tiberius
(4) Gaius (Caligula)
(5) Claudius
~"five fell…"
(6) Nero

Nero reigned from AD 54 to June of AD 68. (Galba to follow reigns but six months.) Here we find the terrible persecutors of the Christians (at whose hand Peter and Paul were martyred), whom God used to destroy the apostate Jews.

Nero was in power and he gave the command to Vespasian to destroy Jerusalem. This was the 6th king, proving beyond any doubt that Revelation was written before the Roman-Jewish War.

Historically, Nero is the one that persecuted Christians beyond all comparison. The apostle John's banishment to Patmos was itself a result of the great persecution of Nero. The apostle Paul was tortured and then beheaded by the evil Emperor Nero

in Rome in AD 67. The apostle Peter, who was crucified upside down, was another victim of Nero.

(7) The Song of Moses

To anyone familiar with the Law of Moses and Jewish tradition - Revelation 15:2,3 will have meaning. It says that those martyrs "**who had come off victorious from the Beast**" were singing "**the Song of Moses**."

Question:

If these martyrs are Christians living 2,000 years after Christ, why would these Christians be singing the Song of Moses? Does any Christian alive today know how to sing this song? Deuteronomy 32:1-43 is the song that John gives reference to.

The Jews were to sing this song to remind themselves of what would befall them "in the latter days" (**Deuteronomy 31:29**). The song talks about "their end" - the Jews (verse 20), and details their destruction by a consuming "fire" (verse 22), "famine"(verse 24), "plague" (verse 24) and "bitter destruction" (verse 24).

God calls them a "perverse generation" (verses 5 and 20) and says He will "render vengeance" upon them and "vindicate His people" (verse 36 and 41 respectively). Why would Christian martyrs of the 21st century be singing this song about the Romans, when the song had reference to the Jews living in the first century? It wouldn't make much sense to modern day Christians.

Aren't these the same martyrs who cried out earlier, "How long, O Lord, will you refrain from judging and avenging our blood?" **(Revelation 6:10)** Who was it who had all the "blood of the righteous" martyrs imputed against them? Clearly, it was Christians who had kept their faith in Jesus, despite the intense persecution, and "had come off victorious from the Beast." (See Matthew 23:35.). This passage (Revelation 15:2,3) points very clearly to followers of Christ living in the first century.

In Revelation 16:10,11, it says that the people in the Beast's kingdom "gnawed their tongues because of pain." They had great sores on their bodies along with other plagues that had been poured out on them. We know from Josephus that the Jews literally gnawed their tongues for lack of food during the siege of AD 70! It is

interesting that Josephus even calls the Jewish Zealot forces a “wild beast” in several places: ***War of the Jews*** *V.1.1*; IV.7.4; IV.9.8; V.2.5)

This point is emphasized even more by the fact that the whole context of the Song of Moses is full of references to “beasts,” “serpents,” and “dragons” (Leviticus 26; Deuteronomy 28-32; Deuteronomy 32:24,33).

(8) The Time Element

Next, consider the expectations of the author, Jesus Christ. He tells John to expect the fulfillment of the prophecy **soon** (Revelation 1:1,3; 2:16; 3:11;22:6,7,10,12,20).

In Revelation 1:1-4, John informed his readers, the seven churches of Asia (verse 4), that the contents of this volume **"must shortly come to pass**." Please note, that John did not write that some of the events, or even most of the events must shortly take place. He wrote that **all of the events** contained in Revelation "**must shortly come to pass**." Why must those things "**shortly come to pass**?" Because "**the time (was) at hand.**" At hand for whom? The seven churches of Asia, specifically. The time for what was at hand? **"The Revelation of Jesus Christ."** Remember, as we saw above, this is the main theme of Revelation.

In Revelation 22:6, John wrote that the Lord sent an angel to John "to show unto his servants the **things which must shortly be done**." Here, at the end of the book of Revelation, John recorded the exact same message that he did in chapter 1. This again **emphasizes that all of the events contained in Revelation were about to take place in the first century** — not stretched throughout time, and certainly not for any future generation.

In Revelation 22:10, the angel of the Lord said to John, "Seal not the sayings of the prophecy of this book: **for the time is at hand**." Once more, we have proof that the events of Revelation were about to **take place in the first century**. However, another element was added to this warning.

The angel told John not to seal the Scroll. Why is this important? To answer that, let's look at the book of Daniel.

After Daniel had received visions concerning his people (the nation of Israel), he was told, "**your people shall be delivered, every one that shall be found written in the book**" (12:1). Daniel is then told how they would be rescued—by resurrection, some would be rewarded with "**everlasting life**" and others with "everlasting contempt" (verse 2). But then, Daniel is told something very peculiar. In verse 4, **Daniel was told, "shut up the words, and seal the book, even to the time of the end.** Please note that this verse says the "**time of the end**", **and not "the end of time"**. There is a huge difference between the end of time and the time of the end.

Now, we must ask "**Whose time of the end?**" Verse 1 told us that **Daniel's visions concerned the nation of Israel**, not mankind in general.

Next, Daniel saw two angels talking about the fulfillment of all that he had seen (verse 6). One asked the other, "**How long shall it be to the end of these wonders**?" The answer was, "**when he shall have accomplished to scatter the power of the holy people, all these things shall be finished**."(verse 7). But Daniel could not understand what they meant, so he asked again, "When?" The angel answered "**Go your way, Daniel: for the words are closed up and sealed till the time of the end**." Now that we have looked at this passage, how does it relate to Revelation 22?

There is only one other place in the Bible where a sealed book is referred to, it's in Revelation chapter 5. Remember, Daniel's visions were concerning the **"time of the end" of Israel**, and Revelation is about God's judgment on apostate Israel. They are one and the same. The reason this has direct bearing on Revelation 22, is that Daniel was told to seal his book concerning the end "**for it pertains to many days in the future"(Daniel 8:26), but John was told not to seal his book "because the time is at hand" (Revelation 22:10)**. The end of Old Covenant Israel and the Law of Moses was coming to an end. The age of Grace had arrived to which there would be no end.

All things written had to be fulfilled by the time Jerusalem fell in AD 70 (see Luke 21:20-22). Therefore, since Revelation is the opening of Daniel, then it must have been fulfilled by the summer of AD 70.

Our next time statement is found in Revelation 22:12. There, Jesus told John, "**And, behold, I come quickly; and My reward is with Me, to give every man according as his work shall be**." Notice that **Jesus did not say that "when I come, I will come quickly,**" He emphatically said that He was coming "**quickly**."

But He also said something else. He said that His reward was with Him to give every man according to his works. **Now some state that this has not happened yet. However, we must let Scripture interpret Scripture, and turn to Matthew 16:27-28, and Mark 8:38-9:1 and Luke 9:26-27.** Jesus said the exact same thing in these three verses that He did in Revelation 22.

In Revelation 22, He said He was coming and "He shall reward every man according to his works." These are the exact same "comings" with the exact same "rewards." But

Jesus also said in these three verses, **“There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in His kingdom**.” Notice that Jesus tied His coming to the lives of His disciples. **He said that some of His listeners would not die until He came.**

But to whom is He coming? And what will be their reward? **Jesus said that the “coming” would be to the first century generation of Israel (Matthew 24:34, Mark 13:30, Luke 21:32). Daniel told us that the” rewards” would be that some would be resurrected to “everlasting life” and others to “everlasting contempt**”.

Now, let’s put these two passages together. Jesus said He was coming and He was going to reward each according to his works, and that some of the disciples wouldn’t die until they saw this take place.

Therefore, since all of the first century disciples are dead, Jesus must have returned and rewarded each according to his works. Furthermore, in Revelation, He said the same thing, therefore it must be fulfilled.

Bibliography

Resources Used for Research

Resources Used for Research

William Barclay - ***The Gospel of Matthew***

John L Bray - ***Matthew 24 Fulfilled***

David Chilton - ***The Days of Vengeance***

Adam Clarke - ***Commentary on the New Testament***

David Clark - ***The Message from Patmos***

David Crews - ***Prophecy Fulfilled - God's Perfect Church***

Marion Dawson - ***Christ's Second Coming Fulfilled***

Samuel G. Dawson - ***Essays on Eschatology***

Gary DeMar - ***Wars and Rumors of Wars***

P.S. Despres - ***The Apocalypse Fulfilled***

F.W. Farrar - ***The Early Days of Christianity***

J.C. Fenton - ***Saint Matthew***

Kenneth Gentry - ***Before Jerusalem Fell***

Glenn L. Hill - ***Christianity's Great Dilemma***

Max King - ***The Spirit of Prophecy***

Josephus - ***The Works of Flavius Josephus***

Josephus - ***War of the Jews, Antiquities of the Jews***

Judaica - ***Jerusalem Encyclopedia***

J. Marcellus Kik - ***An Eschatology of Victory***

Joel McDurmon - ***Jesus v. Jerusalem***

Charles Meek - ***Fulfilled Prophecy***

Don K. Preston - ***The New Covenant: Fulfilled or Future***

J. Stuart Russell - ***The Parousia***

Suetonius - ***The Twelve Caesars***

R.C. Sproul - ***The Last Days According to Jesus***

Scofield - ***The Reference Bible***

Tacitus - ***The Annals of Imperial Rome***

Talmud - ***The Babylonian***

Milton S. Terry - ***Biblical Hermeneutics***

Eusebius -***Church History (Book III)***

About the Author

Dr. Cindye Coates is a beloved teacher who is known to make complicated things simple. She has taught every core subject K5-12th grade in private Christian schools as well as taught college level classes on-line. She is a curriculum writer who has certified teachers. She attributes teaching Ancient World History for the insight she has concerning the New Testament.

She has a doctorate degree in Theology and wrote her doctoral dissertation on fulfilled eschatology proving Bible prophecy was fulfilled in the first century. Much of her research is contained in this book.

She is a gifted communicator, writer, and an award-winning speaker with Toastmasters International. She was an Atlanta Falcon Cheerleader, a Goodwill Ambassador for the '96 Olympic Games in Atlanta, and a 3-time pro-life nominee for the Georgia State House of Representatives.

Dr. Cindye resides just north of Atlanta with her husband of forty years, Dr. Stan Coates. Together they have 2 adult sons, Kyle and Tyler, whom they homeschooled for 20 years. She and her husband have planted seven churches and raised up countless ministry leaders and worship ministries as Stan is a Grammy award winning Gospel songwriter. They currently co-pastor The Porch in Marietta, Georgia.

The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus Facebook Group:
https://www.facebook.com/groups/314449149612216

Current Ministry Projects

Global Podcast – PRESENT TRUTH MATTERS

Subscribe to the podcast here:

www.PresentTruthMatters.com

Dr. Cindye Coates Healing School – YouTube

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w6sfFl_86NA

E-mail: presenttruthmatters@gmail.com

Books by Dr Cindye Coates

The Fulfilled Prophecies of Jesus: A Verse-by-Verse Study of Matthew 24

Upcoming Titles in This Series (Publication Date TBA):

The Garden Mandate – God's Original Intent for Mankind

Living The Raptured Life